Supplementary material for

# *Specification Surfaces for Incremental forecast performance: Estimation, Uncertainty, and Multi-Log Evaluation*

**Abstract**

This document holds the protocol and its amendments, the proofs, the constructions of the reporting objects, the correction register, the per-layer and per-fold results, the literature pilot, the diagnosis of the one simulated world where the bootstrap misbehaves, the reporting standard with the `fieldvalue` package and its six-step recipe, the worked example, the verification harness, the derivation of the coverage calibration — which the article derives and does not apply — three results the article summarises in a paragraph each — the family-by-encoding crossing, the decision-rule comparison, and the calibration, unseen-category and rolling-origin diagnostics — and the tables the article does not print. The article is self-contained without it. Every number in both documents is generated from the same result files by the same script, so a quantity cannot differ between them.

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## S1. Protocol, and the amendments to it

The corpus protocol is `PROTOCOL.md` and the practice pilot's is `AUDIT-PROTOCOL-2.md`; both are in the archive and both were committed before the first result they govern existed. This appendix lists what changed afterwards.

*Why amendments are reported rather than folded in.* A pre-registration that is quietly edited is worse than none, because it claims a discipline it does not have. Each amendment below names its date, the defect that forced it, and the result it moved.

**Amendment 1 — a register's values must recur across time.** Registered rule 3.3 admits any attribute reused across two cases on average. On BPI Challenge 2019 that admits the purchasing-document number, which is a document identifier and not a maintained entity: almost none of its values recur across the temporal split. The amendment adds a second, outcome-free condition — at least 50% of test cases must carry a value seen in training — and *both* selections are reported for every log.

**Amendment 2 — "any timestamp" had to be implemented.** Rule 3.1 excludes timestamps. Matching a fixed list of names did not implement that: it missed five differently-spelled date columns, two of which the registered rules then made the high-cost entity. A column is now a timestamp if its name looks like one or if more than 90% of its non-missing values parse as a date. Both tests read feature values only.

**Amendment 3 — a relabelling of the activity is the activity.** Some logs carry a second column that is a one-to-one recoding of `concept:name`. Admitting it as a feature admits the activity sequence, which is not available at case creation.

**Amendment 4 — coarsenings of the register get their own role.** Type, subtype and service are deterministic functions of the item. Sweeping them into the intake block makes the intake block partly a register, and the increment then measures the residual rather than the field. They are a separate role and S4 uses it.

**Amendment 5 — the caused-by family is an outcome.** A caused-by attribution is the output of diagnosis, not an intake observation. Without this the registered rules made the caused-by configuration item the high-cost entity on the flagship log.

**Amendment 6 — the pilot frame's topical filter was nulled.** The frame's keyword filter was applied to titles and abstracts, which is a filter on how a paper describes itself rather than on what it does. `results/s06_frame.csv` reports what nulling it does to the estimates.

*What the protocol fixed, before any of the results it governs.* The design space of Section 3; the reference specification; the exclusion of the intercept-only rung from every admissible set; the six register-quality mechanisms and their levels; the five planned contrasts and the Holm procedure; the two families over which simultaneous bands are taken; and the two-stratum design of the practice pilot, including the decision to adjudicate a sample of the papers the screen *rejected*. The commit that fixed them adds `scripts/spec.py` and `PLAN-ROUND19.md` and no result file.

*S1.1. Related work, strand by strand*

Four further strands bear on the argument. *Many-analysts studies* put one question and one dataset to independent teams and observe the spread directly (Silberzahn et al., 2018; Breznau et al., 2022): they establish that analytic variability is large without supplying an estimand for it, which is what the surface is. *Predictive multiplicity* and Rashomon sets study near-equally accurate models that disagree on individuals (Marx et al., 2020; Semenova et al., 2022) — multiplicity at the level of a fitted model, where this paper's is at the level of the design that produced it. *Benchmark-variance work in predictive process monitoring* reports how far results move with the pipeline and the protocol (Rama-Maneiro et al., 2023), which is the evidence this paper's decomposition partitions. And the *sensitivity-analysis* tradition of bounding an unmeasured assumption (VanderWeele and Ding, 2017) is the form Section 7.3's leakage tipping point takes. On the estate side, the accuracy of a configuration management database is itself a studied quantity (Suriadi et al., 2017; Mohammed et al., 2025), and the layered service models practitioners maintain are why Section 7.4 asks which *layer* of a register pays. The strands are set out below, each with what this paper takes from it.

*Variable importance and incremental value.* That a feature's apparent importance depends on what else is in the model is the standard motivation for conditional and permutation-based importance (Strobl et al., 2008; Fisher et al., 2019), for Shapley-value attributions (Lundberg and Lee, 2017; Covert et al., 2020), and for nonparametric formulations of importance as a population quantity (Williamson et al., 2021), which average over subsets precisely because a single conditioning set is arbitrary. The clinical-prediction literature has made the same point about the *incremental* value of a marker for two decades: the increase in the area under the ROC curve from adding a predictor depends on how good the existing model is (Pencina et al., 2008; Cook, 2007), is a poor guide to clinical usefulness (Cook, 2007; Vickers, 2008), and is routinely misread (Kerr et al., 2011). What that literature establishes, and what we take as given, is that the baseline and the metric are choices. What it does not supply is an object that reports the whole dependence, an estimator for it, or inference over it.

*Decision-analytic evaluation.* Decision curve analysis (Vickers and Elkin, 2006; Vickers et al., 2016) makes the operating point explicit by reading net benefit across an exchange rate, and is the reason the operating point is an axis here rather than a footnote. Guidance on reading such a curve is well developed (Vickers et al., 2019); what is less settled is what a claim about a *band* of thresholds requires, which is why the bands in Section 8 are simultaneous rather than pointwise.

*Specification sensitivity.* That analytic conclusions move with defensible analytic choices is the subject of multiverse analysis (Steegen et al., 2016), specification-curve analysis (Simonsohn et al., 2020), vibration of effects (Patel et al., 2015) and, in machine learning evaluation, of work on underspecification (D'Amour et al., 2022) and on the fragility of benchmark rankings (Bouthillier et al., 2021). Our design space and our figures are recognisably in that tradition. What this paper adds to it is a decomposition of the surface's variance into axis contributions, simultaneous inference over the surface rather than a distribution of point estimates, region labels with an explicit decision rule, and a regret benchmark against the conventional report. Specification-curve analysis, as usually practised, displays the curve and applies a permutation test to its median; it does not tell a reader which sub-region of the design space supports a sign.

*Data valuation.* Shapley-based data valuation (Ghorbani and Zou, 2019; Jia et al., 2019) values *instances* against a fixed learner and metric; the axes we vary are exactly the ones held fixed there. The two are complementary: a data value is itself a point on a specification surface.

*Which axis a study varies.* Some studies do vary one axis deliberately: the metric axis in effort-aware defect prediction (Çarka et al., 2022), the encoding axis in remaining-time prediction (Liu et al., 2025), the inter-case feature block in predictive process monitoring (Senderovich et al., 2018). What is missing is an object that holds several axes at once and says what their joint variation implies for a sign.

*Prediction on incident event logs.* The empirical setting is predictive process monitoring, surveyed and benchmarked across real logs (Teinemaa et al., 2019; Verenich et al., 2019) on data of the kind process mining formalises (van der Aalst, 2016). We predict at case creation from creation-time attributes with no prefix, which is tabular classification on a process log rather than prefix-based monitoring, and that difference bounds what the corpus result transfers to. The benchmark protocols in that literature fix a learner, an encoding and a metric per experiment, and this paper measures the sensitivity of a conclusion to *those* fixings. It does not measure sensitivity to **prefix length, prefix bucketing or sequence encoding**, which are the axes that literature varies most, because none of them exists at a single prediction point; Section 10 carries the transfer as an assumption rather than a result. Configuration management databases and their data quality are treated in the IT service management literature as an operational problem (Marrone and Kolbe, 2011); we are not aware of an evaluation of one against a named prediction task with the design space held open.

*Data quality as an axis.* The effect of data quality on model performance has been studied directly on tabular data (Mohammed et al., 2025) and, in process mining, for low-quality activity labels (Comuzzi et al., 2025). Those studies vary quality with the feature set fixed; we vary quality *as one axis of the same surface* on which the feature set and the encoding are others, which is what makes the interaction between them visible — Section 7.3 reports a quality defect that is exactly invisible under one encoder and not under another. Leakage, which is availability misspecified, has its own literature (Kaufman et al., 2012; Kapoor and Narayanan, 2023; Weytjens and

De Weerdt, 2022), and the forecast origin of Section 7.2 makes it a declared choice rather than a mistake.

*S1.2. The measure on the axes, and the two axes that are not analysis choices*
*On the measure.* A design space is a set; a decomposition, a weighted mean or a robustness index needs a *distribution* on it, and "uniform over the cells I enumerated" is not neutral — it moves if a level is duplicated, if five folds are written as five levels rather than one, or if a grid is refined. This paper separates the weight on an axis from the weights within it, declares three product measures and an envelope over a fourth (Section 4.5), and reports every weighted quantity under all of them.

Two of these axes deserve comment because they are usually not treated as design choices at all.

The **forecast origin** $\tau$ fixes which fields exist when the prediction is made. It is not the same as the split rule and it is not a data-cleaning detail: moving $\tau$ later in a process admits fields written in between, and Section 7 is a case in which that single move takes a field's increment from resolvably positive to indistinguishable from zero.

The **register quality** $q$ acts on $f$ rather than on the comparison. A field that is a lookup into a maintained register — a configuration item, a customer master record, a product catalogue — inherits that register's completeness and accuracy. We implement six mechanisms besides the clean field, each parameterised by the training half alone: population loss with the long tail absent, with the core absent, and at random; identity error, in which a share of rows carry a wrong value drawn from the training alphabet; reconciliation failure, in which a share of identities exist twice; and staleness, in which an identity is present only if the register had already seen it by the split point. The first three model coverage, the next two accuracy, the last discovery; the taxonomy follows the event-log imperfection patterns of Suriadi et al. (2017) where they apply.

Real registers do not fail at random, so three *further* mechanisms make the missingness depend on something: on *time*, where a row's probability of carrying an identity rises with its position in the log; on *content*, where coverage depends on the item's recorded type through a map estimated on the training half; and on a *propensity* built from the intake block, which makes missingness correlated with the outcome without ever reading a test outcome. Every mechanism is swept over 11 severities and every stochastic one repeated over 20 seeds, and each is verified by execution to be a function of the training

half alone — perturbing the test half and re-degrading must leave the training half's degraded values identical, which `results/s01_trainonly.csv` records over 122 checks.

*S1.3. Targets, splits and the exclusion codes*

*S1.4. Targets, splits and exclusions*

Two targets are defined for every log: *handover*, whether more than one resource group touches the case, and *duration*, whether the case runs longer than the training half's median. Cases are ordered by their first timestamp and split 70/30; the rolling-origin scheme adds five expanding-window folds. Fields that are determined only at closure are excluded by name, which is the standard leakage discipline (Kaufman et al., 2012; Kapoor and Narayanan, 2023) and, for event logs specifically, the discipline of Weytjens and De Weerdt (2022). A log–target pair is excluded only for a registered reason — too few cases, no variation in the test half, a prevalence outside $[0.05, 0.95]$, or the absence of one of the three roles — and every exclusion is reported with its code in Table S12, which accounts for every downloaded log that is not among the admitted pairs — including the held-out set, 1 of the checksummed files, downloaded for a separate test and never offered to these rules at all.

**Every admitted pair is analysed and reported.** Running the full surface only on the logs whose *reduction* is resolvable would condition the analysis on the outcome. The surface is computed on all 19 admitted pairs through one code path, and the pairs on which the register is worth nothing are in the same tables as the rest.

*S1.5. The admission margin at the upper edge*

*The pair carrying the most cells sits closest to the admission edge.* BPIC14/handover has the highest prevalence of any admitted pair, 0.927, against the window's upper bound of 0.95; the nearest pair the headroom rule turns away, BPIC15_5/handover, is at 0.959, and 5 pairs in all are excluded above the bound. That pair is also the largest single contributor to the corpus, carrying 4,800 of the 29,040 admissible scalar cells. A rule with a sharp edge decides some case narrowly, and this is that case: the corpus's biggest component is admitted on a margin narrower than the gap to the pairs excluded beside it. Table S17 reports every headline statistic on the ITSM-like subset as well, which is the population that does not turn on this decision.

## S2. Proof details and constructions

**Remark S1** (What survives a declared family of recalibrations)**.** *For a family $\Psi$ of strictly increasing maps applied simultaneously to all four arms of a configuration, the reduction is $\Psi$-invariant exactly when the metric is* affine *under $\Psi$. Rank-basedness is sufficient and not necessary, and the gap is family-relative: the class-mean gap — the difference in mean score between the two outcome classes, which is not rank-based — has a reduction invariant to $1.9 \times 10^{-14}$ inside the affine family and shifting by up to 0.638 over 5 non-affine ones. What this buys is that a search becomes a proof: one map and one configuration violating the invariance rules it out everywhere, and 18 such certificates are computed, the smallest moving the reduction by 0.241, against 2,400 checks in which the two rank-based instruments hold to exactly zero.*

*Remark 1: the two-point algebra in full*

Let a scoring rule take one of two values, with $a$ of the $P$ positives and $b$ of the $N$ negatives in the high block; write $\alpha = a/P$, $\beta = b/N$, $\rho = N/P$ and $\pi = P/(P+N) = 1/(1+\rho)$. Two exact identities follow directly from the definitions in Section 3.5:

$$\mathrm{AUC} = \tfrac{1}{2} + \tfrac{\alpha-\beta}{2}, \qquad \mathrm{AP} = \alpha\,\frac{\alpha}{\alpha+\beta\rho} + (1-\alpha)\pi.$$

The first is the Mann–Whitney statistic with ties at $1/2$; the second is the step-wise sum over the two operating points the rule admits. Hence

$$\mathrm{AP} - \pi \;=\; \alpha\left(\frac{\alpha}{\alpha+\beta\rho} - \pi\right).$$

Fix $d = \alpha - \beta > 0$. Every rule on the line $\beta = \alpha - d$ has the same AUC increment $d/2$ over the fully tied baseline, so any two of them give $R_{\mathrm{AUC}} = 0$ exactly. Along that line the AP increment runs from $d(1-\pi)$ at $\alpha = d$, $\beta = 0$ down to $\dfrac{d\rho}{\big(1+(1-d)\rho\big)(1+\rho)}$ at $\alpha = 1$, a ratio of about $1+\rho$. How far apart the two reductions can be pushed therefore grows with the imbalance, which is a property of the construction and not a hidden assumption: refuting the existence of $\varphi$ needs only that the two be *different*, and at the modest $\rho = 3$ this paper uses they differ by 0.417.

*Remark S1: the cancelling configuration, and what a certificate is*

Section 3.5 notes a configuration on which a non-rank-based metric's increment moves under $\psi$ while the ratio does not. The construction is immediate once stated: take $\sigma_{B_1} = \sigma_{B_0}$ and $\sigma_{B_1 \cup f} = \sigma_{B_0 \cup f}$. Then $V(B_1) = V(B_0)$ for every metric and every $\psi$, so $R = 0$ identically, while $V$ itself moves under $\psi$ whenever $m$ is not rank-based. The configuration is degenerate — the two baselines induce the same scores — and that is why the proposition quantifies over configurations rather than asserting a configuration-by-configuration change.

A *certificate* for an instrument $m$ and a recalibration $\psi$ is a triple of score vectors $(a, b, c)$ on one labelled test set for which

$$\frac{m(b) - m(a)}{m(c) - m(a)} \neq \frac{m(\psi b) - m(\psi a)}{m(\psi c) - m(\psi a)}.$$

By Remark S1 the existence of one such triple establishes that $\psi$ does not act affinely on $m$, and therefore that $R_m$ is not invariant — a conclusion about *every* configuration drawn from a finite object. The certificates are searched for by maximising the gap over random triples; `results/s29_certificates.csv` records, for every instrument and every recalibration family, the triple found, the two ratios, and the resulting shift in $R$. The search reports failure where it fails, and a failure is not evidence of invariance.

*A withdrawn computational result*

A previous draft reported, as a labelled computational result, a search over a family of synthetic estates for witnesses that no design axis determines another. It is withdrawn and does not appear in this manuscript. Its answer moved between zero and five of twelve ordered pairs as an arbitrary equality tolerance was swept; failing to find a witness is not evidence that one axis determines another; and finding witnesses in a finite synthetic family is not a non-redundancy theorem. Nothing in the manuscript depended on it, which is the clearest argument for removing it rather than repairing it. This is the correction register in the archive.

*Remark 1: the construction*

*Proof (construction).* Take $P$ positives and $N$ negatives and let every score take one of two values, so a scoring rule is described by the pair $(a, b)$ counting

positives and negatives in the high block; write $\alpha = a/P$, $\beta = b/N$, $\rho = N/P$. Both baselines are the fully tied rule $\alpha = \beta = 1$, which has AUC $= 1/2$ and AP $= \pi$, the prevalence. Then exactly

$$\mathrm{AUC} - \tfrac{1}{2} = \tfrac{\alpha-\beta}{2}, \qquad \mathrm{AP} - \pi = \alpha\left(\frac{\alpha}{\alpha + \beta\rho} - \pi\right).$$

Fixing $\alpha - \beta$ equal on the two legs makes the AUC increments equal, hence $R_{\mathrm{AUC}} = 0$ exactly — in integers, not to rounding — while sliding $\alpha$ along the admissible range moves the AP increments and sweeps $R_{\mathrm{AP}}$. With $P = 200$, $N = 600$ and therefore $\rho = 3$, the two configurations in `results/s29_prop1.csv` — $(\alpha, \beta)$ of $(0.8, 0.4)$ and $(0.6, 0.2)$ in one, $(0.9, 0.5)$ and $(0.5, 0.1)$ in the other — have identical $R_{\mathrm{AUC}}$ to $2.2 \times 10^{-16}$ and $R_{\mathrm{AP}}$ of -0.250 against -0.667, differing by 0.417. A single $\varphi$ cannot take one input to two outputs.

The construction is only a proof if those two conditions hold, so `s29_props.py` asserts both: it refuses to write its output if the two configurations fail to share $R_{\mathrm{AUC}}$ or fail to separate $R_{\mathrm{AP}}$. A far more imbalanced problem — $\rho = 500$, which this construction previously used — drives the gap close to one, and the modest $\rho$ here shows the separation does not depend on extreme imbalance. □

*Remark S1: the proof*

The equivalence's harder direction needs one assumption, which round twenty-six moved here from the article with the propositions themselves.

**Assumption S1** (Richness)**.** Every quadruple of score vectors on the fixed labelled test set is realisable as a configuration. This is the assumption that no restriction is placed on the model class; it is what makes "for every configuration" quantify over a set with more than three elements, and it fails only if the analyst commits in advance to a family of scoring rules narrow enough to constrain the four arms jointly. It is used only for (i) ⇒ (ii); the direction that matters in practice needs none.

*Proof.* (ii) ⇒ (i). Each of $V_m(B_0)$ and $V_m(B_1)$ is a difference of two values of $m$, so an affine change of scale multiplies both by $A(\psi)$ and the additive constant cancels; their ratio, and hence $R_m$, is unchanged wherever the denominator is nonzero.

(i) ⇒ (ii). Fix $\psi$ and the test set, and write $m(\sigma)$ for $m(\sigma, y)$. For score vectors $a, b, c$, Assumption S1 admits the configuration $\sigma_{B_0} = a$, $\sigma_{B_0 \cup f} = c$,

$\sigma_{B_1} = a$, $\sigma_{B_1 \cup f} = b$, for which $R_m = 1 - \big(m(b) - m(a)\big)/\big(m(c) - m(a)\big)$. Invariance says

$$\frac{m(b) - m(a)}{m(c) - m(a)} = \frac{m(\psi b) - m(\psi a)}{m(\psi c) - m(\psi a)} \tag{1}$$

for every admissible triple. First, the map $T : m(\sigma) \mapsto m(\psi\sigma)$ is well defined: if $m(b) = m(b')$ then applying (1) to $(a, b, c)$ and to $(a, b', c)$ with the same $a, c$ gives $m(\psi b) = m(\psi b')$. Second, fix $a$ and $c$ and put $k = \big(T(m(c)) - T(m(a))\big)/\big(m(c) - m(a)\big)$; then (1) reads $T(u) = T(m(a)) + k\,(u - m(a))$ for every $u$ in the range of $m$, which is affine with slope $A(\psi) = k$ and intercept $B(\psi) = T(m(a)) - k\,m(a)$. The slope is nonzero because otherwise the transformed denominator vanishes and $R_m$ is undefined rather than invariant. □

*Proposition S1: the* $3 \times 3$ *construction*

*Proof (construction).* Two levels per axis will not do, and the reason is worth stating: with two levels the two main effects are $|P + Q|$ and $|P - Q|$, where $P$ and $Q$ are the two within-axis differences, so their ordering is decided by $\mathrm{sign}(PQ)$, and a strictly increasing $\phi$ preserves the sign of each difference. At two levels the ordering is therefore *invariant* and the proposition is false. From three levels a conditional mean averages more than two cells and a convex $\phi$ reweights them unequally. The $3 \times 3$ design in `results/s07_prop3.csv` has $S_A = 0.421$ against $S_B = 0.284$ in its own units and $S_A = 0.232$ against $S_B = 0.390$ under $\phi = \sqrt{\cdot}$, so the leader changes. □

*Why the second proposition is stated relative to a family*

It is stated *relative to a declared family of recalibrations*, which is both what its proof reaches and what an analyst can act on: nobody recalibrates by an arbitrary monotone map, and a reader who has declared that they will consider Platt scaling, or isotonic regression, or any affine rescaling, is asking about that family and not about all of them.

Richness is used only in the direction (i) ⇒ (ii), so under a model class too narrow to realise the separating configuration an instrument can be invariant on *that class* without acting affinely; the direction that matters for practice, (ii) ⇒ (i), needs no richness at all. A reader working inside a restricted family should read the proposition as a sufficient condition and establish non-invariance on their own class by exhibiting a configuration in it, which is what the certificates do.

## S3. Construction of the inferential objects

Section 4 states what each of the reporting objects is and why it is that and not something else. This appendix carries the constructions themselves, so that the section can be read for the argument and this one for the arithmetic. What is here is the detail a reader would need to reimplement the objects without reading the code.

*The multiplier bootstrap for the max-t critical value*

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the declared family, $V_c^{(b)}$ the $b$th bootstrap draw at cell $c$, $\bar{V}_c$ the draw mean and $\hat{\sigma}_c$ the per-cell bootstrap standard error. Standardise the draw matrix,

$$Z_{b,c} \;=\; \frac{V_c^{(b)} - \bar{V}_c}{\hat{\sigma}_c}, \qquad b = 1, \ldots, B, \quad c \in \mathcal{F},$$

and let $e_1, \ldots, e_B$ be independent standard normals drawn afresh for each replicate. The *multiplier* statistic is

$$T^{(\mathrm{mult})} \;=\; \max_{c \in \mathcal{F}} \left| B^{-1/2} \textstyle\sum_b e_b Z_{b,c} \right|.$$

Conditionally on the draws, $B^{-1/2} \sum_b e_b Z_{b,\cdot}$ is a centred Gaussian vector whose covariance is exactly the empirical covariance of the standardised draws, so the distribution of $T^{(\mathrm{mult})}$ approximates that of the max-$t$ statistic without any further refitting (Chernozhukov et al., 2013). The critical value $q_{1-\alpha}$ is the $(1-\alpha)$ quantile of 20,000 such replicates, generated in chunks so that the $20{,}000 \times B$ normal matrix is never held at once.

Two properties are worth stating because they are the reason the construction is used here. The precision of $q$ is governed by the number of multiplier replicates and not by $B$, so a design whose fitting budget is fixed by the cost of refitting an entire pipeline can still resolve its critical value; and because the multiplier draws are conditional on the observed $Z$, the construction inherits whatever dependence the moving-block resampling induced across cells, which is what a family-wise statement over a correlated surface requires. The approximation is asymptotic in the same sense the max-$t$ band is: it needs the high-dimensional central limit theorem to hold over a family whose size is comparable to the draw count, which Section 10 states as an assumption rather than a guarantee.

The Monte Carlo interval for $q$ itself is retained. Writing $[q^-, q^+]$ for the order-statistic interval of the multiplier quantile, a cell is called *resolved* only if its band excludes zero at $q^+$, so residual Monte Carlo noise leaves cells unresolved rather than resolving them in the wrong direction.

*Fieller's construction for the reduction*

For $\vartheta = V_1/V_0$ with estimates $(\hat{v}_0, \hat{v}_1)$ and bootstrap covariance $(\hat{s}_{00}, \hat{s}_{11}, \hat{s}_{01})$, Fieller's theorem gives the confidence set

$$\Big\{\vartheta : (\hat{v}_1 - \vartheta\hat{v}_0)^2 \le z^2\big(\hat{s}_{11} - 2\vartheta\hat{s}_{01} + \vartheta^2\hat{s}_{00}\big)\Big\},$$

whose boundary solves a quadratic in $\vartheta$ with leading coefficient $\hat{v}_0^2 - z^2\hat{s}_{00}$. When that coefficient is positive the set is a bounded interval. When it is zero or negative — which is exactly the case in which the denominator $\hat{v}_0$ is not resolvably different from zero at level $z$ — the set is a half-line, the whole line, or the complement of an interval, and reporting a bounded interval for it is reporting a set that is not the confidence set. `results/s02_fieller.csv` records the kind of every set this paper computes, in its `fieller_kind` column.

*The three rules for the reduction.* The article makes $D$ and the two increments primary and treats $R$ as a secondary descriptive statistic subject to three rules, declared before any $R$ was computed:

1. $R$ is reported only where $V_s(f \mid B_0)$ is resolvably positive under the *simultaneous* band, not merely positive as a point estimate;
2. its interval is a Fieller set and its *kind* — bounded, unbounded, or the complement of an interval — is printed beside it. A confidence set for a ratio is the solution set of a quadratic (Fieller, 1954) and is bounded only when the denominator is resolvably away from zero (Supplement S3). Of the 10,584 reductions this paper computes, 5,282 have a non-bounded Fieller set, and a percentile interval reports a bounded one for every single one of them;
3. the magnitude of $R$ is never compared with the spread of $R$ across metrics as though both lived on an unproblematic common scale.

*The three regret designs*

Section 4.7 defines the misreport rate $M(s)$ and the regret $G(s)$ and explains why an average of $G$ taken across instruments has no units. The three designs it names are constructed as follows.

**A. Metric-specific.** For each scalar instrument $m$ separately, the admissible set is restricted to the cells whose metric axis is at $m$, and $M(s)$ and $G(s)$ are computed over that restriction under the declared measure. Every reported value carries the name of its unit, and no average is taken across instruments. The only cross-instrument statement the design permits is a count: in how many of the five instruments the *direction* of a conclusion is the same, and which ones it is not — and Section 6.6 reports both, because on this corpus two of those counts are four and not five. The design assumes nothing beyond the measure, and it is what the headline uses.

**B. Common operational utility.** Net benefit at threshold $t$,

$$\mathrm{NB}(t) \;=\; \frac{\mathrm{TP}(t)}{n} \;-\; \frac{\mathrm{FP}(t)}{n} \cdot \frac{t}{1-t},$$

is measured in true positives per case at an exchange rate the threshold declares, so values at different thresholds are cardinally comparable and may be averaged. The increment is the difference in net benefit between the two arms at the same threshold, computed only on calibrated probabilities (Section 8) because a threshold read as a cost ratio requires one. The resulting quantity is called *decision* regret rather than predictive-performance regret. The design assumes a distribution over thresholds, which is declared and varied rather than fixed.

**C. Partial identification.** If a reader insists on one number across instruments, the answer depends on a map $\phi$ from an instrument's units to theirs. Five are declared, in `s23_regret.UTILITY_MAPS`: the *identity*; division by the instrument's remaining *headroom*, the distance left to a perfect score; division by the increment's *standard deviation* across the surface; a signed *square root*; and a logistic squashing of the standardised increment. Each is increasing in the increment and each divides only by positive quantities, so all five fix zero and the *sign* of an increment is invariant to every one of them; what moves is the relative

magnitude an instrument contributes to a mixed average. The conclusion is reported as its *range* over the family together with the part invariant to all of it, which is exactly the part the design declines to identify.

Designs A and C are computed on the full declared surface, since neither needs a bootstrap draw. Design B is computed on the calibrated decision-curve cells of Section 8.

*Estimating the decomposition*

Write $\mathbb{P} = \bigotimes_i w_i$ for the product measure over the axes. Every subset $u$ of axes has a component $g_u$ given by the Möbius sum over the conditional means,

$$g_u(x_u) \;=\; \sum_{v \subseteq u} (-1)^{|u|-|v|}\, \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}[V \mid x_v]\,, \qquad D_u \;=\; \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}\Big[g_u^2\Big]\,,$$

and the components are mutually orthogonal, so $\sum_{u \neq \emptyset} D_u = \mathrm{Var}(V)$ exactly. The first-order and total indices of Section 4.5 are $S_i = S_{\{i\}}$ and $S_{T_i} = \sum_{u \ni i} S_u$ for $S_u = D_u / \mathrm{Var}(V)$.

The components are computed exactly rather than by a sampling estimator, which the complete factorial makes possible. For that product measure the conditional means $\mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}[V \mid x_v]$ are weighted group means over the cell table, one for each of the $2^k$ subsets $v$ of the $k$ axes; the Möbius sum then gives every $g_u$ and every $D_u = \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}[g_u^2]$. The implementation forms the group index once with a mixed-radix encoding of the axis levels and reuses it for all $2^k$ subsets, so the cost is $2^k$ passes over the cell table rather than $2^k$ table joins.

Three checks run on every decomposition and are recorded rather than assumed. The disjoint components must sum to the variance, which is asserted numerically on all 304 decompositions. Duplicating a level with its weight split must leave every component unchanged, and does, to $1.1 \times 10^{-16}$. Refining the operating-point grid under the same underlying continuous measure must leave the threshold axis's index unchanged, and moves it by 0.004.

Where the inference surface supplies draws, the whole decomposition is recomputed inside every draw, which gives an interval for every index rather than a point; corpus-level medians are bootstrapped with the log–target pair as the resampling unit, because pairs and not cells are the independent objects. No axis is called dominant anywhere in this paper where those intervals overlap.

*S3.1. Specification regret: the three designs*

A reader of a one-number claim decides whether to adopt the field, and the rule the number supports is *adopt iff* $V_s > 0$. If the specification the reader will actually run is drawn from the same admissible set under the declared measure, two quantities follow. The *misreport rate* $M(s) = \Pr_{s'}[\operatorname{sign} V_{s'} \neq \operatorname{sign} V_s]$ is the probability that the reader's own cell disagrees in sign with the reported one. The *regret*

$$G(s) \;=\; \mathbb{E}_{s'}\Big[\max(0, -V_{s'})\Big]\,\mathbf{1}\{V_s > 0\} \;+\; \mathbb{E}_{s'}\Big[\max(0, V_{s'})\Big]\,\mathbf{1}\{V_s \leq 0\}$$

is the performance destroyed by adopting when the reader's cell is harmful plus the performance forgone by declining when it is beneficial.

$G(s)$ carries the units of the instrument its increments were measured in, so an average across five scalar instruments has no units at all. Three designs are therefore reported, each constructed above: **A, metric-specific**, inside one instrument at a time, which is what the headline uses; **B, common operational utility**, on calibrated net benefit (Section 8.3); and **C, partial identification**, over five declared monotone utility maps fixing zero. The misreport rate has a second difficulty, which Section 6.4 answers rather than notes: a cell whose sign the data do not resolve contributes a coin flip to it. The rate is therefore reported over all cells, over the cells the band resolves, and weighted by $|V|$, and the article's headline is the second. No coverage calibration enters any of the three (Section 9.2).

Saying that a surface report asserts a sign only where the region is uniform, and therefore misreports nothing, is a definitional win and not a measured one, so the paper compares explicit *decision rules* under the loss above.

**Lemma S1** (The decision-optimal collapse)**.** *Let the reader's specification be drawn from the admissible set $\mathcal{S}$ under a weighting $w$, and let a rule choose one action for all readers. Writing $A = \mathbb{E}_w[\max(0, -V_s)]$ for the harm mass and $B = \mathbb{E}_w[\max(0, V_s)]$ for the benefit mass, expected loss is $A$ under* ADOPT *and $B$ under* DECLINE*, and $B - A = \mathbb{E}_w[V_s]$. Hence expected loss is minimised by adopting exactly when $\mathbb{E}_w[V_s] > 0$: the decision-optimal summary of a specification surface is the* weighted mean increment*, not the sign at any one cell and not the count of positive cells.*

Its assumptions are strong — one action for every reader, a loss linear in a common utility, and a known reader distribution $w$ — and what is scientifically difficult is specifying the utility and the weighting, not proving the identity. The paper therefore reports the identity as a check — the mean rule's

in-sample excess regret is exactly zero across every pair and instrument, as it must be — and measures the rules *out of sample* instead (Section 6.6). Two things follow: the conservative rule is wrong, not merely cautious, whenever the harm mass is smaller than the benefit mass it forgoes; and a one-number report is optimal exactly when the sign of its cell agrees with the sign of the mean, which is a coincidence rather than a property of the cell.

*S3.2. The pipeline, and what the estimator holds fixed*

**The rule that selects the inference surface, in full.** It is one design, and it is the same design on every pair: two learners, two splits, three register-quality conditions and three admissible rungs, crossed — 36 cells a pair, 3,420 scalar family members across the corpus — at 400 draws. Nothing in the rule reads a result, and nothing in it reads the log: the size classes that chose the previous surface's levels are gone, and the objection they carried with them.

**It is a complete factorial, and that is checked rather than declared.** On every one of the 19 pairs each combination of the four axes is present exactly once — no cell missing, no cell twice, and no pair differing in shape from any other — so a corpus median over these families is a median over one design, which the previous surface's was not. A balanced full factorial is also strictly stronger than the resolution-IV fraction that would suffice to make the decomposition estimable here, so the guarantee is the stronger one and not the cheaper one.

The pipeline is frozen and identical on every log. Attributes are assigned to roles by the registered rules of Section 5; cases are ordered by their first timestamp; and the split is temporal. The *pipeline* axis spans encodings as well as model families: one-hot logistic regression, frequency-encoded logistic regression, cross-fitted target-encoded (Micci-Barreca, 2001) histogram gradient boosting, and the same boosting wrapped in isotonic calibration. All four run on the case study's log; the other pairs carry two or three by a rule declared on row count. Because those levels move two things at once, Section 6.2 crosses the family with the encoding where the budget allows it, and the axis is called a pipeline rather than a learner throughout. Registers here run to 5,245 levels, above the cardinality cap of the boosting implementation's native categorical support, which is why the tree learner is target-encoded, cross-fitted inside the training half so that no training row sees its own outcome in its own encoding.

The usual interval for such an increment resamples test rows with the fitted models held fixed. It excludes training-sample variability, model-selection

variability, encoder variability, split uncertainty and the temporal dependence between cases, and a design sweep is not a substitute for it: specification sensitivity and sampling uncertainty answer different questions.

Every interval in this paper is instead a *nested moving-block bootstrap*. One draw resamples the training half by moving blocks (Künsch, 1989) of length $\lceil n^{1/3} \rceil$, refits every arm of every rung under every learner and every quality mechanism on that resample, and evaluates on a moving-block resample of the test half. Encoders, frequency tables, target encodings, register frequency rankings and calibrators are rebuilt inside the draw. On the simulation of Section 9, where the truth is known by enumeration, the fixed-model interval covers its own estimand a median 92.1% of the time across the worlds and the nested basic interval 93.0%. Every log is also reported under rolling-origin validation — five expanding-window folds — beside the single temporal holdout, and the split is an axis of the decomposition rather than a robustness paragraph.

*S3.3. The four interval objects, and what each ranges over*

*The family must be the family.* Within-cell bands, each covering five members, do not cover the several hundred cells a surface-level label ranges over. Four interval objects are therefore declared, and every table says which it prints: POINTWISE, the per-cell interval, with no multiplicity control; WITHIN-INSTRUMENT, max-$t$ over the scalar instruments at one cell, reported only so that the cost of the wider family is visible; WHOLE-SURFACE, max-$t$ over *every* scalar cell of the pair's inference family — a median 16.7% of its admissible scalar cells — which is the only family a surface-level claim may use; and DECISION-CURVE, max-$t$ over the pair's declared decision-curve family, 248 cells on the case study's, declared separately because net benefit and a scalar instrument are not the same scale. The last two are the registered families. The whole-surface family has a median 180 members against the five of the within-instrument family, and its median critical value is 5.03 against 2.37 and the pointwise 1.96.

Family control is **per log–target pair**: every cross-pair statement in this paper is descriptive, and none is a simultaneous inferential claim over the corpus. A replicate is dropped from a family when a resample leaves one of its cells without outcome variation, because a maximum over a moving set is not a maximum; `results/s48w_incomplete.csv` names the 0 families where that happens, and on the surface this paper reports it is empty.

*S3.4. The planned contrasts, and where a p-value and an interval disagree*
*A one-sided p-value and a two-sided basic interval disagree on PC3, and the interval decides.* PC3's one-sided $p$ is 0.00100 (Holm-adjusted 0.00250) and its two-sided basic interval, [−0.00059, +0.01210], contains zero. Both come from the same 2,000 draws. The $p$-value says where those draws lie — their central ninety-five per cent runs +0.00327 to +0.01596, entirely above zero — while the interval says where the *estimand* lies, obtained by pivoting that distribution about the estimate; the draws sit 0.00193 AUC *above* the estimate, the upward shift Section 4.1 diagnoses, so pivoting moves the interval down by twice that shift and its lower limit crosses zero even though almost no draw does. **A contrast is called resolved only when the interval says so**, and PC3 is not resolved on any of the four cohort-and-target combinations Section 7.1 reports. Every other comparison here is *exploratory*, labelled as such where it appears, and carries no multiplicity correction, because none would be meaningful over a surface enumerated in full.

*S3.5. The two estimates of the critical value, and how they differ*
*And the two estimates of the same critical value disagree, in the direction that matters.* The precision argument above is an argument about variance, and the two estimators differ by more than variance. On 19 of the 19 whole-surface families, and on *every* one of the 19 decision-curve families, the multiplier value lies below the entire order-statistic interval of the empirical quantile: the median ratio $q_{\mathrm{emp}}/q$ is 1.50 on the surface families and 2.68 on the decision-curve ones, whose medians are 3.90 against 10.45. The direction is anti-conservative — a band built on the smaller value resolves cells the observed maxima do not — and the mechanism is visible in the draws. A Gaussian multiplier reproduces the empirical *covariance* of the standardised draws and therefore only the excursions a Gaussian process makes. These draws are heavy-tailed — Section 9.2 measures how, and finds that the word covers two different mechanisms on the two families — and the asymptotics the construction rests on are asked to hold at 400 draws over families of 180 cells.

Which of the two is right is a measurement, and Section 9.2 makes it: on the family matched to this design the empirical quantile attains its nominal level and the multiplier does not, at any draw budget. The empirical quantile is therefore the operative critical value, and both are reported: over the whole-surface families the multiplier band would resolve 890 cells against the empirical band's 698; over the decision-curve families, 2,602 against 672,

the larger exposure, partly carried by cells that are zero by arithmetic (Supplement S9.6) and excluded from a family by the rule Section 8.2 declares. Section 6.3 carries the surface counts under both and Section 8.2 the decision-curve ones.

*S3.6. The measure the decomposition is taken under*

*The measure the decomposition is taken under.* A variance decomposition is taken with respect to a distribution over specifications, and *uniform over the cells I happened to enumerate* is a choice rather than a neutral default: it moves if an analyst adds a pipeline, writes five folds as five levels, or refines a threshold grid. Axis weights are therefore separated from within-axis level weights and every quantity is reported under declared measures (Table S26): EQUAL-LEVEL, every level of every axis equally likely; REFERENCE, half the mass on the reference level of each axis; CONCENTRATED, four fifths on it; and an ENVELOPE over Dirichlet draws of the level weights. Two invariance properties are executed rather than asserted: duplicating a level with its weight split leaves every component unchanged, to $1.1 \times 10^{-16}$, and refining the operating-point grid under the same underlying continuous measure moves the threshold index by 0.004.

Indices are estimated quantities: the whole decomposition is recomputed inside every draw the inference surface supplies, corpus-level medians are bootstrapped with the pair as the resampling unit, and no axis is called dominant where the intervals overlap. They are computed within each instrument, in its own units, which is the primary analysis, and on the *headroom* scale $V_s/(1 - m(B))$, which is comparable across instruments and lets the metric enter as an axis. The second is a sensitivity analysis rather than a uniquely meaningful decomposition, because of the following.

**Proposition S1** (The decomposition inherits the metric's scale)**.** *Let $\phi$ be strictly increasing with $\phi(0) = 0$. The first-order sensitivity indices of $V$ and of $\phi(V)$ over the same design need not agree, and there exist designs and $\phi$ under which one axis has the larger index on one scale and a different axis on the other.*

The $3 \times 3$ construction is in Supplement S2. This is the same phenomenon as Remark 1 one level up: just as the reduction is not identified without the metric, "which choice matters most" is not identified without the scale on which the increment is expressed, so the manuscript never says an axis dominates without naming it.

*S3.7. Why refitting inside the draw breaks the percentile interval*

*Refitting inside the draw breaks the percentile interval.* **The mechanism below is the *multinomial* resample's, and Section 4.1 retracts it as an explanation of the displacement**: drawing weights per block removes the level loss entirely and the displacement barely moves, so what follows is the reason the *percentile* interval is not used, and not a diagnosis of the residual displacement, which this paper reports as unexplained. A multinomial resample contains about $1 - e^{-1}$ of the distinct levels of a high-cardinality categorical, so with 3,019 register levels every refit inside every draw sees a sparser register than the real training half and returns a smaller increment. The bootstrap distribution is then displaced relative to the estimate, and a percentile interval taken from a displaced distribution is a correct interval for the wrong quantity: it misses no matter how wide it is. On this corpus the displacement is small — negative in 56% of cells, by a median -0.0001 AUC — but it bites in the regime the mechanism predicts: on the sparse world of Section 9 the percentile interval covers 37.2% against a nominal 95%, *worse* than the fixed-model interval refitting was meant to improve on. Every interval here is therefore the *basic* (pivotal) interval $[\,2\hat{V} - q_{1-\alpha/2},\ 2\hat{V} - q_{\alpha/2}\,]$ (Davison and Hinkley, 1997), which pivots the displacement out; simultaneous bands are recentred by the same shift, which is a property of the draws and so corrects a whole family at once (Table S37, and Supplement S6 for the diagnosis).

*S3.8. The two resampling schemes, compared on one design*

Two moving-block schemes were run over one design, at one draw count, with one set of seeds, on 24,624 cells: the multinomial resample, which holds a subset of the blocks, and the weighted one, which draws Dirichlet weights per moving block so that every row has positive weight in every draw and every register level is present in every refit. **Every band the article reports is the weighted one**; the multinomial arm appears only here, as the thing compared against. Section 4.1 carries the two findings; this section carries the whole comparison.

**The mechanism is removed completely.** The share of the register's training levels a draw actually contains rises from 80.8% under multinomial resampling, 60.2% at worst, to 100% under weights, where it is one by construction. **And with it goes the starkest consequence**: under the multinomial scheme a draw can drop an arm *entirely*, so the cell is absent rather than noisy, the median down its column is undefined, and the cell gets no

band at all. Such a cell is not resolved — so it was counted as *unresolved*, beside cells that were banded and straddled zero, inside the denominator of every statement about how little the data resolve. Under weights there are 0; the multinomial arm run on the same design at the same draw count carries 270 such cells of 3,420.

**The symptom, however, survives the removal of its supposed cause.** A pivotal interval need not contain the estimate it is built from: pivoting moves the interval by twice the displacement, and where the displacement exceeds the interval's own half-width both endpoints land on the same side of $\hat{V}$. That is a property of a pivotal interval under bias rather than an error, but it is not what a reader expects of a band, so it is counted — and it falls from 965 cells (3.9%) to 322 (1.3%), which is better and is not zero. The displacement's own median barely moves, 0.0050 to 0.0041.

**Level loss is therefore not the main cause of the displacement.** Removing it entirely leaves most of the displacement standing, and this paper does not know what the remainder is. Section 10 carries that rather than a claim that the scheme is now unbiased. **The comparison is also not symmetric, and it leans the way that flatters the old scheme**: where a draw is missing, the band construction refuses the cell while the comparison drops the missing draws and computes from the rest, so every multinomial number above is conditioned on the draws in which the arm could be fitted — and those cells carry roughly twice the displacement of the others. Both multinomial numbers above are therefore measured on that scheme's successes, and both are still the larger of the pair.

**Under the multinomial scheme it gets worse with the sample size, not better.** That displacement is a bias — a multinomial resample holds about $1 - e^{-1}$ of the distinct levels however many rows it has — so at a fixed ratio it does not shrink with $n$ while the half-width shrinks like $n^{-1/2}$. Section 9.1 locates the crossing: at a ratio of 0.125 the interval straddles its own estimate in every replicate up to 8,000 training rows and in only 1.6% of them by 50,000. This corpus reaches a ratio of 0.324 at its highest pair and 10 of 19 sit above a tenth, so it has pairs in that regime. **The argument does not carry to the bands reported here.** Weights remove the mechanism it rests on, and a displacement survives them anyway (above), so what remains under the reported scheme is not bounded by this reasoning and is not explained by it. Section 10 carries it as an open defect rather than a controlled one.

| log | target | level | levels from coarse | cardinality | n | n test | base auc | auc | gain over base |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Helpdesk | duration | service_type | 0 | 3 | 4580 | 1374 | 0.629 | 0.629 | 0.001 |
| Helpdesk | duration | support_section | 1 | 7 | 4580 | 1374 | 0.629 | 0.629 | 0.000 |
| Helpdesk | duration | product | 2 | 21 | 4580 | 1374 | 0.629 | 0.638 | 0.009 |
| Helpdesk | duration | product marginal over support_section | −1 | 21 | 4580 | 1374 | 0.629 | 0.638 | 0.009 |
| BPIC19 | duration | case:Spend area text | 0 | 20 | 248445 | 74534 | 0.619 | 0.620 | 0.000 |
| BPIC19 | duration | case:Vendor | 1 | 1944 | 248445 | 74534 | 0.619 | 0.672 | 0.052 |
| BPIC19 | duration | case:Item Category | 2 | 4 | 248445 | 74534 | 0.619 | 0.620 | 0.000 |
| BPIC19 | duration | case:Item | 3 | 490 | 248445 | 74534 | 0.619 | 0.621 | 0.002 |
| BPIC19 | duration | case:Item marginal over case:Item Category | −1 | 490 | 248445 | 74534 | 0.620 | 0.621 | 0.002 |
| BPIC14 | handover | CI Type (aff) | 0 | 13 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.641 | 0.775 | 0.134 |
| BPIC14 | handover | CI Subtype (aff) | 1 | 65 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.641 | 0.804 | 0.163 |
| BPIC14 | handover | CI Name (aff) | 2 | 3019 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.641 | 0.898 | 0.257 |
| BPIC14 | handover | CI Name (aff) marginal over CI Subtype (aff) | −1 | 3019 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.804 | 0.913 | 0.109 |
| BPIC14 | duration | CI Type (aff) | 0 | 13 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.618 | 0.662 | 0.045 |
| BPIC14 | duration | CI Subtype (aff) | 1 | 65 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.618 | 0.662 | 0.045 |
| BPIC14 | duration | CI Name (aff) | 2 | 3019 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.618 | 0.747 | 0.129 |
| BPIC14 | duration | CI Name (aff) marginal over CI Subtype (aff) | −1 | 3019 | 46606 | 13982 | 0.662 | 0.749 | 0.087 |

Table S1: The increment of each layer of the register over the same baseline, on the log–target pairs the registered rules of Section 5 admit. 9 rows on excluded pairs are not printed. *Columns.* levels from coarse is the layer's depth, counting from the coarsest layer at 0 inward; the value −1 is not a depth but marks the *marginal* row, which adds the finest layer on top of the second finest. base auc is the AUC of the model this row is measured against — the intake block $B_0$ with every register layer removed on a layer row, and $B_0$ together with the second-finest layer on the marginal row. auc is the AUC of that same model with this row's layer added, and gain over base is the difference of the two. Because the marginal row's baseline is not $B_0$, its gain is not comparable with the rows above it and is not meant to be: it answers what the finest layer is worth once the coarser one is already in the model.

## S4. Which layer of the register pays

A register has layers. The affected configuration item is the finest; its type, its subtype and the service component it belongs to are deterministic coarsenings, and a buyer choosing how much of a register to populate is choosing between them. The registered rules give coarsenings their own role (S1, amendment 4) so that this question can be asked without the coarsenings contaminating the intake block.

*Which cell the ladder is on, and why it does not reconcile with the decision-time table.* Section 7.4 reports the item as worth +0.257 AUC over the intake block and Table 8 reports +0.1838 over the same block, and a reader who tries to reconcile the two cannot, because they are different cells. This ladder is computed on the *registered* cohort of Section 5 — 46,606 cases, 13,982 in test — under the registered handover rule, one-hot logistic regression at the fixed temporal holdout, against the intake block at base AUC 0.641 on the handover question and 0.618 on duration. Table 8 is on the estate's own cohort and its reassignment target, which is neither of the two targets this

ladder is computed on. Section 7.1 is the reason the two differ: they are the two analyses whose answers about this register disagree, and neither number is the other one mismeasured. What the ladder compares is layers *against each other* at one cell, which is the comparison a programme is choosing among, and that comparison is unaffected by which of the two cohorts it is made on.

Table S1 reports the increment of each layer over the same baseline, and of the item over each layer. **Which layer pays is a property of the target and of the log, and not of the register.** On the case study's estate the coarse layers are *not* close to free: the item's type alone reaches 52% of what the item is worth over the intake block on the handover question and 35% on the duration question (Section 7.4), and what survives as a claim about the finest layer is its *marginal* contribution over the coarse ones — +0.109 and +0.087 AUC. On the two other logs in the table the opposite holds: every coarse layer is worth essentially nothing — at most +0.001 on Helpdesk and −0.002 on BPIC19 — while the finest is worth +0.009 and +0.050. **So a programme cannot read a layer policy off another estate's ladder**, which is the same conclusion this paper reaches about the increment itself, one level down. None of it transfers to any other task and none is claimed to.

## S5. Rolling-origin results, per fold

The single temporal holdout is one split. Table S2 reports the increment at the reference cell under each of the five expanding-origin folds, per log–target pair, so that a reader can see how much of the holdout's answer is the holdout's.

The split axis carries a median 18.9% of the variance in the increment (Table S8) — the largest of the four first-order indices on this corpus, which is worth stating because the split is the axis an evaluation paper is most likely to fix without comment. Reporting a single holdout is therefore not enough, and where a fold disagrees with the holdout in sign the pair's region label in Table 4 reflects it.

| log | target | rolling1 | rolling2 | rolling3 | rolling4 | rolling5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | −0.019 | −0.011 | −0.024 | −0.012 | 0.015 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.001 | 0.027 | 0.051 | 0.030 | 0.007 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.030 | 0.038 | 0.049 | 0.032 | 0.032 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.076 | 0.100 | 0.083 | 0.109 | 0.112 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.092 | 0.121 | 0.152 | 0.155 | 0.141 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.034 | 0.030 | −0.020 | −0.018 | 0.008 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.001 | 0.010 | 0.001 | 0.005 | 0.004 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.166 | 0.033 | 0.050 | 0.031 | 0.026 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 0.031 | 0.020 | 0.037 | −0.023 | 0.007 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | −0.040 | −0.004 | −0.004 | 0.031 | 0.023 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.000 | −0.018 | 0.000 | −0.032 | 0.038 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.050 | 0.052 | 0.024 | 0.026 | 0.052 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.003 | 0.002 | 0.005 | 0.010 | −0.007 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.044 | 0.053 | 0.059 | 0.018 | −0.004 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 0.003 | −0.004 | 0.016 | −0.039 | 0.000 |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.024 | 0.010 | 0.021 | 0.033 | 0.041 |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.130 | 0.159 | 0.154 | 0.129 | 0.186 |
| UCI498 | duration | −0.007 | −0.011 | −0.008 | −0.006 | −0.010 |
| UCI498 | handover | 0.003 | −0.003 | 0.001 | −0.003 | −0.005 |

Table S2: The increment at the reference cell under each rolling-origin fold.

## S6. The noisy world, and two explanations that were wrong

The simulation of Section 9 reports that every interval construction fails on the noisy world: coverage 7.0% against a nominal 95%, with the estimator sitting $-0.0353$ below $V_{\text{limit}}$ and a mean interval width of 0.0367. A gap the size of the whole interval is not something a resampling scheme repairs, and the natural write-up was that the estimator is biased in that world and the interval inherits the bias.

That write-up would have been wrong, and the two experiments below are what stopped it. Both were designed so that either could refute the bias reading, and both did.

*The gap against sample size.* A finite-sample bias closes as $n$ grows. The increment was estimated at six sample sizes from 2,000 to 64,000 in every world, at 30 replicates each, with the penalty held fixed. The sparse world behaves as a finite-sample gap must: $+0.0118$ at $n = 4{,}000$ falling to $+0.0006$

at 64,000. The noisy world does not: +0.0361 at $n = 4{,}000$ and still +0.0329 at 64,000. The sparse world is the control that makes the noisy result mean something — without it, "the gap did not close" could be a statement about the experiment rather than about the world.

*The gap against the penalty.* A fixed $L_2$ penalty is not scale-free, so it can masquerade as bias: it shrinks coefficients materially at $n = 4{,}000$ and barely at $n = 120{,}000$, which would make a large-sample fit a different specification rather than the same one at its limit. Holding $n$ at 4,000 and weakening the penalty by five orders of magnitude moves the noisy world's gap from +0.0361 to +0.0362 — that is, not at all.

*What was actually wrong.* Neither explanation surviving is what sent us to examine the target rather than the estimator, and the target was wrong. The simulation enumerated the generator's cells, carrying the *true* register value, while in the noisy world the estimator only ever sees a value that is replaced by a uniform draw with probability 20%. Both estimands were therefore computed on a population the estimator does not sample from. Marginalising the noise exactly (Section 9) moves $V_{\text{limit}}$ from +0.1135 to +0.0804. The estimator's mean was +0.0781 throughout. There was no bias; there was a wrong estimand in our own simulation, and it took two arms of evidence against everything else to find it.

*The same two experiments, after the correction.* Both arms were re-run against the corrected target, and there is nothing left for them to explain: the noisy world's gap is +0.0025 at $n = 4{,}000$ and −0.0007 at 64,000. The sparse world's gap is unchanged in both runs, because the correction touches only the noisy world, which is what makes it a control rather than a coincidence. Coverage on the noisy world is 94.8%. `scripts/s18_bias_scaling.py --legacy-target` regenerates the pre-correction figures above, so the evidence for this appendix is reproducible rather than quoted from a log we happen to have kept.

The general lesson is the one this paper makes elsewhere about the design space: a quantity is defined relative to a declared population, and a simulation's population is a declaration like any other. A quality mechanism that acts on the data — which is exactly what the register-quality axis of Section 3 does on real logs — changes what the estimand is, not merely how well it is estimated. The register-quality results of Section 7.3 are reported

| world | fixed-model, basic | fixed-model, percentile | nested, basic | nested, bias-corrected | nested, percentile | MC half-width |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| drift | 0.935 | 0.915 | 0.910 | 0.915 | 0.975 | 0.030 |
| imbalanced | 0.910 | 0.910 | 0.935 | 0.950 | 0.940 | 0.030 |
| linear | 0.920 | 0.900 | 0.915 | 0.915 | 0.945 | 0.030 |
| noisy | 0.930 | 0.930 | 0.920 | 0.925 | 0.920 | 0.030 |
| nonlinear | 0.935 | 0.925 | 0.935 | 0.940 | 0.950 | 0.030 |
| sparse | 0.660 | 0.635 | 0.925 | 0.675 | 0.420 | 0.030 |

Table S3: Simulation: coverage of the estimator's own limit at the nominal 95%, by world, for the fixed-model and the nested bootstrap under the percentile, basic and bias-corrected constructions. The nested percentile interval is the one that fails, on the sparse world, and the basic construction is the repair; the bias-corrected percentile is not. The last column is the Monte Carlo half-width of every coverage in the row at this replicate count, so a reader can see which differences the simulation resolves. The oracle rows are in results/s10_coverage.csv.

against the degraded register for that reason, and the correction register in the archive records this as the round's largest error of its class.

*The two estimands, and the marginalisation*

Two estimands are separated, because under misspecification they are not the same. $V_{\text{oracle}}$ is the increment between the two Bayes-optimal scoring rules — what the register is worth in the world. $V_{\text{limit}}$ is the increment between the two fitted pipelines' limits — what the estimator estimates. A resampling interval can only cover the second, and reporting its coverage of the first as though it were the estimator's coverage is precisely the error the earlier simulation made. Both are reported in Table S3, which is the 200-replicate run this diagnosis was made on. Table S37 is the 1000-replicate run every coverage number in the main text comes from; the two agree on every qualitative statement in this appendix, and the diagnosis is reported against the run that produced it rather than restated against a later one.

*The truth has to be the truth the estimator sees.* Both estimands are computed by enumerating cells, and in the noisy world the cells the generator writes down are not the cells the estimator observes: a register value is replaced by a uniform draw with probability 20%, so the observed cell $(b, g, j)$ is a mixture over the true ones, with mass and outcome rate

$$w(b,g,j) \;=\; \sum_f \Pr(b,g,f)\;\Pr(j \mid f),$$

$$\Pr(y{=}1 \mid b,g,j) \;=\; \frac{1}{w(b,g,j)} \sum_f \Pr(b,g,f)\;\Pr(j \mid f)\,p(b,g,f),$$

where $\Pr(j \mid f) = (1 - r)\mathbf{1}\{j = f\} + r/K$. Enumerating the *true* cells instead scores the estimator against a population it never samples from, and the first version of this simulation did exactly that: it reported a coverage of 7.0% on the noisy world and a bias of $-0.0353$ that did not exist. The two experiments above refuted every finite-sample explanation for that apparent bias and thereby sent us to look at the target. The marginalisation is checked against a Monte Carlo sample, on standardised residuals, at the start of every simulation run.

*S6.1. The six simulated worlds and the two estimands*

A simulation that fits a logistic data-generating process with logistic regression tests an unusually favourable arrangement. This one uses six worlds — four of them misspecified for the estimator — at 1,000 replicates each. The covariate space is finite, so the joint distribution of cell and outcome is enumerated and the population AUC of any scoring rule is computed in closed form rather than simulated. The worlds are a logistic surface, a nonlinear one with an interaction and a threshold the logistic model cannot see, a drifting one, a sparse register with 200 levels, an imbalanced outcome at prevalence 0.02, and a noisy register in which a share of values are wrong.

Two estimands are separated because under misspecification they differ. $V_{\text{oracle}}$ is the increment between the two Bayes-optimal scoring rules — what the register is worth in the world. $V_{\text{limit}}$ is the increment between the two fitted pipelines' limits — what the estimator estimates. A resampling interval can only cover the second, and reporting its coverage of the first as though it were the estimator's coverage is a category error. Both are reported in Table S37. Where a register value is corrupted the cells the generator writes down are not the cells the estimator observes, so the truth has to be marginalised over the corruption; the two experiments that found that, and the check that guards it, are the subject of this section.

*S6.2. Where the refit helps, and where the percentile interval fails*

**Where the refit helps.** The nested basic interval covers at least as well as the fixed-model percentile interval on 6 of the 6 worlds, and its median across them is 93.0% against the fixed-model interval's 92.1%. Both fall a little short of nominal on most worlds, by more than the Monte Carlo resolution.

**Where the percentile interval fails, and why.** On the sparse world it collapses to 37.2%, and the *nested* percentile interval is worse there than

the fixed-model one. The cause is Section 4.1: a bootstrap training resample holds about 63% of the distinct register levels, so every refit sees a sparser register and the bootstrap distribution shifts below the estimate. The basic interval pivots that shift out and restores coverage — 89.9% — and costs nothing where there was nothing to repair, at a median 93.0% and a minimum 89.9% across all six worlds. The bias-corrected percentile does *not* repair the sparse world (63.1%), which is why every interval and band in this paper uses the basic construction. The $m$-out-of-$n$ subsampling interval, the standard alternative in exactly this regime, does not win either: 72.8% on the sparse world and a median 75.8% across the 3 worlds it was priced on.

## S7. The worked example on UCI Adult

The standard is not about event logs and not about configuration databases, and the quickest way to show that is to run it on something else. UCI Adult (Census Income) predicts whether a person's income exceeds a threshold from 30,162 records. Suppose an analyst wants to report what `occupation` is worth. It is the expensive field: a survey has to ask about it and code it, where age, sex, race and country come with the sampling frame and education comes with an enrolment record.

Worth compared with what? Against the frame alone, against the frame plus education, or against the frame plus education plus hours worked. Measured how, at which operating point, and with the register how complete. Over the resulting 480 cells the reduction runs 0.200 to 0.947. The baseline axis and the metric axis carry the same first-order share of the variance in the increment to three figures — 25.9% and 25.9% — against 7.2% for the register population, and a one-number report misstates the sign for a mean 24.9% of the other cells. That the two lead axes tie is a property of this dataset and not a general one; it is the sort of thing a surface reports and a single number cannot.

`examples/worked_example.py` produces all of it in 121 statements against the package's public interface, and ends by calling `float()` on the surface so a reader can see what the refusal looks like.

## S8. The verification harness

Every number in the manuscript is a macro, defined in the generated file `paper/numbers.tex` that `scripts/make_numbers.py` writes from `results/*.csv`. The manuscript contains no numeric literal outside that file

and the generated tables. A number therefore cannot disagree between the abstract, a table and the conclusion: there is one of it.

That removes one class of defect and creates another — a wrong generator makes the whole manuscript wrong *consistently*, and nothing looks odd — so the architecture comes with seven controls.

**The generator.** `make_numbers.py` emits a visible **??** for any macro whose source file is absent, and `--strict` exits non-zero if one remains. A partial build is therefore visibly partial and cannot silently drop a claim.

**The verifier.** `scripts/verify_numbers.py` re-derives each checked macro from the result file with code written against the *definition* rather than against the generator, and compares. It also enforces 25 consistency conditions that no single macro expresses — relations that must hold between numbers even when each of them is individually correct. Among them: that every register-quality mechanism passed its executed train-only check; that no surface is labelled uniformly beneficial while carrying an unresolved cell, nor conditionally harmful while carrying a beneficial one; that every region label is one of the six the manuscript defines and that the labels partition the pairs; that Remark 1's sweep still holds the AUC reduction at zero; that the disjoint functional-ANOVA components sum to one on every decomposition; that no planned contrast reports a $p$-value the draw count cannot produce, and that its Holm adjustment reproduces from the raw values; that no rank-based instrument's reduction moves under a monotone recalibration, and that every certificate for a non-rank-based one exhibits two ratios that actually differ; that the cells a region label ranges over are exactly the cells the simultaneous family that licenses it controls, and that every decision rule is compared over the declared regret population rather than over whatever the file happened to hold; that the case study's split partitions its cohort; and that the adjudicated set of the practice pilot is exactly the screened-in set. The partition condition is the one that catches a region label the analysis emits and the manuscript does not define, which is how it was found.

**The corruption suite.** `scripts/s13_attack_numbers.py` is the verifier's own regression suite. It corrupts one thing at a time — a value in a result file, a value in `numbers.tex`, a deleted macro, a train-only check

flipped, a region label made inconsistent with its counts, an adjudication file made inconsistent with the coding file — and requires the verifier to notice. Every corruption is applied to a copy in a temporary directory; the suite refuses to start if a previous run left its lock behind, because in an earlier round a corruption suite was killed mid-flight and a corrupted manuscript reached a commit.

A corruption of a *result* file is checked by regenerating the macros from the corrupted copy and then verifying, which is the only version of that test that means anything: without the regeneration the suite asks the verifier about a `numbers.tex` built from clean results, so any quantity the verifier re-derives from a different file than the generator reads is untouched and the corruption passes. One corruption did exactly that, silently, for a round.

**The condition on the set, not on the number.** Every check above compares one macro with one source file, and a whole class of defect passes all of them: two macros, each perfectly consistent with its own source, that the prose calls by the same name. That is not hypothetical. It is how a case study's increment came to be printed with two values and two signs, and no check in this repository could have seen it.

The repair is a declaration rather than a computation. The verifier `round21_verify.py` carries an ESTIMANDS table: one entry per quantity a reader would name in one phrase, listing the macros that may hold it. Two members of an entry that disagree is a failure; a quantity that legitimately takes two values under two specifications gets two entries with different names, and the manuscript must then use those names. Corruption `G1` in the suite is the test: it moves a value in one result file and lets both the generator and the verifier read the moved value, so every macro-against-source check passes and only the condition on the set fails. **Write the check on the name, not on the number.**

**The provenance record.** `results/provenance.json` holds the SHA-256 of every analysis script at the moment its outputs were last accepted, with a note saying why, and `make_numbers.py --strict` refuses to certify a manuscript whose numbers come from a script that has changed since. This exists because `--strict` used to pass on a build reading

a two-replicate smoke test that had been run under the wrong seed and against an estimand corrected an hour later: every macro resolved cleanly, to a wrong number. A missing file is loud, and a stale one is silent. Modification time cannot answer the question — changing a script's output format does not make its numbers wrong — so acceptance is a deliberate act with a recorded reason.

**The compliance linter.** `scripts/texlint.py` carries 17 checks: the abstract length, the keyword count, the highlight lengths against their own stated counts, the presence of all five required statements, the absence of any numeric literal in the prose, the absence of a declared set of rhetorical sentence-openers, that every `\input` target exists, that a spelled-out count matches the list it introduces — whether that list is a run of identifiers or a `description` environment — and that no manuscript part, generated table or analysis script carries a stray control character.

Seven of them exist because each caught a defect that had already reached a compiled PDF of *this* manuscript: a spelled-out count that did not match the list it introduced; the word *Appendix* written before a reference that already supplies it, on every appendix reference at once; a macro swallowing the space after it and printing `42.0%--- and`; a macro carrying words quoted inside math mode and printing `18percentagepoints`; a sentence's tail left behind by a scripted edit and printed twice; a *backslash escape interpreted by a scripted edit*, which had written `\ref{x}` into the file as a carriage return followed by `ef{x}` and `\nMacro` as a newline followed by `nMacro`; and a spelled-out count introducing a `description` list of a different length — which is the first defect in the form the first check could not see, and which was in the paragraph above this one, announcing five controls before listing six. Those print as garbage or as a wrong word, produce no wrong number, and every checker in this repository passed on the build that carried them. Each signature is exact — a carriage return that is not a line ending, a line beginning with the tail of a control word, a numeral word whose list is a different length — so each is now a check rather than a thing to remember. All seven were found by *reading the rendered pages*, which is the check no file in this repository replaces.

**The claim registry.** `scripts/claim_registry.py` writes one row per

macro: its value, every manuscript location that uses it, the generator file and *line* that defined it — captured from the calling frame, so it cannot drift — the result file that line reads, and whether the verifier re-derives it independently. Because the manuscript contains no numeric literals, the registry is exhaustive by construction: any number a reader can see is a macro, and every macro is a row. `--check` fails a build in which a macro the manuscript uses is unresolved.

The registry also answers the question a reader should ask of the paragraph above: *how many* macros are independently re-derived, not merely how many could be. Its summary row counts them, separately for the *headline* macros — the ones the abstract, the introduction and the conclusion print — and the count is deliberately not quoted here, because it is a property of a build and belongs in the file rather than in a sentence. It is not all of them, and the ones it is not are visible in the same file. Writing the missing re-derivations is also how the largest arithmetic error in the register was found: a range taken over four rows of a table, three of which are corpus medians and one of which is a single pair.

*What the harness does not do.* It guards numbers thoroughly and prose only where a guard was written by hand. The correction register in the archive groups this project's own errors by class, and its largest class is sentences in which every printed number was correct and the relation asserted between them was not. The generated-macro discipline makes one sub-class of that structurally impossible — the same quantity printed differently in two places — and does nothing about the rest. Holes have been found in this project's checkers in every round including this one — a corruption that passed because nothing regenerated between it and the check, a strict mode that certified a manuscript built from a superseded run, a compliance rule that reads digits and not words — and every one of them was found by a corruption suite, by a provenance record, or by reading the output, never by the checker itself.

The clearest limit is Class G of the register: a quantity computed correctly, printed correctly, and consistent everywhere it appears, while the *definition* it refers to is not the one the estimator addresses (S6). Every guard described above passes such a manuscript, and would have passed it silently. What caught it was constructing two experiments that could each have confirmed the comfortable reading and having both refuse to. No checker in this repository would have done that on its own.

*S8.1. The inference surface, the draw counts and the pipeline axis*

*The inference surface is smaller than the declared surface, and the grid is not uniform across the corpus.* Every point estimate comes from the full declared space; every *band* comes from the inference surface, a median 16.7% of each pair's admissible surface. It is a subset of the declared surface cell for cell and the share of positive cells differs between them by a median 0.060, but a study with compute to spare should equate the two. The same budget shows in two further places. Every family is declared at 400 draws and every family is effective at 400: a replicate that leaves any cell of a family without outcome variation is dropped from that family, and under the weighted scheme no replicate is dropped on any family. The accounting is kept rather than removed, because what it now establishes is that the gap it was built to measure is empty — a distinction a reader cannot draw from its absence. And the pipeline axis carries four levels on the case study's log and two or three elsewhere, by a rule declared on row count before the runs, so a sensitivity index computed on one pair is not strictly comparable with one computed on another.

## S9. The coverage calibration

This section derives a widening calibrated at the pair's own ratio of register cardinality to training row count. **The article reports it as a sensitivity and does not apply it.** The factor is fitted to restore *pointwise* coverage on the $(n, K)$ plane of Section 9.1: it addresses the channel the family-wise measurement of Section 9.2 switches off — the interval underneath the band, which is governed by $K/n$ — and not the critical value, which that measurement settles. It is fitted pointwise and applied simultaneously, its transfer from simulated worlds to real logs is an assumption, and it is measurably misspecified in $n$ (below); the construction is given in full so that a reader can see what applying it would cost, and the sensitivity of every downstream count to it is reported.

*S9.1. The inflation factor has a closed form*

Write the basic interval of Section 4.1 as $[\hat{V} - L,\, \hat{V} + U]$. Inflated by a factor $c$ it becomes $[\hat{V} - cL,\, \hat{V} + cU]$, and it covers the truth $\vartheta$ exactly when

$$c \;\geq\; \max\left\{ \frac{\hat{V} - \vartheta}{L},\; \frac{\vartheta - \hat{V}}{U} \right\}.$$

The smallest $c$ attaining nominal coverage at level $1-\alpha$ over a set of replicates is therefore the $(1-\alpha)$ quantile of that ratio across them, and its Monte Carlo interval comes from the same order statistics. No search over candidate factors is needed, and the estimate inherits the replicate count directly: the plane carries 29 cells at 500 replicates each, over $K/n$ from 0.0011 to 0.500, on two data-generating worlds rather than one (Table S41).

*S9.2. A monotone fit, not a parametric one*

The dependence of $c$ on $K/n$ is well summarised by a log-linear fit whose slope is 0.102, with a standard error of 0.005: the widening a pair needs grows with its register's cardinality relative to its training set, as the mechanism of Section 4.1 predicts. That fit is quoted because it is the interpretable summary, but it is *not* the curve the construction settles on. The parametric fit sits below the measured factor at the smallest ratios, and using it would under-correct exactly the pairs whose bands are narrowest — the pairs where an anti-conservative band does the most damage. The curve carried forward is therefore an isotonic regression through the measured factors, which is monotone by construction and interpolates the measurements rather than smoothing through them. Table S41 prints the two curves side by side.

*Three candidate curves, on the criterion that chose the monotone one.* The widened plane makes $\log n$ a significant term (Section 6.3), so the obvious repair is a two-covariate parametric fit in $\log(K/n)$ and $\log n$. It is not one. On the plane's fitted cells the weighted residual sum of squares is 253 for the ratio-only fit, 185 with $\log n$ added, and 52 for the monotone curve; and on the criterion that matters — how many cells the curve sits below their own measured factor's lower confidence limit, which is the anti-conservative direction — the two parametric fits are alike at 8 and 8 cells against the monotone curve's 2. Adding $n$ to a parametric curve improves the fit and does not improve the object. The monotone curve is retained and its residual in $n$ is reported as a limitation rather than fitted away.

*S9.3. What the calibration does and does not correct*

The factor is estimated on a *pointwise* interval in a simulation and applied to a *simultaneous* band on real logs. It corrects the scale of the studentised statistic, which is the channel the plane identifies. It does not correct a change in the shape of the maximum's distribution, and it assumes that the simulated worlds' dependence on $K/n$ transfers to logs whose dependence

structure and signal are not the simulation's. Because that transfer is an assumption, Section 6.3 reports the corpus counts at three settings — nominal, calibrated, and every factor pushed to the upper end of its own Monte Carlo interval — and Section 10 carries the transfer as a limitation.

*S9.4. The plane's reach in $n$, and where the factor is undefined*

**The factor's reach in $n$, and the two things widening the plane found.** The plane is fitted at training sizes 500 to 180,000 and this corpus runs 735 to 176,213, so all 19 of the 19 pairs lie inside the range the factor is identified on. That is the arrangement a calibration needs, and it is not the end of the matter.

**$K/n$ is not sufficient, and a plane wide enough in $n$ can now show it.** Adding $\log n$ to the fit gives a coefficient of 0.067 at $t = 8.3$: at a fixed ratio the widening a pair needs grows with its sample size. The design that isolates it is the ladder, three ratios held fixed while $n$ moves over two orders of magnitude, and along it the measured factor moves by 0.22 — 2.8 combined Monte Carlo standard errors — while coverage itself moves by 21.7%. The curve is a function of the ratio alone, so it carries that dependence as a residual: it sits below the measured factor's own lower confidence limit on 2 of the plane's cells, by at most 0.18, and both are large-$n$ cells. A two-covariate fit in $\log(K/n)$ and $\log n$ does not repair it — it is worse than the monotone curve on every cell-weighted criterion (Supplement S9.2) — so the residual is reported rather than fitted away.

**And on 4 of the 33 cells the factor does not exist at all.** The inflation factor is a widening *about the point estimate*, and Section 4.1 shows that past a crossing in $n$ the basic interval stops containing the point estimate. Where it does, there is no widening about $\hat{V}$ that attains nominal coverage and the quantity this calibration estimates is undefined. All 4 such cells are at 50,000 training rows or more. The admission rule — a cell enters the plane when the interval straddles its estimate in at least 0.90 of replicates — decides nothing: the rejected cells reach 0.078 and the admitted ones start at 0.976, so any threshold between those two gives this plane. Section 10 carries what that leaves the corpus's largest pairs.

Under the band the article reports — the empirical critical value, no widening applied — the region counts, the labels Definition 3 yields with the minimum resolved share included, which are the ones Table 4 prints, are: conditionally beneficial, 5; sign-changing, 2; conditionally harmful, 0; uniformly beneficial, 1; unresolved, 11; and the median robustness index is

0.000. Before the minimum share is applied the same band gives 6, 2, 2, 1 and 8 in that same order. The minimum share moves 3 of the labels, of which 3 are directions withdrawn and 0 are sign-changing pairs that carried no direction to withdraw (Table 6). Every conditionally harmful label the band reaches — 2 of them, on BPIC15_3/handover; Helpdesk/duration, resting on at most 4 resolved cells of 180 — is among those withdrawn, so under Definition 3 this corpus carries 0 conditionally harmful surfaces.
Had the widening been applied on top of it, the same definition would give 5, 2, 1, 1 and 10 in that order, at a median robustness index of 0.000. That is the column Table S9 prints beside the reported one, and it is what the pointwise channel would cost if its correction transferred from the simulated plane to these logs, which the article treats as an assumption rather than a result.

*S9.5. The $(n, K)$ grid, cell by cell*

**The ratio $K/n$ captures most of the dependence, and not all of it.** Across the plane the basic interval covers a median 83.3% and a minimum 21.3%, the last at a ratio of 0.377. Below $K/n = 0.050$ its coverage lies between 88.7% and 90.7% — short of nominal everywhere, by about two Monte Carlo standard errors at 150 replicates — and it has fallen below three quarters by 0.125. The ratio is the right first-order summary — the mechanism of Section 4.1 is why, and varying $n$ alone would not have exposed the regime the corpus occupies — but it is not sufficient, and the plane says so in two places. The two cells closest to each other in ratio — a register of 200 levels at 2,000 training rows, and one of 1,000 at 8,000 — cover 0.780 and 0.613, a gap of 3.2 combined Monte Carlo standard errors; and holding the register at 1,000 levels while moving the training half from 2,000 rows to 8,000 moves coverage from 0.453 to 0.613, so $n$ carries signal of its own. The calibration of Section 6.3 is a function of the ratio alone and therefore inherits this residual, which Section 10 states.

**Where this corpus sits, and what is done about it.** The median log–target pair here has $K/n = 0.106$, the range runs 0.001 to 0.324, and 10 of 19 pairs are above a tenth. Most of this corpus therefore sits at or beyond the ratio at which coverage starts to fall, and a nominal band on those pairs is *narrower* than a 95% interval should be — the anti-conservative direction, which inflates the count of resolved cells. The plane is dense enough to calibrate against; what it yields is reported here and not applied.

*S9.6. The degenerate decision-curve cells*

**What is wrong with the decision-curve families is not a tail.** At a threshold where both arms treat every case alike the net-benefit difference is zero by arithmetic rather than by estimation, and 638 cells of the corpus's curve families are exactly zero in at least nine draws of ten — up to 14.3% of a single family, against 0 such cells anywhere in the surface families. The admission rule keeps any cell whose spread exceeds a floor in absolute units, so such a cell survives and standardising it by that spread sends its studentised value to the largest value a deviate standardised over $B$ points can take. They are what makes $q_{\text{emp}}$ large on those families: excluding them moves the median ratio $q_{\text{emp}}/q$ from 2.68 to 2.24. It does *not* dissolve the disagreement — $q$ still lies below the empirical interval on 19 of the 19 curve families and 19 of the 19 surface ones once they are gone — and Table S40 reports the regime with and without them because Section 4.3's count of what $q_{\text{emp}}$ resolves is, on those families, partly a count of arithmetic.

*S9.7. The region counts at four calibration settings*

**The counts are reported at four settings, and the ordering is stable across all of them.** Under the multiplier critical value the corpus would resolve 890 cells at a median $\rho$ of 0.039; under the empirical critical value the article reports, at $c = 1$ — no widening — 698 cells at 0.000; under the calibrated factors on top of it, 519 cells at 0.000; and pushing every factor to the upper end of its own Monte Carlo interval, 471 at 0.000. **The second of those four is the one the article reports**: the first is the approximation Section 9.2 measures short of its level, and the calibrated and upper-end rungs are a sensitivity ladder for the pointwise channel, not settings the corpus runs under, because the widening is not applied. What moves across all four is how much resolution the corpus has; what does not move is which pair reaches $\rho = 1$: the count is 1 under the reported band, 1 under the calibrated factors, 1 with every factor at the upper end of its own Monte Carlo interval, and 1 under the multiplier, and it is the same pair every time. Across the corpus 2 region labels change under the widening, and that one is not among them. The transfer from a pointwise interval in a simulation to a simultaneous band on real logs is an assumption, and Section 10 carries it as a limitation.

## S10. A glossary, with the case study's own value for every term

Every term the article uses in a technical sense, with what it means and what it is on the case study's log. The article defines each where it introduces it; this is the lookup.

| term | what it means | on the case study's log |
|---|---|---|
| register $f$ | the recorded field whose worth is in question: high-cardinality, maintained, reused across cases | the affected configuration item |
| free field $g$ | a resource-like field that is recorded anyway and that the register has to beat | the assignment group |
| intake block $B_0$ | what is known when the case arrives, excluding the register and the free field | category, impact, urgency, priority |
| rung | one baseline in the nested ladder $B_0 \subset B_1 \subset \cdots$ the increment is measured against | intake + group + knowledge reference |
| instrument | the scalar metric an increment is read in; five are declared and they are not on a common scale | ROC AUC |
| cell | one complete assignment to every varied axis: a point of the surface | one-hot logistic, holdout, clean register, intake + group, AUC |
| specification surface | the map from cells to increments over a declared design space | the 4,800 cells of Figure 1 |
| declared / computational / inference surface | what is admissible, what was computed, and what carries bootstrap draws — three denominators, audited apart | 29,040, the same, and 3,420 |
| resolved | the cell's simultaneous band excludes zero, so the data determine the sign of that cell's increment | 155 of the 684 AUC cells that carry a band |
| family $\mathcal{F}$ | the set of cells a claim quantifies over, which is what a simultaneous band must cover | a median 180 cells per pair |
| resolution region | the label a surface earns from its resolved cells: uniformly or conditionally beneficial or harmful, sign-changing, unresolved | sign-changing |
| robustness index $\rho$ | (beneficial − harmful) / $\lvert\mathcal{F}\rvert$, always printed with the counts behind it | see Table 6 |
| MPID | the minimal practically important difference, declared before any disagreement is counted | 0.01 AUC |

Table S4: THE VOCABULARY, IN ONE PLACE. Every term this paper uses in a sense a reader could not guess, with the case study's own value for it. The terms are defined again where they are first used; this table exists so that a reader who meets one in Section 6 does not have to find that place.

## S11. Which halves a register-quality mechanism is applied to

A degraded register is a state of the world and not a training accident, so **the mechanism is applied to both halves of the data**: the same values are missing, stale, corrupted or split at fit time and at evaluation time, and the increment measures a model built on a degraded register and deployed against one. What is estimated from the *training half alone* is the mechanism's *parameters* — which values fall in the long tail, which are common, the frequency table a corruption draws from, the set of identities a reconciliation failure splits — so that no test outcome and no test-half content can reach the counterfactual.

That property is executed rather than asserted: the test half is perturbed, the mechanism is re-applied, and the training half's degraded values are required to be identical, on every mechanism and level. The check runs on every mechanism and every level in the design space and is one of the conditions `verify_numbers` enforces (Supplement S8).

The distinction matters because the two designs measure different things. A mechanism applied to the training half alone would degrade the model's inputs and leave the evaluation clean, which measures a train–test mismatch: how much a model built on a bad register loses when deployed against a good one. That is not the question a register's owner is asking. The owner's register is bad at both moments, and the counterfactual that answers the question degrades both.

## S12. A prefix axis, on one log

The article predicts at one moment — case creation — from the attributes recorded there, and Section 10 states plainly that prefix length, prefix bucketing and sequence encoding are therefore not axes of $\mathcal{S}$ and cannot be. That limitation stands. What it leaves open is the question a reader from predictive process monitoring will ask next: whether the paper's central claim — that the moment of prediction is an *argument* of the estimand rather than a preliminary to it — is a property of that literature's own axis as well, or an artefact of predicting at creation. This section answers that on one log.

*The construction, declared before it was run.* The log is BPIC14, the case study's own, and the register is the affected configuration item. At prefix $k$ the analyst stands after the case's $k$-th assignment event. Three things follow from $k$ and are not chosen separately. The **population** is the cases

| prefix | n | prevalence | register levels | base auc | with auc | V | interval | resolved |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 46606 | 0.945 | 3019 | 0.641 | 0.898 | 0.257 | [+0.233, +0.281] | yes |
| 1 | 46605 | 0.945 | 3019 | 0.733 | 0.900 | 0.166 | [+0.145, +0.203] | yes |
| 2 | 11080 | 0.722 | 1567 | 0.711 | 0.775 | 0.064 | [+0.047, +0.088] | yes |
| 3 | 6583 | 0.612 | 1224 | 0.799 | 0.816 | 0.017 | [−0.025, +0.039] | no |
| 5 | 3005 | 0.373 | 700 | 0.743 | 0.787 | 0.044 | [+0.021, +0.087] | yes |
| 8 | 857 | 0.550 | 341 | 0.672 | 0.741 | 0.069 | [−0.001, +0.126] | no |

Table S5: A PREFIX AXIS ON ONE LOG. At prefix $k$ the analyst stands after the case's $k$-th assignment event: the population is the cases still at risk — more than $k$ events and no group change yet — the target is whether a change occurs AFTER event $k$, and the baseline is the intake block plus what the prefix has revealed. $k = 0$ is case creation, which is the prediction point every other result in this paper uses, and it is the anchor the rest are read against. Every interval is the pointwise basic construction under the block-weighted bootstrap at 300 draws.

still at risk: more than $k$ events, and no change of assignment group in the first $k$, because a case whose outcome is already determined by $k$ is not a prediction problem. The **target** is whether a change of group occurs *after* event $k$, which is the registered handover rule of Section 5 restricted to the remaining suffix, so nothing already observed is predicted. The **baseline** is the intake block plus what the prefix has revealed — the group the case sits in now and how many distinct groups it has seen — which is the prefix-aware baseline that literature builds, and giving the prefix to the baseline and not to the register is the comparison that can embarrass the register. The split is the same fixed temporal holdout under the same declared tie-break, and every interval is the pointwise basic construction under the block-weighted bootstrap at 300 draws. $k = 0$ is case creation, which is the prediction point every other result in this paper occupies.

*What it shows.* **The register's worth falls sharply away from case creation, and what it does after that is not measured well enough to describe.** At case creation it is +0.257 [+0.233, +0.281] AUC over the intake block on 46,606 cases; two events later it is +0.064 [+0.047, +0.088] on 11,080. That fall is resolved: the two intervals do not overlap. **Beyond it the sequence is not monotone** — at the deepest prefix measured the increment is +0.069 [−0.001, +0.126], nominally 27% of its creation-time value but on an interval containing zero, and higher than the point estimate at three shallower prefixes. Across the 6 prefixes it ranges over +0.017 to +0.257, and on 2 of them the interval does not exclude zero, so no shape

should be read into the tail of this axis — only the fall at its head, which is determined, and large.

**Two of the three mechanisms are visible in the table.** The baseline rises as the prefix reveals the routing history, from 0.641 at creation; the population shrinks and its prevalence falls as the cases that were going to be handed over early leave it; and the register's own cardinality falls with the population. None of this is drift in the register: it is the same field, on the same estate, worth a different amount because the question changed underneath it.

*What this does and does not license.* It does not make this a predictive-process-monitoring paper, and no claim about that literature's benchmarks is made here: one log, one register, one encoding, no prefix bucketing and no sequence encoder is a pilot and is offered as one. What it does establish is that the prediction point is an argument of the estimand on that literature's own axis and not only on the service-desk one of Section 7.2, and that case creation — the point this paper occupies throughout — is the *most favourable* point for a creation-time register. A study that reported this register's worth from a prefix-based benchmark and a study that reported it from case creation would disagree by a factor of 3.7 *in point estimates*, and neither would be wrong. The qualifier is not decoration: that factor's denominator is one of the prefixes whose interval contains zero.

### S13. Is the increment stationary across the test half?

Section 10 names two assumptions, of which mixing is still not tested and stationarity is what this section tests: the moving-block construction needs stationarity and mixing that an event log is not guaranteed to have, and the same assumption is what makes Definition 2's population limit well defined under a temporal split. This section tests the first of them, on every pair, and reports the answer whichever way it comes out.

*The diagnostic, and the null it is read against.* At the reference cell the model is fitted *once* on the training half and then evaluated on the test half cut into 5 consecutive blocks in time. Under a stationary process the per-block increment should differ only by sampling error. A block is a fifth of the test half, so it carries more sampling error than the whole and *some* spread is guaranteed; comparing the spread with the pair's own interval, which is a whole-sample object, would therefore call ordinary noise drift. The reference

| log | target | V | range over blocks | spread | null median | percentile | trend | sign varies | drifts |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | −0.009 | [−0.044, +0.011] | 0.055 | 0.054 | 51.5 | 0.50 | yes | no |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.028 | [−0.003, +0.055] | 0.058 | 0.043 | 76.8 | −0.50 | yes | no |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.037 | [+0.032, +0.042] | 0.010 | 0.022 | 3.3 | −0.50 | no | no |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.096 | [+0.069, +0.112] | 0.043 | 0.021 | 98.0 | 0.10 | no | yes |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.167 | [+0.157, +0.184] | 0.027 | 0.047 | 13.5 | 0.00 | no | no |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.001 | [−0.077, +0.103] | 0.179 | 0.069 | 100.0 | −0.10 | yes | yes |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.007 | [+0.002, +0.012] | 0.010 | 0.021 | 6.8 | 0.10 | no | no |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.035 | [−0.013, +0.038] | 0.051 | 0.068 | 22.5 | 0.10 | yes | no |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | −0.003 | [−0.053, +0.049] | 0.102 | 0.074 | 83.5 | 0.00 | yes | no |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 0.035 | [−0.036, +0.043] | 0.079 | 0.048 | 92.8 | −0.40 | yes | no |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.001 | [−0.041, +0.020] | 0.062 | 0.038 | 92.0 | 0.67 | yes | no |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.032 | [+0.018, +0.107] | 0.089 | 0.106 | 35.5 | 0.60 | no | no |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.002 | [−0.010, +0.011] | 0.022 | 0.015 | 86.5 | −0.60 | yes | no |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.024 | [−0.037, +0.063] | 0.100 | 0.010 | 100.0 | −0.80 | yes | yes |
| Helpdesk | duration | −0.020 | [−0.103, +0.015] | 0.118 | 0.042 | 100.0 | 0.30 | yes | yes |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.031 | [+0.025, +0.069] | 0.044 | 0.012 | 100.0 | 1.00 | no | yes |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.153 | [+0.106, +0.230] | 0.124 | 0.105 | 64.5 | 0.60 | no | no |
| UCI498 | duration | −0.007 | [−0.015, +0.009] | 0.025 | 0.013 | 99.0 | 0.10 | yes | yes |
| UCI498 | handover | −0.003 | [−0.005, −0.002] | 0.003 | 0.005 | 9.5 | −0.60 | no | no |

Table S6: IS THE INCREMENT STATIONARY ACROSS THE TEST HALF? The reference cell's model is fitted once on the training half and evaluated on the test half cut into 5 consecutive blocks in time. 'spread' is the range of the per-block increment; 'null median' is the median spread over 400 RANDOM re-partitions of the same rows into blocks of the same sizes, which destroys the time order and nothing else; 'percentile' places the observed spread in that reference. A block is a fifth of the test half and so carries more sampling error than the whole, which is why the comparison is against the null and not against the pair's own interval. 'trend' is the Spearman correlation of the increment with the block index: it separates drift, which has an order, from heterogeneity, which does not. 'drifts' marks a percentile in the null's upper tail at the declared level $\alpha = 0.05$.

is instead a **stationarity null**: the same test rows re-partitioned at random into blocks of the same sizes, 400 times, which destroys the time order and nothing else. The observed spread is reported as a percentile of that reference.

*What it shows.* **On 6 of 19 pairs the increment is not stationary across the test half** — the time-ordered spread sits in the upper tail of the null at the declared level $\alpha = 0.05$ — and on 13 it sits above the null's median. The median observed spread is +0.055 AUC, 1.38 times the null's median, and on the worst pair it is 9.8 times. On 11 of 19 pairs the *sign* of the increment varies between blocks of the same test half.

**It is heterogeneity rather than trend.** Only 1 of 19 pairs shows a Spearman correlation between the increment and the block index that reaches conventional significance, so what the diagnostic finds is not a register decaying smoothly with time: it is a test half whose periods are not exchangeable. Two candidate mechanisms are in the table. Prevalence moves by a median

0.13 between the first and last block, and by 0.56 on the worst pair; and the share of test rows whose register value was never seen in training rises from a median 4.8% in the first block to 8.2% in the last.

*What follows.* Two things, and neither is a correction. First, a pair that fails this test is not a pair whose number is wrong: it is a pair whose estimand is a moving target, which is a fact a reader should be given rather than an error to be repaired — and it is the paper's own thesis applied to time, which $\mathcal{S}$ does not contain as an axis. Second, the interval and the band do not cover it. Both are computed under an assumption this diagnostic finds violated on 6 pairs, so on those pairs the interval understates what a reader would see on a different stretch of the same log, and the direction of the understatement is not signed. Adding time as a declared axis — an evaluation period, with the increment reported per period — is the change this measurement implies, and it is not made here.

## S14. Results the article summarises

*S14.1. The pipeline axis is two axes*

Crossed on the case study's log — both families against all three encodings, 6 complete factorial pipelines, run on each of the log's two targets, which index surfaces rather than enlarging one (Section 5) — **the encoding is the larger of the two**, 10.1% of the variance against the family's 5.2%, each the median over those two targets and the 5 instruments pooled, with an interaction, 9.7%, that lies between the two main effects and is the largest two-way term: the fused index is not the sum of two indices. Table S7 carries the per-target medians, which are a different aggregation and need not agree with these.

**Run on the 8 ITSM pairs, that finding travels but does not hold everywhere.** Taking the median over the 5 instruments within each pair — a third aggregation, distinct from the corpus median of a column and from the per-instrument largest that Section 6.2 names — the encoding is the larger first-order axis on 6 of the 8, and on the other 2 **the family is, and not narrowly**: on the more extreme of them the encoding carries 0.04 times what the family does. So the case study's ordering is the common one and not the rule. **That is the article's own thesis arriving where it was not sent**: the crossing was run to separate two axes a fused index confounds,

| log | target | encoding | family | quality level | rung | split | higher-order |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.091 | 0.066 | 0.065 | 0.492 | 0.014 | 0.271 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.125 | 0.049 | 0.109 | 0.430 | 0.009 | 0.276 |

Table S7: The decomposition with the model family and the encoding as separate axes, on the case study's log where all six pipelines run. First-order shares, median over the five instruments, under the equal-level measure, then the total higher-order share. The 'learner' axis of Table S8 is the two of them together.

and what it finds is again that which axis leads is a property of the pair. The remaining pairs are not crossed, which Section 10 records.

Table S8's "learner" column is not a learner axis. Its levels are pipelines: a model family together with an encoding and, in one case, a calibration. On 15 of the 19 pairs only two of them run, so the index is a statement about a two-level axis whose levels differ in two things at once.

On the case study's log the budget allows the two to be crossed. Both model families — penalised logistic regression and histogram gradient boosting — are run against all three encodings: one-hot, frequency, and cross-fitted target encoding. That is 6 complete factorial pipelines, run on each of the log's two targets — the target is not an axis of any surface (Section 5), so it indexes surfaces rather than enlarging one — and the decomposition of Section 4.5 then carries a family axis and an encoding axis separately.

Three things follow, and the third is the reason the confound mattered.

**The encoding is the larger of the two.** It carries 10.1% of the variance in the increment against the family's 5.2%, each the median over the log's two targets and the 5 instruments pooled; Table S7 prints the per-target medians, which are a different aggregation and need not agree with these. How the register is turned into columns matters more than which model consumes them on both targets, and it is the choice more often left unstated — but by how much is a property of the target: the encoding's share is 1.4 times the family's on one target and 2.6 on the other.

**Their interaction lies between the two main effects, and is the largest two-way term.** The family–encoding two-way component carries 9.7% — below the encoding's 10.1% and above the family's 5.2% — and no other two-way term in the crossed decomposition is larger. A gradient-boosting model and a logistic model do not respond to a change of encoding in the same way, which is precisely what an axis that fuses them cannot express.

**So the fused index is not the sum of two indices.** It is a statement about a two-level axis whose levels move two things at once, and Table S8's pipeline column should be read as that and nothing more. Section 6.2 reports what the same crossing found on the 8 ITSM pairs, where it does not fully replicate; the remaining 11 pairs are not crossed, and Section 10 carries that as a limitation rather than assuming the case study's split transfers.

*S14.2. The decomposition on the inference surface*

The inference surface is a balanced full factorial, so the exact functional ANOVA of Section 4.5 applies to it unchanged. It is applied: one decomposition per pair per instrument, over 36 cells each, with no failures. That retires the objection that the surface bands are computed on is a corner rather than a design.

**It does not, however, confirm the declared surface's decomposition, and it is not evidence that either is unrepresentative.** The axis carrying the largest first-order index agrees between the two on a minority of pairs, and the corpus medians differ. The reason is structural rather than substantive: *the two surfaces do not declare the same levels.* The inference surface carries two splits, three register-quality conditions and three rungs against the declared surface's six, six to ten, and three to four, and an axis cannot show the same variance share at three levels as at ten. So the comparison is between two designs and not a check of one against the other.

What survives it is worth stating, because it is this paper's own argument turning on one of its own objects: **a first-order index is a statement about the levels an analyst declared, and not only about the pair.** The corpus claim of Section 4.5 — that which axis leads is a property of the pair — is qualified by that and not refuted: it holds across the pairs of one declared design, and a reader who declares a different one should expect a different ordering.

*S14.3. Decision rules, in sample and out*

Table S27 compares the four rules of Section 4.7 — *one-number*, *uniform*, *majority* and *weighted mean* — under the loss defined there, inside one instrument at a time and in that instrument's own units. No average in this paper crosses an instrument.

The weighted-mean rule is optimal in sample by construction — its excess regret is exactly zero everywhere, as the lemma requires — so the comparison that matters is out of sample. Choosing the action on a random half of the

admissible cells and paying the loss on the other half, the one-number rule costs 0.00450 AUC of expected excess regret against 0.00011 for the majority rule and 0.00002 for the weighted mean. The part of the ordering that holds everywhere is that the one-number rule is worse than the majority rule, in 5 instruments of 5; the full three-way ordering holds in 4 of them.

Three results run against the surface's advocate and are reported as such. The conservative rule — adopt only where the whole surface is positive — is the worst of the four in 4 of 5 instruments, because it declines so often that the performance it forgoes exceeds the performance the one-number rule destroys; the exception is Nagelkerke $R^2$. The median excess regret of the one-number rule is *zero* in every instrument: on most pairs every rule picks the same action. And under rolling-origin folds — choosing the action on the earlier folds and paying on the later ones, a harder test because the surface itself moves in time — the ordering does not hold: one number costs 0.00885 against the majority rule's 0.01922. Leaving one log out and asking whether a pairwise ordering established on the rest survives on the held-out log, it does on 57% of the 79 comparisons in which the two rules differ at all, which is near chance.

**What we conclude from this, and what we do not.** We do not conclude that a surface report is a better decision rule than a number. On this corpus the decision-optimal collapse is the weighted mean, that is an algebraic identity in sample and a small and unstable advantage out of it, and on the one utility with an operational meaning what separates is the conservative rule and not the one-number rule (Section 8.3). The case for reporting the surface rests on the decomposition and on the sign disagreement, not on the regret comparison, and the regret comparison is reported here as a check on the former rather than as a result in its own right.

*S14.4. Calibration, unseen categories and rolling origin*

Table S28 reports, for each pair at the reference cell, the calibration intercept and slope, the Brier score, and the share of test cases carrying at least one level unseen in training. The unseen-category rate is the mechanism behind much of the register's behaviour: a register whose identities do not recur across the split cannot help a model that has never seen them, and the rate ranges from 0% to 87%. Calibration is reported because discrimination alone is not a sufficient description of a model (Van Calster et al., 2019); slopes below one indicate the overfitting that high-cardinality one-hot encodings produce, and are the reason a calibrated learner is one of the four.

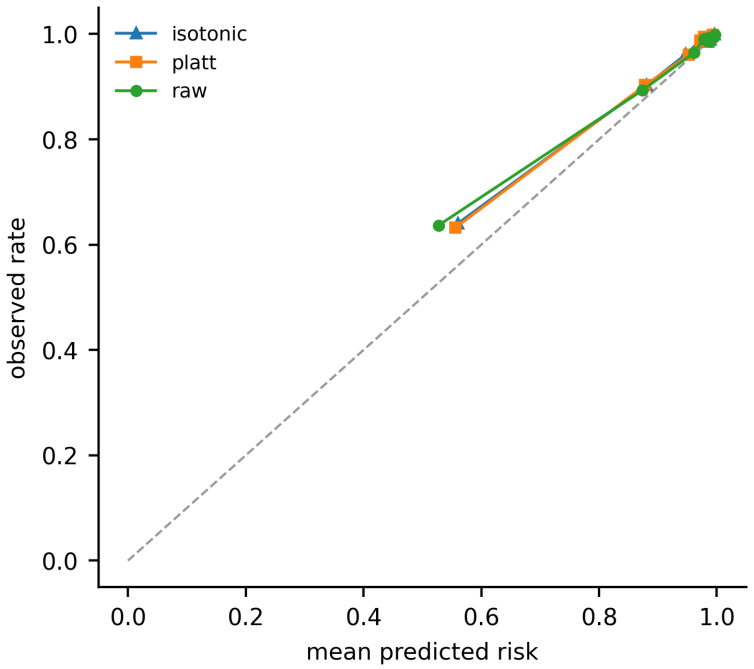



Figure S1: Calibration at the reference cell on the case study's log, by decile of predicted risk. The two proper scoring rules on the metric axis — Brier skill and the log-loss skill — read this picture; the two rank-based ones cannot see it at all (Remark S1). A pipeline whose discrimination is adequate and whose calibration is not therefore moves the increment on some instruments and not others, which is one concrete mechanism behind the metric axis's contribution to Table S8.

The frequency-encoded pipeline is the one that is visibly miscalibrated, with a slope well below one, and it is also the one whose increment differs most from the others on the two proper scoring rules. That is the interaction between the pipeline axis and the metric axis, drawn.

Rolling-origin results are in `results/s01_surface.csv` under `split = rolling`$k$ and enter the decomposition as the split axis; Supplement S5 prints them per fold. The single holdout is not the best estimate of the increment, and reporting it alone would be a limitation.

*S14.5. The case study's leakage and quality experiments*

*The leakage tipping point.* The knowledge reference is load-bearing: it is the field that takes the register's increment to indistinguishable from zero, so the evidence that it was available at $\tau_2$ is stated exactly, and it is weaker than proof. The interaction detail file establishes that the field is written by the

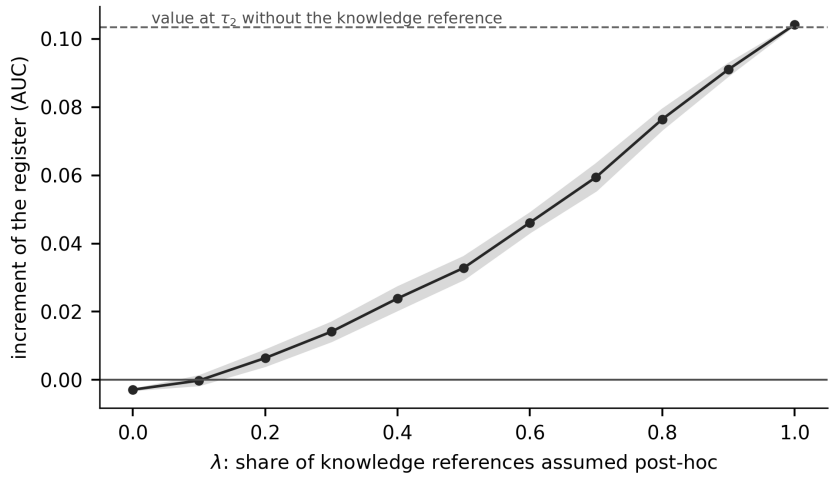



Figure S2: The register's increment at $\tau_2$ on the estate's cohort and reassignment target, as a function of $\lambda$, the share of knowledge-article references assumed to have been written after the incident existed. A reader who has a belief about $\lambda$ can read their own answer off the curve.

service-desk process and not by the incident process — 94,250 interactions in it never became incidents, and 100% of them carry a knowledge reference — but not *when*, for a given incident, the value was written. Table S30 lists each piece of evidence beside what it does and does not establish. Availability at $\tau_2$ is probable and unproven, and the disposition of an unprovable admissibility assumption is a sensitivity analysis rather than a headline.

Because availability is probable rather than proven, the increment is reported in Figure S2 as a function of $\lambda$, the share of knowledge references assumed to have been written after the incident existed and therefore inadmissible. Masking a random $\lambda$ share of the field and re-estimating traces a curve from the permissive end ($\lambda = 0$, the field fully admissible) to the conservative end ($\lambda = 1$, equivalent to $\tau_2$ without the field at all). The masking is stochastic, so each point is a mean over 5 seeds with the spread across them printed beside it, and the curve is a sensitivity display rather than an estimate the paper quotes a number from.

At $\lambda = 0$ the register is worth $-0.0029$ $[-0.0074, +0.0019]$, which is not resolvably different from zero, and it reaches half of its knowledge-free value at $\lambda = 0.64$: a reader who believes that more than 64% of knowledge references are written *after* the incident exists should read this estate's register as worth

at least half of +0.1034 AUC, and one who believes almost none are should read it as worth almost nothing. We have no way to measure $\lambda$ and do not claim one; the curve makes the assumption explicit and continuous rather than binary and made on the reader's behalf.

*Register quality.* Masking a complete field is a sensitivity experiment, not a model of a real register, so Table S31 reports the six mechanisms of Section 3 plus a discovery lag, and sweeps the accuracy and reconciliation mechanisms rather than reporting one level of each. Everything here is on the estate's cohort and reassignment target; Table S32 carries the severity curves, over 11 severities and 20 seeds per stochastic mechanism, and Table S34 the same mechanisms on the registered cohort. Four things follow, and two of them are nulls we did not expect.

**Coverage is the expensive failure, and losing the long tail is not the worst way to lose it.** At half population the register is worth +0.0819 if its long tail is absent and +0.0708 if its core is, against +0.1034 complete. Losing the core costs more than losing the tail, which is the opposite of the usual intuition that the rare identities carry the information: on this estate the frequent items are the ones the model has enough cases to learn from. Loss at random is worse than either (+0.0676), because it fragments every identity rather than removing some cleanly.

**Accuracy costs about what coverage costs.** Corrupting three tenths of the identities — the register is complete, and wrong — leaves it worth +0.0689, a loss of −0.0346, about what losing a third of its population costs. A maturity assessment that counts populated rows and does not sample them for correctness is measuring one of the two and reporting it as the whole.

**Reconciliation failure is nearly free.** Splitting *every* identity into two records moves the increment by −0.0019: with thousands of cases per identity, halving the evidence behind each still leaves enough.

**Staleness is exactly zero, and the reason is the encoder.** Removing identities the register had not seen by the split point moves the increment by +0.0000. That is not a bug in the mechanism: a one-hot encoder fitted on the training half already ignores levels it has never seen, so a test row carrying an undiscovered identity contributes an all-zero encoding either way. Under an encoder that keeps missingness as an explicit indicator the effect is non-zero; Supplement S15 measures that on the registered cohort. A *discovery lag* — identities first used in the last half of the training window absent everywhere, leaving 94.0% of rows populated — moves it by +0.0039. Whether a data-

quality defect is visible is therefore an interaction between the quality axis and the encoding axis, and an analyst who varies one without the other will conclude that the defect does not matter.

**And which rows go missing matters as much as how many.** The three *dependent* mechanisms of Section 3 carry severity integrals +0.0768, +0.0486 and +0.0559, against +0.0692 for the independent long-tail mechanism, which the dependent ones bracket rather than track: the identity of the missing rows changes what the loss costs by up to half again, so a quality axis built only from independent coin flips is measuring one corner of the question. The summary is an integral against a uniform measure on severity, and coarsening the sweep from 11 severities to five moves it by at most 0.0114 AUC. Every mechanism is verified by execution to be a function of the training half alone — 16 checks run and 16 pass.

*S14.6. Calibration before the decision curve*

**Why that window, and why the exclusion is not repaired by recalibrating again.** A Cox calibration slope of $\gamma$ means a threshold $\theta$ selects the cases a well-calibrated model would select at a different threshold, and the discrepancy grows without bound as $\gamma$ leaves one; the window is the conventional band in which risks are neither compressed nor stretched beyond a factor the literature treats as readable, and it is a declared convention rather than a derived bound. Widening it to admit everything would not make the excluded thresholds readable as cost ratios; it would only stop saying so. **Recalibration is already an axis, which is why it cannot also be the remedy**: isotonic recalibration is a level of the pipeline axis, so an arm that fails the slope check has, on the pairs that carry it, a recalibrated sibling in the same surface. Applying isotonic recalibration to the failing arm before excluding it would silently replace one specification by another and report the result under the first one's name — the exact substitution this paper's argument is against. The arm is excluded and its sibling is reported as itself. The rule, what it removes and what the curves look like without it are below.

*Calibration comes first, or the threshold means nothing.* The identity above reads $\theta$ as a probability threshold, and everything that follows from it requires the score to be a probability. A threshold of 0.30 applied to a score whose calibration slope is -0.28 is not a statement about a cost ratio of 2.3 false nominations per true one; it is a statement about a number that happens to lie at 0.30 on an arbitrary scale. Every model contributing to a

decision-curve conclusion in this paper is therefore refitted under a **training-only** calibration: isotonic and Platt scaling, each cross-validated *inside* the training half, so no test outcome touches the calibrator, and the calibration is rebuilt inside every resampling iteration. Table S29 gives the diagnostics for the raw and the calibrated scores on every pair.

The correction bites. Across the corpus the median calibration slope is 0.63 on raw scores and 0.95 after isotonic calibration; the median expected calibration error falls from 0.105 to 0.089; and the number of arms whose slope lies outside $[0.5, 2]$ falls from 92 to 63. It also changes conclusions: the sign of the net-benefit increment differs between the raw and the calibrated curve at a mean 27.4% of thresholds.

**What may and may not be read as a decision curve.** Curves computed on calibrated probabilities carry the probability-threshold interpretation and are what Section 8.2 and the case study read. Curves on raw scores are reported as *score-threshold sensitivity analyses* and are labelled so in every table; they say how a conclusion moves as a selection rule tightens, and they do not say what cost ratio that rule encodes.

*S14.7. Simultaneous bands on the decision curve*

Figure S3 draws the register's net-benefit increment across the grid at the reference cell on *calibrated* probabilities, with the pointwise interval and the simultaneous max-$t$ band. The band's family is declared separately from the scalar family and spans every admissible net-benefit cell of the pair — 248 members, nominal critical value 3.57, widened by the measured factor 1.96 of Section 8.2 to 7.01 — and the difference from a pointwise reading is not cosmetic. Its median width is 0.0266 against the pointwise interval's 0.0071 (0.0136 before the widening), and across the 31 operating points of this estate's decision curve the pointwise interval declares the increment resolvably positive at 24 of them while the simultaneous band declares it at 8 (18 under the nominal band). Both are built from the same draws, so the only thing that differs is the family: those points are the price of a statement about a *range* of thresholds rather than about each threshold separately, and a paper that reads a decision curve across its range and prices it pointwise has claimed the first while paying for the second.

The curve dips near $\theta = 0.575$, where the widened band's lower edge reaches -0.0374, so the count of points that resolve as *harmful* is reported rather than left to the eye: 0 of the 31 points pointwise and 0 under the simultaneous band. The second can only be smaller than or equal to the

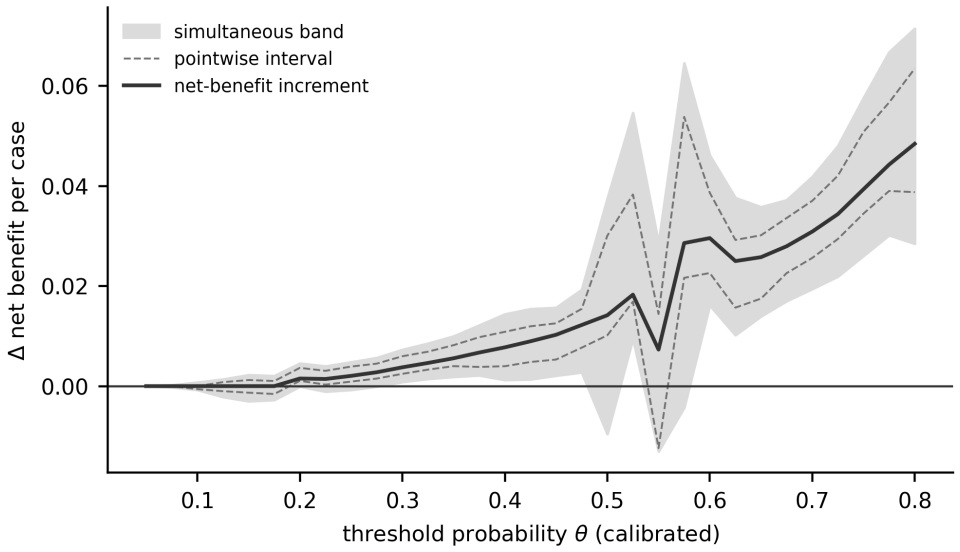



Figure S3: The register's net-benefit increment across the operating range at the reference cell, with the pointwise interval and the simultaneous max-$t$ band. The simultaneous band is what a claim about a *range* of thresholds has to be read against. **The band drawn here is the NOMINAL one, before the measured widening of Section 8.2**: the widened band is 1.96 times wider at every point and is what the counts in that section and in the text below are computed under, so this figure shows the shape of the curve and the ordering of the two intervals, and not the band any claim is read against. The curve dips near $\theta = 0.55$ as drawn, where the nominal band's lower edge reaches -0.0130 — under the widened band the dip is at $\theta = 0.575$ and reaches -0.0374. Either way the dip is not a harm the evidence resolves: 0 of the 31 operating points resolve as harmful pointwise, 0 under the nominal band and 0 under the widened one.

first — the wider family gives the wider interval at every point, which `verify_numbers` checks — so a dip a reader can see is not a harm the evidence resolves. Over the 248 cells of the band's own family — *not* the 10,974 decision-curve rows the corpus carries as point estimates, which are a different and much larger set — the same counts are 3 and 0; Table S25 prints this pair's own curve, operating point by operating point, and its caption names the cell it is computed at.

**This family is the one most exposed to how the critical value is estimated, and it is the one where the estimator matters most.** On every one of the 19 decision-curve families the multiplier value lies below the whole order-statistic interval of the empirical quantile (Section 4.3), by a median factor of 2.68, and across the corpus's decision-curve cells the

multiplier band would resolve 2,602 against the empirical band's 672. Part of that ratio is arithmetic rather than tail: cells that are exactly zero in at least nine draws of ten inflate the empirical quantile of any family that keeps them, which is why the article's rule excludes them before the quantile is taken and prints the excluded count (2 of 248 on this family). The measured widening of 1.96 that an earlier construction applied to the multiplier value is kept in the ladder above as the comparison: it lands at 7.01 against the admissible empirical quantile's 6.64, and the counts under it are printed so the reader can see that the two agree on the shape of the conclusion and differ on its size. The $(n, K)$ calibration of Section 6.3 is estimated for the scalar instruments and is not applied here either.

*S14.8. The ITSM family, statistic by statistic*

Eight of the 19 pairs are IT service management, where the register is a maintained configuration or customer register and a data-quality mechanism has an operational referent. The other eleven include a loan amount treated as a high-cardinality categorical, a case-type reference nobody curates and an article of law, which Section 5.4 names as threats to construct validity. Table S17 reports every headline statistic on all nineteen pairs, on the eight, and on the eleven that remain, each with a cluster-bootstrap interval taking the *log* as the resampling unit — two targets on the same log share a cohort and are not two independent observations.

The higher-order share is 36.5% on the ITSM family against 56.0% on the whole corpus, the largest first-order index 35.5% against 28.7%, and the all-cells sign-disagreement rate 27.1% against 32.8%. One difference runs against the paper. **The headline is lower on the population this paper is about**: of the resolved cells, 3.1% disagree in sign on the ITSM family against 31.2% on the other eleven and 13.0% pooled. The corpus-wide figure is therefore driven by the pairs Section 5.4 names as carrying construct-validity threats, and a reader who takes this paper to be about maintained registers should read the ITSM column and should read it as the weaker case for the apparatus, not the stronger one.

*S14.9. The decision rules in full*

The four rules of Section 4.7 — *one-number*, *uniform*, *majority* and *weighted mean* — are compared under the loss defined there, inside one instrument at a time and in that instrument's own units. Table S27 and Supplement S14.3 carries it in full. The weighted mean is optimal in sample

by construction, so what matters is out of sample: choosing on a random half of the admissible cells and paying on the other half, the one-number rule costs 0.00450 AUC of expected excess regret against 0.00011 for the majority rule and 0.00002 for the weighted mean, and is worse than the majority rule in 5 instruments of 5.

**Three results run against the surface's advocate, and we report them rather than the comparison alone.** The conservative rule is the worst of the four in 4 instruments, declining so often that the performance it forgoes exceeds the performance the one-number rule destroys; the median excess regret of the one-number rule is *zero* in every instrument, because on most pairs every rule picks the same action; and under rolling-origin folds the ordering does not hold, at 0.00885 against 0.01922. We therefore do not conclude that a surface report is a better decision rule than a number. The case for reporting the surface rests on the decomposition and on the sign disagreement; this comparison is a check on those and not a result in its own right.

*S14.10. The desk's decision, in net benefit per thousand*

Because net benefit is a single cardinal utility, the decision-rule comparison of Section 6.6 can be run on it without the unit problem that forces that section to work instrument by instrument. Three things have to be settled first, and each is settled by a declared rule rather than a default.

**Which models may enter.** A threshold is a cost ratio only if the score is a probability, so a model whose recalibrated slope lies outside $[0.5, 2.0]$ is excluded from the decision-analytic reading by a registered rule applied at the level of the (pair, pipeline, baseline) triple and requiring both arms to pass. A *model* here is one such triple, not one fitted classifier. The rule removes 40 of 118 of them and leaves 3 of 19 pairs with none. **That count is itself the strongest operational finding in this section**: on a third of the models a published evaluation would fit here, no threshold can be read as a cost ratio at all.

**Which thresholds.** A uniform measure over an operating range from 0.05 to 0.80 is not a desk's belief. For a decision about pre-empting a reassignment the false positive costs a specialist's few minutes and the false negative costs a re-triage, a second queue wait and the service-level exposure that goes with it; ratios between three and ten to one put the indifference threshold between 0.08 and 0.36, with a median of 0.19. A Beta distribution

with that support is declared as the *desk distribution*, and single exchange rates are reported beside it.

**Which unit.** Net benefit per case is a rate near zero, and three decimal places of it look like a tie, so Table S23 reports it per thousand cases.

**And where the rules separate, what separates is the conservative rule.** Under the desk distribution the one-number rule, the majority rule and the weighted mean all carry a median excess regret of 0.000 per thousand cases; only the conservative rule loses, at 0.048 — and the medians hide a tail that is entirely that rule's, whose cross-pair *mean* excess is 6.092 against the one-number rule's 0.056. The four rules do not all lose the same amount on 11 of the 16 pairs the calibration rule admits, and are identical on the other 5. Where they do separate the one-number rule is strictly the worst on 3 and tied for worst on 2, at a maximum of 0.412 per thousand — a real ordering and a small quantity. **The case against a one-number report does not rest on this design.** It rests on the decomposition of Section 4.5 and on the sign disagreement of Section 6.4, which is unit-free.

**What does separate, in this unit, is the forecast origin.** The register is worth 1.71 true positives per thousand cases against the intake block. Against intake plus group plus the knowledge reference — the same estate, the same register, a later moment in the same process — it is worth 0.003. A desk that read the first number and deployed where the second applies is short 1.70 per thousand cases. That is the operational content of Section 7.2, and it is larger than the most the choice of collapse rule costs a one-number report, which is 0.412 per thousand at its worst pair. It is *not* larger than every difference between the four rules: the conservative rule's own mean excess is 6.092 per thousand, which exceeds it, and that rule reaches far more than this on a single pair. The comparison that holds is against the rule this section is about, and it is stated at that width rather than at the one that reads better. It is also conditional on the knowledge reference being admissible at $\tau_2$, which Section 7 shows is probable and unproven: the second figure is the $\lambda = 0$ end of Figure S2, and a reader who believes a share $\lambda$ of those references are written after the incident exists should read their own figure off that curve.

*What the operational statement does not say.* Net benefit converts a discrimination increment into units the desk recognises. It does not convert it into money, and three gaps remain, each needing data this study does not have: nominating a case for review is not the same as preventing a reassignment,

and whether acting on a nomination changes the outcome is an interventional question on observational evidence; the exchange rate is declared rather than measured, which is why the whole curve is reported; and the cost of the register itself — discovery tooling, reconciliation effort, the staff who keep it current — is nowhere in this evidence.

*S14.11. The measure, the target axis, and which axis leads*

**The pooled decomposition, for comparison.** Across the corpus the median pooled first-order index is 18.9% for the split, 5.5% for the baseline rung, 4.2% for the register-quality condition and 3.6% for the pipeline; at the median pair the largest first-order index *within an instrument* — a median over pairs of a median over instruments, and not the largest of those four medians — is 28.7%, the total higher-order share is 56.0% (95% interval 40.9% to 60.8% over pairs, 23.3% to 79.3%), and the largest per-axis *involvement* $\max_i(S_{T_i} - S_i)$, a different quantity, is 43.7%. The involvement is reported because it is what the specification-curve literature computes, and because the difference between it and the higher-order share is what Section 6.2 turns on — not because it answers the question as asked.

**The measure is not neutral, and one conclusion does not survive it.** Under the reference-weighted measure the median higher-order share is 49.6% and under the concentrated measure 31.7% (Table S26). That second number is smaller than the largest first-order index under the same measure, 39.2%, and on 12 of 19 pairs some single axis carries more variance than everything higher-order combined — against 6 pairs under the equal-level measure. The statement *the interactions carry more than any main effect* is therefore true under the two measures that let a reader roam and false under the one that keeps them near the reference cell. Both invariance tests pass, to $1.1 \times 10^{-16}$ and 0.004.

**The target is an axis too, and it is a small one within a pair.** Every index above is computed *within* a log–target pair. On the 6 logs carrying both registered targets the target axis can be added, on the headroom scale, and it carries a median 2.1%. The two targets are different questions, agreeing on a median 51% of cases, so the reading is not that the target hardly matters — on the case study it decides the sign (Section 7.1) — but that once it is fixed, the remaining choices move the answer by more than switching it does.

**Which axis leads is a property of the pair.** The largest single first-order index anywhere on the corpus is 77.0%, carried by the baseline rung on UCI498 / duration; 4 different axes lead somewhere, and the most frequent

leader is the split, on 51% of pair–instrument combinations. An analyst can guess the leader and be right about half the time.

*S14.12. What the pooled resolved rate is a ratio of*

**It is a pooled ratio, it depends on which band resolves the cells, and both facts belong beside it.** The denominator is a sum over pairs whose resolved-cell counts run from zero to 180, not an average of per-pair rates, and it depends on which band decides what "resolved" means. The figure quoted here, 13.0%, is the reported band's — the empirical critical value, with no $(n, K)$ widening applied (Section 9.2). The estimator choice moves it: under the multiplier approximation the denominator is larger, 890 cells against the reported band's 698. **And the disagreements are concentrated**: of the 91 cells, 91 come from three logs, and only 3 of the 13 logs contribute any at all. The designed surface runs every pair at the same draw count, so unlike earlier reports of this statistic the concentration cannot be a budget effect. On 8 pairs no resolved cell contradicts the reference, on 3 some do, and on 8 nothing resolves.

*S14.13. What the case study says to a configuration management programme*

*S14.14. What this says to a configuration management programme*

The register in this log is layered, and the layers are the ones a common service data model uses: an item belongs to a class, a class to a subtype, and a subtype rolls up to a service component. Supplement S4 estimates the increment at each layer against the intake block, on the registered targets. The coarse layers are *not* free — on the handover target the item's type alone is worth +0.134 and its subtype +0.163, against +0.257 for the item itself, and on duration +0.045 against +0.129 — so knowing that a case concerns *a laptop* is worth between a third and two thirds of knowing which one. What the item adds *on top of* the subtype is the quantity a populated hierarchy does not buy, and it is +0.109 on handover and +0.087 on duration. A programme that populates the class hierarchy and stops has bought a real part of the value and left the larger marginal part on the table; it has not bought nothing. These figures are on the registered targets rather than this section's reassignment target, and Supplement S4 says so.

The three dependent quality mechanisms map onto how a configuration management database actually decays, which is why they are in the design space rather than independent coin flips. *Discovery lag* is the interval between a service going live and the discovery tooling finding its items, which

is why a new service's cases carry an empty affected item for weeks. *Unreconciled duplicates* arise when two discovery sources write the same physical item under two identifiers. *Propensity-dependent missingness* arises when the affected item is populated by the desk rather than by discovery: the unusual case, which is the one worth predicting, is the one the desk is least likely to classify correctly under time pressure. The measured costs above say which of the three is worth spending on: on this estate, coverage and accuracy at the item level, and not reconciliation.

Two disclaimers. This is forecast performance on one estate for one decision, not procurement advice, and a register that pays nothing here may be bought for change control, audit or impact analysis, none of which this measures; and the ranking of the mechanisms is a property of this cohort's cardinality and volume.

*S14.15. The three forecast origins, moment by moment*

An incident in this estate does not begin as an incident. A caller reaches the service desk, an *interaction* is opened, the desk works it, and if it cannot be closed there an incident is created and routed. Three moments at which a prediction could be made are estimated, and what changes between them is not only which fields are admissible (Table 8).

$\tau_0$**, first touch, every call.** The desk has just picked up the call and does not yet know whether it will escalate. The population is every interaction — 145,478 of them — the register is the interaction's own affected item, with 4,034 values, and the admissible baseline is the interaction's intake block. Against it the register is worth +0.2310 [+0.2204, +0.2618].

$\tau_1$**, first touch, the calls that escalate.** The same moment and the same fields, restricted to the 44,513 calls that did become incidents. The register is worth +0.2013 [+0.1930, +0.2224].

$\tau_2$**, incident creation.** The desk has worked the interaction and escalated it. The population is the 45,455 incidents; the group that logged the incident is known, and so — probably — is the knowledge-article reference the desk consulted. Against the intake block the register is worth +0.1838; against intake plus group, +0.1034 [+0.0949, +0.1295]; against intake plus group plus the knowledge reference, −0.0029 [−0.0074, +0.0019] — the one rung of the five that does not resolve.

The pairwise differences separate the mechanisms that a baseline ladder alone conflates, and separating them properly requires one more row than the three moments give. $\tau_1$ and $\tau_2$ are *not* the same cases: 942 incidents have no interaction record, so $\tau_2$ carries 45,455 cases against $\tau_1$'s 44,513. Table 8 therefore also reports $\tau_2$ restricted to $\tau_1$'s own population — the same 44,513 cases at the same prevalence 0.402 — which is the row that makes the information step an information step.

Restricting the population from every call to the calls that escalate, holding the information fixed, moves the increment by $-0.0297$ AUC. Moving from first touch to incident creation *on the matched cases*, changing what is known and nothing else, moves it a further $-0.0099$. The remaining $-0.0076$ is what the 942 incidents with no interaction record are worth, and it is a population difference rather than an information one: the unadjusted $\tau_1$-to-$\tau_2$ step, $-0.0175$, is the sum of the two and attributing all of it to information would overstate the information channel by three quarters. Admitting the group and then the knowledge reference takes the increment the rest of the way to zero. A forecast origin is therefore an argument of the estimand in its own right: it fixes the population, the feature snapshot and the admissible set, and only the third of those is a baseline.

Neither $\tau_0$ nor $\tau_2$ is "the" answer: which one a reader wants depends on where in their own process they intend to predict. A desk screening at $\tau_0$ looks at 145,478 calls a year at a prevalence of 0.146; a desk screening at $\tau_2$ looks at 45,455 incidents at 0.400, and Section 8.3 prices the difference.

*S14.16. Magnitude weighting, and the rate under each measure*

**Weighting by magnitude does not rescue the conventional report, and the rate depends on the measure.** Weighting each cell by $|V|$ as well as by the measure gives a median 50.2%, *higher* than the unweighted rate: the cells that disagree are not the negligible ones. The median is 32.8% under the equal-level measure, 25.4% under the reference-weighted and 13.4% under the concentrated, falling as the measure concentrates on the reference specification, which is what it should do. A sign comparison is unit-free, which is why this one quantity may be pooled across instruments where an expected loss may not.

Table S18 attributes the disagreement to axes. Holding everything else fixed and changing one axis, the sign of the increment flips for a median 33.5% of same-everything-else pairs of cells under the split, 31.3% under the pipeline, 22.2% under the baseline rung, 20.4% under the register-quality

condition and 19.7% under the metric. The two axes an evaluation paper is most likely to hold fixed without comment — which split, which pipeline — are the two that flip the sign most often.

*S14.17. The eight pairs where the construct is what this paper is about*

Every corpus statistic is reported on the 8 ITSM-like pairs as well as on all 19 (Table S17), because the register there is a maintained one and the construct is what the paper is about. **The headline is lower on the population this paper is about**: the sign-disagreement rate is 27.1% against 32.8% over the corpus, and on resolved cells 3.1% against 31.2% on the rest. The decomposition barely moves — higher-order 36.5% against 56.0%, largest first-order 35.5% against 28.7%. Supplement S14.8 carries every statistic on both populations.

*S14.18. The one surface that is uniformly beneficial, and what it cost to reach*

**1 of the 19 pairs is uniformly beneficial, and the interesting part is the denominator.** The label requires every cell of the *inference family* to have its lower band above zero (Definition 3) — a set that is a median 16.7% of a pair's admissible cells, and on the pair that reaches the label it is smaller still, under a twentieth. A label about *every* cell is correspondingly easier to earn over fewer of them, which is why Section 4.6 names this as the label the restriction most flatters.

It is not, however, an artefact of the critical value. A cell whose point estimate is negative can never qualify at any critical value, and the pair in question carries none inside its family; the label holds under the multiplier, under the empirical quantile the article reports, under its order-statistic upper end and under every widening the $(n, K)$ calibration could ask for (Supplement S9.7). So the state is genuinely reached, and reached over 3.75% of the specifications the declaration admits.

**That combination is the point rather than an embarrassment.** Section 4.6 offers $\rho = 1$ as the only state in which one positive number is a safe summary of a surface, and asks how often it obtains. It obtains once here — on the pair with the richest declared grid — and the claim it licenses ranges over 3.75% of that pair's admissible specifications. A reader who wants a single number for this register may have one, provided they are content that it is a statement about the design the band was computed on and not about the design they might have declared.

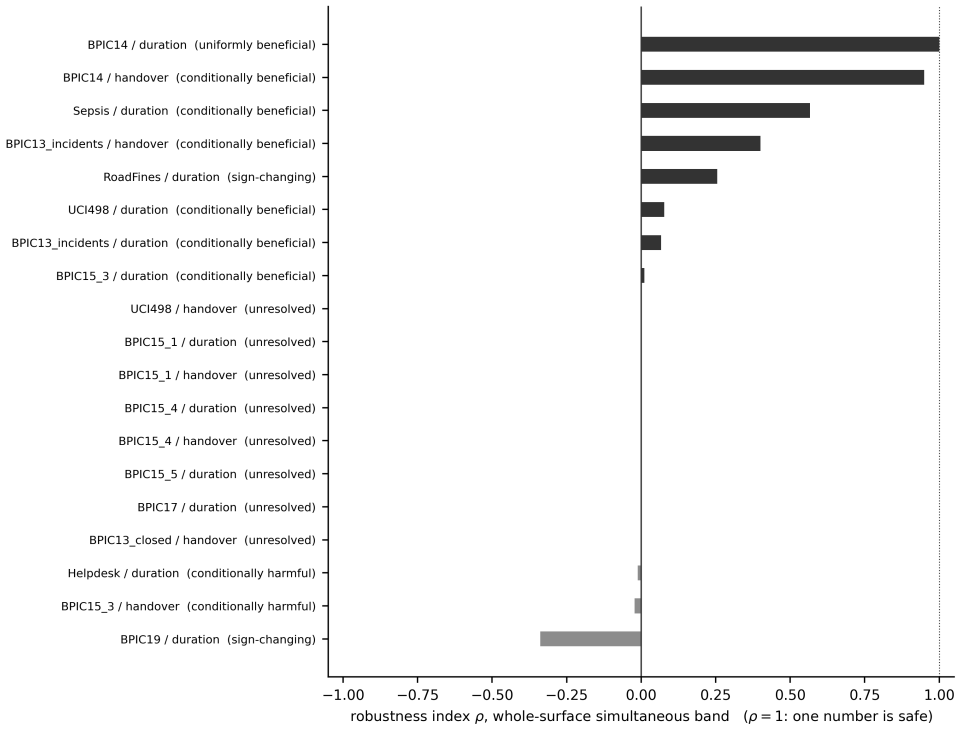



Figure S4: The robustness index $\rho$ per log–target pair, with the region label, at the critical value Section 6.3 reports. The label drawn here is the one the band yields *before* the minimum resolved share of Definition 3, which changes it on 3 of these pairs (Table 6). $\rho = 1$, the dotted line, is the only state in which a single positive number is a safe summary.

The statement that needs none of the apparatus is the weaker one that survives everywhere: on every pair at least one admissible specification has a negative increment, which is visible from the all-cells column of Table S10. What the apparatus earns is $\rho$ and the resolved counts.

*S14.19. How much of the rung spread the half-of-intake rung carries*

**How much of the range the half-of-intake rung carries is itself a property of the pair**: dropping it cuts the spread by a median 88.1% per pair, by 1.0% on the pair holding the corpus's widest spread, and not at all on 2 pairs, where the rung's own increment falls inside the range the remaining rungs already span. The fall is not a correction of an error but a change of denominator with a plain explanation: on 17 of the 19 pairs only two rungs remain, so the spread over them *is* the absorption $D$ of the free

field, which Section 7.5 reports as an object in its own right with its own interval. Only the case study's log carries a third (Table 3), and its two pairs are where the corpus's widest realistic-rung spread sits, reaching 0.2495.

## S15. Tables the article summarises

The article prints the 8 tables a reader needs to follow its argument. This section carries the ones it summarises: the exclusion ledger, the construct audit, the surface denominator, the planned contrasts, the region labels, the ITSM family split, the sign-flip attribution, the cohort decomposition, the axis-kind partition, the specification-curve comparison, the desk utility, the tipping curve, the decision-curve corpus, the declared measures, the four decision rules, the calibration diagnostics, the availability evidence, the severity sweeps, the absorption ladders, and the simulation in full. Every one is generated by `scripts/make_numbers.py` from the result files, and none is typed by hand.

*S15.1. The corpus*

*S15.2. Regions, sign flips and the cohort decomposition*

*S15.3. Measures, rules and calibration*

*S15.4. The case study*

*S15.5. The same objects on the registered cohort*

Section 7.1 shows that this log gives two answers, and that the difference is the target rather than the cohort. Section 7 prints the estate's own cohort and reassignment target throughout. These are the same objects on the registered cohort and the handover target, so that a reader can see both without either being the one the article quotes.

*S15.6. The simulation in full*

| log | target | learner | quality | rung | split | higher-order total | largest involvement |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 0.110 | 0.029 | 0.075 | 0.203 | 0.560 | 0.437 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.036 | 0.029 | 0.029 | 0.384 | 0.409 | 0.372 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.024 | 0.099 | 0.169 | 0.172 | 0.308 | 0.251 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.242 | 0.151 | 0.359 | 0.013 | 0.233 | 0.180 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.314 | 0.127 | 0.307 | 0.010 | 0.233 | 0.183 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.041 | 0.039 | 0.055 | 0.263 | 0.614 | 0.548 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.018 | 0.036 | 0.075 | 0.079 | 0.575 | 0.476 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.003 | 0.081 | 0.025 | 0.287 | 0.607 | 0.490 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 0.002 | 0.004 | 0.128 | 0.189 | 0.662 | 0.547 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 0.060 | 0.025 | 0.011 | 0.111 | 0.732 | 0.655 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.022 | 0.031 | 0.035 | 0.050 | 0.793 | 0.643 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.078 | 0.042 | 0.057 | 0.036 | 0.749 | 0.664 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.000 | 0.062 | 0.001 | 0.346 | 0.590 | 0.494 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.014 | 0.011 | 0.003 | 0.491 | 0.474 | 0.418 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 0.262 | 0.086 | 0.008 | 0.222 | 0.339 | 0.314 |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.009 | 0.289 | 0.032 | 0.192 | 0.449 | 0.424 |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.021 | 0.145 | 0.008 | 0.134 | 0.608 | 0.574 |
| UCI498 | duration | 0.048 | 0.030 | 0.056 | 0.399 | 0.433 | 0.391 |
| UCI498 | handover | 0.079 | 0.071 | 0.287 | 0.136 | 0.390 | 0.285 |

Table S8: The corrected sensitivity decomposition, within instrument, under the equal-level measure. The four first-order indices, then the TOTAL higher-order share $1 - \sum_i S_i$ of Equation (4), then the largest per-axis interaction involvement $\max_i(S_{T_i} - S_i)$ — which is the quantity an earlier version reported as the interaction share and which is not it, because those differences overlap across axes.

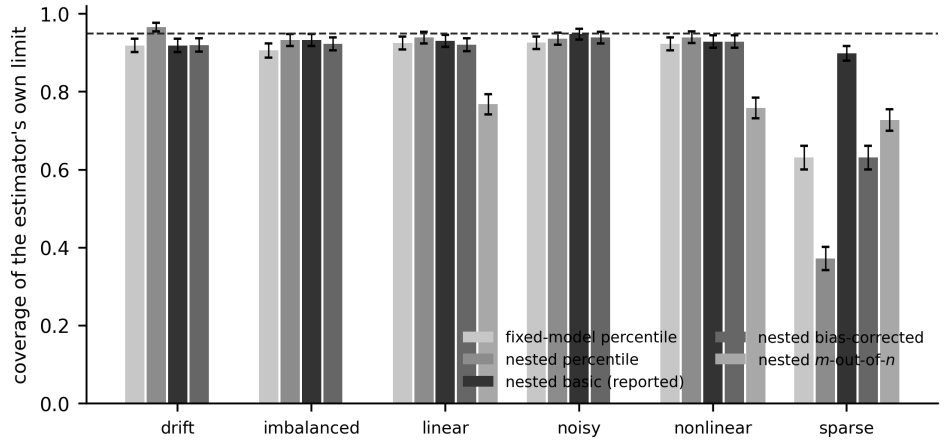



Figure S5: Coverage of the estimator's own limit in six simulated worlds, by interval construction, with Monte Carlo error bars. The dashed line is nominal. The fixed-model percentile interval is the conventional one; the nested basic interval is the one this paper reports. The sparse world is where they disagree by more than a few points, and the nested percentile bar there is the failure the basic construction repairs.

| log | target | K / n | q | c | q calibrated | cells (nominal) | rho | cells (cal) | rho (cal) | region (cal) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 0.324 | 3.380 | 1.767 | 7.437 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.133 | 3.372 | 1.456 | 6.027 | 12 / 0 / 168 | 0.067 | 2 / 0 / 178 | 0.011 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.133 | 3.356 | 1.456 | 6.456 | 72 / 0 / 108 | 0.400 | 49 / 0 / 131 | 0.272 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.093 | 3.214 | 1.294 | 4.798 | 180 / 0 / 0 | 1.000 | 180 / 0 / 0 | 1.000 | uniformly beneficial |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.093 | 3.266 | 1.294 | 6.168 | 171 / 0 / 9 | 0.950 | 152 / 0 / 28 | 0.844 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.106 | 3.362 | 1.343 | 7.368 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.106 | 3.377 | 1.343 | 8.171 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.095 | 3.362 | 1.300 | 6.066 | 2 / 0 / 178 | 0.011 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 0.095 | 3.345 | 1.300 | 6.541 | 0 / 4 / 176 | −0.022 | 0 / 3 / 177 | −0.017 | conditionally harmful |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 0.072 | 3.409 | 1.243 | 7.270 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.072 | 3.430 | 1.243 | 7.545 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.132 | 3.407 | 1.455 | 8.405 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.032 | 3.276 | 1.177 | 6.086 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.011 | 3.380 | 1.177 | 6.834 | 10 / 71 / 99 | −0.339 | 8 / 60 / 112 | −0.289 | sign-changing |
| Helpdesk | duration | 0.123 | 3.325 | 1.431 | 5.625 | 0 / 2 / 178 | −0.011 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.001 | 3.298 | 1.177 | 5.958 | 52 / 6 / 122 | 0.256 | 46 / 6 / 128 | 0.222 | sign-changing |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.200 | 3.319 | 1.562 | 6.112 | 102 / 0 / 78 | 0.567 | 11 / 0 / 169 | 0.061 | conditionally beneficial |
| UCI498 | duration | 0.301 | 3.296 | 1.756 | 7.040 | 14 / 0 / 166 | 0.078 | 2 / 0 / 178 | 0.011 | conditionally beneficial |
| UCI498 | handover | 0.301 | 3.339 | 1.756 | 9.666 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | 0 / 0 / 180 | 0.000 | unresolved |

Table S9: Resolution regions under the nominal critical value and under one calibrated for the register's cardinality. $c$ is the inflation factor the $(n, K)$ plane of Section 9.1 gives at that pair's own $K/n$; a calibrated critical value would be $c$ times the nominal one. 'q' is the operative critical value the article's labels rest on (Section 4.3 says which estimator that is); the labels are computed at the operative critical value of Section 4.3, which is the value $c$ multiplies. The cell columns are beneficial / harmful / unresolved, and the admissible count is the same under both critical values. THE NOMINAL COLUMNS ARE THE ONES THE ARTICLE'S COUNTS USE: no widening is applied (Section 9.2), and the calibrated columns are printed beside them to show what applying one would cost — not what was done. The widening these families actually need is larger than the $c$ printed here.

| log | target | cells | all-cells rate | resolved / of which disagree | resolved rate | magnitude rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 1080 | 0.284 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.111 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 1080 | 0.393 | 12 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.812 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 1080 | 0.111 | 72 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.482 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 4800 | 0.106 | 180 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.018 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 4800 | 0.244 | 171 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.025 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 1080 | 0.423 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.502 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 1080 | 0.242 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.529 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 1080 | 0.191 | 2 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.179 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 1080 | 0.616 | 4 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.565 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 1080 | 0.623 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.715 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 1080 | 0.618 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.784 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 1080 | 0.328 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.507 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 1080 | 0.353 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.203 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 1620 | 0.360 | 81 / 71 | 0.877 | 0.563 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 1080 | 0.257 | 2 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.102 |
| RoadFines | duration | 1620 | 0.173 | 58 / 6 | 0.103 | 0.099 |
| Sepsis | duration | 1080 | 0.056 | 102 / 0 | 0.000 | 0.031 |
| UCI498 | duration | 1080 | 0.493 | 14 / 14 | 1.000 | 0.623 |
| UCI498 | handover | 1080 | 0.481 | 0 / 0 | – | 0.683 |

Table S10: The sign-disagreement rate of a one-number report, counted three ways, under the equal-level measure. The all-cells rate counts every admissible cell, most of whose signs the data do not determine; the resolved rate is restricted to the cells whose whole-surface band excludes zero, and the column before it gives the two counts it is computed from; the magnitude rate weights every cell by $|V|$ as well as by the measure. A pair with no resolved cell has no resolved rate and is printed with none rather than with zero.

| step | cohort | target | V at the knowledge rung | lo | hi | delta |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| the case study as published | reassignment | reassignment | −0.00322 | – | – | – |
| the case study, tie-break declared | reassignment | reassignment | −0.00286 | −0.00730 | 0.00203 | 0.00035 |
| then the other tie-break rule | reassignment | reassignment | −0.00286 | −0.00730 | 0.00203 | 0.00000 |
| then the registered cohort | registered | reassignment | −0.00385 | −0.00898 | 0.00069 | −0.00098 |
| then the registered target | registered | handover | 0.00768 | −0.00161 | 0.01217 | 0.01153 |

Table S11: The two published values of the register's increment at the later forecast origin, reconciled one factor at a time. Each row changes exactly one thing from the row above; 'delta' is what that change is worth. The first row is the number Section 7 reported and the last is the planned contrast PC3 of Table S15. Intervals are the pointwise basic construction at 400 draws; the first row has none because the ordering it was computed under is not reproducible by a rule, which is the subject of the second row.

| log | domain | code | detail |
|---|---|---|---|
| Helpdesk | itsm | NO_HEADROOM | handover/primary prev=0.9993 |
| Helpdesk | itsm | NO_HEADROOM | handover/g=workgroup prev=0.0011 |
| BPIC13_open | itsm | SMALL_N | n=819 |
| BPIC13_closed | itsm | NO_TEST_VARIATION | duration |
| BPIC12 | lending | NO_G | n=13087 |
| BPIC17 | lending | NO_HEADROOM | handover/primary prev=0.9977 |
| BPIC19 | procurement | NO_HEADROOM | handover/primary prev=0.9631 |
| BPIC15_2 | permitting | SMALL_N | n=832 |
| BPIC15_5 | permitting | NO_HEADROOM | handover/primary prev=0.9593 |
| BPIC20_domestic | expenses | NO_G | n=10500 |
| BPIC20_intl | expenses | NO_G | n=6449 |
| BPIC20_prepaid | expenses | NO_G | n=2099 |
| BPIC20_permit | expenses | NO_G | n=7065 |
| BPIC20_rfp | expenses | NO_G | n=6886 |
| Sepsis | healthcare | NO_HEADROOM | handover/primary prev=1.0000 |
| HospitalBilling | healthcare | NO_F | n=100000 |
| RoadFines | enforcement | NO_HEADROOM | handover/primary prev=0.0037 |
| BPIC11 | healthcare | HELD_OUT | downloaded as a held-out log for the out-of-corpus test; never offered to the admission rules |
| BPIC18 | agriculture | NO_TEST_VARIATION | held-out set: duration |
| BPIC18 | agriculture | NO_HEADROOM | held-out set: handover prev=1.0000 |

Table S12: Every downloaded log that is not among the 19 admitted log–target pairs, with its registered exclusion code. HELD_OUT names the logs downloaded as a held-out set for a separate test and never offered to the admission rules; every other code is a rule of Section 5. Some logs appear here under one target and among the admitted pairs under the other, which is what a per-pair admission rule does.

| log | domain | target | register | free field | why it behaves as a register | threat to construct validity |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| RoadFines | enforcement | duration | article | org:resource | article of law, reused across fines | semantics legal, not operational |
| Sepsis | healthcare | duration | Diagnose | org:group | diagnosis vocabulary: reused, not maintained | no maintenance process; quality axis hypothetical |
| BPIC13_closed | itsm | handover | product | org:resource | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| BPIC13_incidents | itsm | duration | product | org:resource | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| BPIC13_incidents | itsm | handover | product | org:resource | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| BPIC14 | itsm | duration | CI Name (aff) | assignment group | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| BPIC14 | itsm | handover | CI Name (aff) | assignment group | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| Helpdesk | itsm | duration | customer | Resource | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| UCI498 | itsm | duration | caller_id | assigned_to | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| UCI498 | itsm | handover | caller_id | assigned_to | maintained CI or customer register | none beyond domain: closest to the case study |
| BPIC17 | lending | duration | case:RequestedAmount | org:resource | application or offer reference | near-unique per case, so reuse is thin |
| BPIC15_1 | permitting | duration | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC15_1 | permitting | handover | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC15_3 | permitting | duration | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC15_3 | permitting | handover | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC15_4 | permitting | duration | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC15_4 | permitting | handover | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC15_5 | permitting | duration | case:parts | org:resource | case-type reference, reused | nobody curates it |
| BPIC19 | procurement | duration | case:Vendor | org:resource | item or vendor catalogue entry | target is a duration, not a routing decision |

Table S13: Construct validity, per log–target pair: the field playing the register role, why it behaves as a maintained and reused entity, the free field, and the specific threat to construct validity the pair carries. These are not the same construct, which is why the corpus is a benchmark of specification sensitivity rather than a replication.

| log | target | learners | splits | quality | rungs | metrics | declared scalar | computed scalar | model fits | duplicates | missing | inference cells / instrument | draws | register levels K | K / n train |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 337 | 0.324 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 704 | 0.133 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 704 | 0.133 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 4 | 6 | 10 | 4 | 5 | 4800 | 4800 | 1200 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 3019 | 0.093 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 4 | 6 | 10 | 4 | 5 | 4800 | 4800 | 1200 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 3019 | 0.093 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 89 | 0.106 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 89 | 0.106 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 94 | 0.095 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 94 | 0.095 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 53 | 0.072 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 53 | 0.072 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 107 | 0.132 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 701 | 0.032 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 3 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1620 | 1620 | 432 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 1975 | 0.011 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 394 | 0.123 |
| RoadFines | duration | 3 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1620 | 1620 | 432 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 66 | 0.001 |
| Sepsis | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 147 | 0.200 |
| UCI498 | duration | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 5245 | 0.301 |
| UCI498 | handover | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 1080 | 1080 | 288 | 0 | 0 | 36 | 400 | 5245 | 0.301 |

Table S14: The surface denominator audit. For every log–target pair: the declared level count on each axis, then two counts *on the same basis* — the admissible scalar cells the declaration multiplies out, and the same cells counted in the surface file — which are equal on every pair. 'model fits' is a different quantity and is printed separately: it counts fitted arms before the expansion over instruments and *includes* the intercept-only rung, which the master surface carries so that the surface is complete and which no admissible set contains. Then duplicates, missing combinations, the size and draw count of the inference surface — COUNTED PER INSTRUMENT here, so that it multiplies by the 5 instruments to the 180 scalar members every other table prints — the register's cardinality and its ratio to the training row count, which Section 9.1 shows is what governs whether the bands cover at their nominal level.

| contrast | cell a | cell b | estimate | interval | p Holm | Holm | resolved |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| PC1 | intake | – | 0.25718 | [+0.23556, +0.27809] | 0.00250 | yes | yes |
| PC2 | intake + g | – | 0.16727 | [+0.14456, +0.20735] | 0.00250 | yes | yes |
| PC3 | intake + g + km | – | 0.00768 | [−0.00059, +0.01210] | 0.00250 | yes | no |
| PC4 | intake | intake + g | 0.08991 | [+0.04844, +0.11706] | 0.00250 | yes | yes |
| PC5 | intake + g | intake + g, long tail 50% | 0.06339 | [+0.05368, +0.07740] | 0.00250 | yes | yes |

Table S15: The five final-round *planned* contrasts (PC1–PC5), stated in words in Section 4.4. Every one is on the REGISTERED cohort (46,606 cases) and the handover target — not the case study's cohort and reassignment target, which Section 7.1 reconciles against these — at incident creation, with the register clean, under one-hot logistic regression on the single temporal holdout in ROC AUC; PC3 additionally admits the knowledge reference and PC5's second cell carries the quality named in it. $p$-values are ONE-SIDED bootstrap values from the plus-one estimator $(k+1)/(B+1)$ with a Holm step-down correction; the intervals are TWO-SIDED basic intervals from the same draws, and the last column says whether the interval resolves — which is the criterion this paper uses and is not the same as the $p$-value's. PC3 is the contrast on which they differ, and Section 4.4 derives why. The contrasts are not confirmatory: they were fixed before this analysis round, not before the data were seen.

| log | target | cells | beneficial | harmful | unresolved | rho | region | q | label under the narrow family |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.380 | conditionally harmful |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 180 | 12 | 0 | 168 | 0.067 | conditionally beneficial | 3.372 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 180 | 72 | 0 | 108 | 0.400 | conditionally beneficial | 3.356 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC14 | duration | 180 | 180 | 0 | 0 | 1.000 | uniformly beneficial | 3.214 | uniformly beneficial |
| BPIC14 | handover | 180 | 171 | 0 | 9 | 0.950 | conditionally beneficial | 3.266 | uniformly beneficial |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.362 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.377 | sign-changing |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 180 | 2 | 0 | 178 | 0.011 | conditionally beneficial | 3.362 | sign-changing |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 180 | 0 | 4 | 176 | −0.022 | conditionally harmful | 3.345 | sign-changing |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.409 | conditionally beneficial |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.430 | sign-changing |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.407 | sign-changing |
| BPIC17 | duration | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.276 | sign-changing |
| BPIC19 | duration | 180 | 10 | 71 | 99 | −0.339 | sign-changing | 3.380 | sign-changing |
| Helpdesk | duration | 180 | 0 | 2 | 178 | −0.011 | conditionally harmful | 3.325 | sign-changing |
| RoadFines | duration | 180 | 52 | 6 | 122 | 0.256 | sign-changing | 3.298 | sign-changing |
| Sepsis | duration | 180 | 102 | 0 | 78 | 0.567 | conditionally beneficial | 3.319 | conditionally beneficial |
| UCI498 | duration | 180 | 14 | 0 | 166 | 0.078 | conditionally beneficial | 3.296 | conditionally beneficial |
| UCI498 | handover | 180 | 0 | 0 | 180 | 0.000 | unresolved | 3.339 | sign-changing |

Table S16: Resolution regions from the whole-surface simultaneous band, with its critical value $q$ and, for comparison, the label a narrower within-instrument family would have given the same draws. THESE ARE THE LABELS THE BAND YIELDS BEFORE THE MINIMUM RESOLVED SHARE of Definition 3, which changes the label on 3 of these rows; Table 4 and Table 6 print the labels the article quotes. No coverage calibration is applied to them: the $(n, K)$ factor was fitted to restore POINTWISE coverage on a plane built around a different inference surface, and Section 9.2 measures the family-wise widening these families need as LARGER than that factor supplies. This table therefore isolates the cost of the wider FAMILY, and Table S9 prints the same labels beside the widening that would be needed to earn them.

| statistic | all 19 | itsm 8 | other 11 |
|---|---|---|---|
| baseline spread (AUC) | 0.073 [0.024, 0.097] | 0.070 [0.014, 0.132] | 0.088 [0.022, 0.097] |
| higher-order share | 0.560 [0.409, 0.608] | 0.365 [0.233, 0.450] | 0.608 [0.532, 0.732] |
| largest first-order index | 0.287 [0.185, 0.352] | 0.355 [0.278, 0.358] | 0.201 [0.151, 0.305] |
| misreport, all cells | 0.328 [0.243, 0.452] | 0.271 [0.244, 0.481] | 0.353 [0.191, 0.617] |
| misreport, analyst latitude only | 0.200 [0.100, 0.467] | 0.194 [0.067, 0.367] | 0.400 [0.067, 0.600] |
| misreport, magnitude-weighted | 0.502 [0.102, 0.623] | 0.296 [0.025, 0.623] | 0.507 [0.139, 0.640] |
| misreport, resolved cells (pooled) | 0.130 | 0.031 | 0.312 |
| robustness index rho | 0.000 [0.000, 0.167] | 0.072 [−0.006, 0.950] | 0.000 [0.000, 0.133] |
| one-number excess regret (AUC) | 0.000 [0.000, 0.003] | 0.000 [0.000, 0.011] | 0.000 [0.000, 0.005] |

Table S17: Every headline corpus statistic on three populations: all nineteen log–target pairs, the eight from IT service management where the register is a maintained configuration or customer register, and the eleven where it is not. Each cell is the statistic with a 95% percentile interval from a cluster bootstrap that resamples LOGS, because two targets on the same log share a cohort and are not two independent observations. The resolved-cell row is a pooled ratio — disagreeing cells over resolved cells, summed across the population — and not a median of per-pair rates, which on a population where most pairs resolve little prints zero and says nothing.

| log | target | learner | metric | quality | rung | split |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 0.287 | 0.214 | 0.234 | 0.222 | 0.401 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.374 | 0.249 | 0.204 | 0.230 | 0.405 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.174 | 0.089 | 0.111 | 0.100 | 0.181 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.155 | 0.051 | 0.121 | 0.150 | 0.089 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.426 | 0.096 | 0.115 | 0.139 | 0.113 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.383 | 0.217 | 0.228 | 0.348 | 0.446 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.313 | 0.168 | 0.232 | 0.263 | 0.331 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.337 | 0.144 | 0.164 | 0.187 | 0.250 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 0.365 | 0.302 | 0.217 | 0.276 | 0.449 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 0.431 | 0.169 | 0.238 | 0.196 | 0.501 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.450 | 0.254 | 0.255 | 0.287 | 0.454 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.426 | 0.194 | 0.221 | 0.309 | 0.335 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.291 | 0.219 | 0.257 | 0.224 | 0.397 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.183 | 0.217 | 0.160 | 0.079 | 0.451 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 0.252 | 0.273 | 0.181 | 0.131 | 0.284 |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.120 | 0.172 | 0.181 | 0.112 | 0.221 |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.113 | 0.066 | 0.058 | 0.063 | 0.089 |
| UCI498 | duration | 0.300 | 0.197 | 0.199 | 0.383 | 0.384 |
| UCI498 | handover | 0.333 | 0.206 | 0.230 | 0.489 | 0.289 |

Table S18: Sign flips attributable to each axis: the share of pairs of cells that agree on every other axis and disagree on the sign of the increment.

| effect | B intake | B intake g | B intake g km |
|---|---|---|---|
| cohort | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 |
| cohort x target | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.007 |
| target | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.993 |

Table S19: The exact two-factor decomposition of the discrepancy. Share of the variance of $V$ over the cohort $\times$ target design, at each rung of the ladder, at a declared tie-break. With two levels per factor the decomposition is exact.

| log | target | lat. raw | res. raw | ctf. raw | h.o. raw | lat. hdrm | res. hdrm | ctf. hdrm | h.o. hdrm |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 0.223 | 0.203 | 0.029 | 0.546 | 0.192 | 0.111 | 0.014 | 0.683 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.111 | 0.384 | 0.029 | 0.475 | 0.101 | 0.158 | 0.011 | 0.729 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.174 | 0.172 | 0.099 | 0.555 | 0.080 | 0.094 | 0.031 | 0.795 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.606 | 0.013 | 0.151 | 0.231 | 0.641 | 0.008 | 0.104 | 0.247 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.631 | 0.010 | 0.127 | 0.232 | 0.612 | 0.007 | 0.065 | 0.316 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.084 | 0.263 | 0.039 | 0.613 | 0.160 | 0.141 | 0.005 | 0.694 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.106 | 0.079 | 0.036 | 0.779 | 0.043 | 0.060 | 0.027 | 0.869 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.037 | 0.287 | 0.081 | 0.595 | 0.107 | 0.184 | 0.068 | 0.641 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 0.128 | 0.189 | 0.004 | 0.679 | 0.088 | 0.125 | 0.001 | 0.786 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 0.083 | 0.111 | 0.025 | 0.781 | 0.062 | 0.156 | 0.007 | 0.776 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.090 | 0.050 | 0.031 | 0.829 | 0.089 | 0.017 | 0.038 | 0.856 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.157 | 0.036 | 0.042 | 0.766 | 0.231 | 0.043 | 0.020 | 0.705 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.001 | 0.346 | 0.062 | 0.591 | 0.408 | 0.087 | 0.046 | 0.459 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.017 | 0.491 | 0.011 | 0.481 | 0.165 | 0.374 | 0.010 | 0.451 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 0.287 | 0.222 | 0.086 | 0.405 | 0.356 | 0.151 | 0.065 | 0.428 |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.065 | 0.192 | 0.289 | 0.454 | 0.534 | 0.016 | 0.090 | 0.360 |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.127 | 0.134 | 0.145 | 0.594 | 0.366 | 0.061 | 0.075 | 0.498 |
| UCI498 | duration | 0.107 | 0.399 | 0.030 | 0.465 | 0.343 | 0.116 | 0.008 | 0.533 |
| UCI498 | handover | 0.396 | 0.136 | 0.071 | 0.398 | 0.427 | 0.057 | 0.025 | 0.491 |

Table S20: The variance decomposition partitioned by what KIND of choice each axis is, under both declared scales. *Analyst latitude* is the pipeline and the baseline rung — and, on the second scale only, the instrument — things an analyst chooses and could have chosen otherwise. *Resampling* is the split, five of whose six levels are expanding-origin folds on the same data and are therefore different samples rather than different analyses. *Counterfactual* is the register-quality condition, which is a different state of the world. The remainder belongs to no single axis. *Columns.* lat. is analyst latitude, res. resampling, ctf. the counterfactual and h.o. the higher-order remainder; raw and hdrm are the two scales. *Which scale, and why there are two.* raw, within instrument is the paper's primary scale: the decomposition is taken separately inside each of the five instruments, on that instrument's own units, and the median is reported — so the instrument is a stratum here and its own contribution appears in no column. headroom, instrument as an axis is the secondary scale of Section 4.5: raw AUC and raw average precision do not share units, so making the instrument a sixth axis requires the headroom rescaling. Every row is the equal-level measure. The two scales order *analyst latitude* against *resampling* oppositely, which is a property of the scale and not of the corpus; Section S14.17 says so rather than choosing one.

| axis varied | reference level | pairs | median rate | min over pairs | max over pairs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| the declared reference | – | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| pipeline | boosting, target-encoded | 19 | 0.353 | 0.056 | 0.716 |
| pipeline | boosting, isotonic | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.640 |
| pipeline | logistic, frequency-encoded | 19 | 0.353 | 0.056 | 0.756 |
| instrument | average precision | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| instrument | Brier skill | 19 | 0.382 | 0.056 | 0.672 |
| instrument | log-loss skill | 19 | 0.382 | 0.056 | 0.672 |
| instrument | nagelkerke | 19 | 0.382 | 0.056 | 0.672 |
| baseline rung | half the intake block | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| baseline rung | intake only | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| baseline rung | intake, group and knowledge | 19 | 0.353 | 0.056 | 0.894 |
| split | rolling1 | 19 | 0.353 | 0.056 | 0.743 |
| split | rolling2 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.493 |
| split | rolling3 | 19 | 0.353 | 0.056 | 0.743 |
| split | rolling4 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| split | rolling5 | 19 | 0.384 | 0.056 | 0.716 |
| register quality | clean at 1.0 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | corrupt at 0.05 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | corrupt at 0.15 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.647 |
| register quality | duplicate at 0.15 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | mask common at 0.5 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | mask random at 0.5 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | mask rare at 0.25 | 19 | 0.382 | 0.056 | 0.889 |
| register quality | mask rare at 0.5 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | mask rare at 0.75 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |
| register quality | stale at 1.0 | 19 | 0.328 | 0.056 | 0.623 |

Table S21: The headline sign-disagreement rate under a different declared reference specification. Each row moves the reference ONE axis at a time and holds the rest at the declared cell, then recomputes the all-cells rate on every pair under the equal-level measure; the first row is the paper's own reference. The reference supplies the sign the other cells are counted as agreeing or disagreeing with, so moving it moves which cells disagree and nothing else. The median column is the corpus median the article quotes; the two beside it are over pairs and show that the spread within the corpus is far larger than the spread across reference specifications.

| log | target | cases | capped | observed median | null median | p (median) | share positive | SCA verdict | region | resolved share | rho |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 1487 | no | −0.010 | −0.008 | 0.327 | 0.208 | not distinguishable from null | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 7554 | no | 0.010 | −0.012 | 0.673 | 0.625 | not distinguishable from null | conditionally beneficial | 6.7 | 0.067 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 7554 | no | 0.031 | −0.006 | 0.010 | 0.833 | non-null at 5% | conditionally beneficial | 40.0 | 0.400 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 20000 | yes | 0.091 | −0.001 | 0.010 | 1.000 | non-null at 5% | uniformly beneficial | 100.0 | 1.000 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 20000 | yes | 0.035 | 0.000 | 0.010 | 0.750 | non-null at 5% | conditionally beneficial | 95.0 | 0.950 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 1199 | no | 0.030 | 0.001 | 0.010 | 0.792 | non-null at 5% | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 1199 | no | 0.002 | −0.002 | 0.653 | 0.708 | not distinguishable from null | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 1409 | no | 0.119 | 0.003 | 0.010 | 0.958 | non-null at 5% | unresolved (below minimum share) | 1.1 | 0.011 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 1409 | no | 0.023 | −0.005 | 0.020 | 0.625 | non-null at 5% | unresolved (below minimum share) | 2.2 | −0.022 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 1053 | no | −0.030 | −0.004 | 0.010 | 0.333 | non-null at 5% | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 1053 | no | −0.018 | −0.011 | 0.158 | 0.250 | not distinguishable from null | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 1156 | no | 0.043 | −0.001 | 0.010 | 0.833 | non-null at 5% | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 20000 | yes | 0.006 | −0.001 | 0.030 | 0.708 | non-null at 5% | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 20000 | yes | 0.051 | −0.001 | 0.010 | 1.000 | non-null at 5% | sign-changing | 45.0 | −0.339 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 4580 | no | −0.013 | −0.008 | 0.109 | 0.208 | not distinguishable from null | unresolved (below minimum share) | 1.1 | −0.011 |
| RoadFines | duration | 20000 | yes | 0.016 | 0.000 | 0.010 | 0.792 | non-null at 5% | sign-changing | 32.2 | 0.256 |
| Sepsis | duration | 1050 | no | 0.154 | −0.003 | 0.010 | 1.000 | non-null at 5% | conditionally beneficial | 56.7 | 0.567 |
| UCI498 | duration | 20000 | yes | 0.005 | −0.005 | 0.396 | 0.625 | not distinguishable from null | conditionally beneficial | 7.8 | 0.078 |
| UCI498 | handover | 20000 | yes | 0.000 | −0.002 | 1.000 | 0.500 | not distinguishable from null | unresolved | 0.0 | 0.000 |

Table S22: Specification-curve analysis as practised, beside this paper's region label. The permutation test asks whether the surface as a whole differs from one with no signal in it; the region asks, of each cell, whether the sign of that cell's own increment is determined. Where the two part company is what the extra machinery is for. The permutation test runs on the declared 24-cell sub-surface at 100 permutations, and 'cases' is the number of cases it ran on, which is the pair's own count unless the declared cap of 20,000 bound on it. THE REGION IS NOT COMPUTED ON THAT SUB-SURFACE: it is the label Definition 3 yields on the pair's whole inference family, minimum resolved share included, under the NOMINAL critical value of Section 6.3. 'Resolved share' is the percentage of the inference family the band resolves, and a direction is withheld below 5% of it. THE TWO UNRESOLVED LABELS ARE NOT THE SAME STATE: a plain 'unresolved' is a pair on which the band resolves no cell at all, and 'unresolved (below minimum share)' one on which it resolves some but too few to carry a direction — which is why the count of pairs where neither instrument resolves anything is taken over the first label only. It is the same label, from the same column of the same file, as the 'region' column of Table 4, and Table 6 prints the counts underneath it.

| threshold measure | majority | one-number | uniform-beneficial | weighted-mean | pairs where the rules differ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| desk distribution | 0 | 0 | 0.0477 | 0 | 11 |
| fixed 1:19 | 0 | 0 | 0.0000 | 0 | 5 |
| fixed 1:2 | 0 | 0 | 0.3251 | 0 | 10 |
| fixed 1:4 | 0 | 0 | 0.2127 | 0 | 11 |
| fixed 1:9 | 0 | 0 | 0.0000 | 0 | 7 |
| uniform over the declared range | 0 | 0 | 1.3468 | 0 | 13 |

Table S23: Median excess regret of each decision rule, in net benefit per thousand cases, on the models that pass the registered calibration rule. The desk distribution places its mass on the exchange rates a service desk plausibly holds; the fixed rows report single exchange rates so that a reader who rejects the distribution still has a number. The last column counts the pairs on which the four rules do not all lose the same, out of the 16 pairs that carry a model the calibration rule admits — NOT out of 19: the rule excludes 3 of them, and a count taken over the admitted pairs and printed against the corpus total is the defect this caption exists to prevent.

| lambda posthoc | V auc | sd | n seeds |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.000 | −0.003 | 0.000 | 5 |
| 0.100 | 0.000 | 0.001 | 5 |
| 0.200 | 0.006 | 0.002 | 5 |
| 0.300 | 0.014 | 0.003 | 5 |
| 0.400 | 0.024 | 0.003 | 5 |
| 0.500 | 0.033 | 0.003 | 5 |
| 0.600 | 0.046 | 0.003 | 5 |
| 0.700 | 0.059 | 0.004 | 5 |
| 0.800 | 0.076 | 0.003 | 5 |
| 0.900 | 0.091 | 0.002 | 5 |
| 1.000 | 0.104 | 0.000 | 5 |

Table S24: The register's increment against the share of knowledge references assumed post-hoc.

| metric | V | se | sim lo | sim hi | sim resolved |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| nb_0.050 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | no |
| nb_0.075 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | no |
| nb_0.100 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | no |
| nb_0.125 | 0.000 | 0.000 | −0.001 | 0.001 | no |
| nb_0.150 | 0.001 | 0.001 | −0.002 | 0.004 | no |
| nb_0.175 | 0.003 | 0.001 | 0.001 | 0.008 | yes |
| nb_0.200 | 0.003 | 0.001 | 0.000 | 0.007 | no |
| nb_0.225 | 0.004 | 0.001 | 0.001 | 0.007 | yes |
| nb_0.250 | 0.004 | 0.001 | 0.001 | 0.008 | yes |
| nb_0.275 | 0.005 | 0.001 | 0.001 | 0.008 | yes |
| nb_0.300 | 0.005 | 0.001 | 0.001 | 0.009 | yes |
| nb_0.325 | 0.006 | 0.001 | 0.002 | 0.010 | yes |
| nb_0.350 | 0.007 | 0.001 | 0.002 | 0.012 | yes |
| nb_0.375 | 0.008 | 0.001 | 0.002 | 0.013 | yes |
| nb_0.400 | 0.010 | 0.001 | 0.004 | 0.016 | yes |
| nb_0.425 | 0.011 | 0.002 | 0.006 | 0.019 | yes |
| nb_0.450 | 0.012 | 0.002 | 0.006 | 0.020 | yes |
| nb_0.475 | 0.014 | 0.002 | 0.007 | 0.023 | yes |
| nb_0.500 | 0.016 | 0.005 | −0.003 | 0.038 | no |
| nb_0.525 | 0.004 | 0.007 | −0.023 | 0.031 | no |
| nb_0.550 | 0.007 | 0.003 | −0.004 | 0.019 | no |
| nb_0.575 | 0.010 | 0.012 | −0.041 | 0.058 | no |
| nb_0.600 | 0.037 | 0.006 | 0.016 | 0.060 | yes |
| nb_0.625 | 0.033 | 0.005 | 0.011 | 0.055 | yes |
| nb_0.650 | 0.036 | 0.005 | 0.020 | 0.064 | yes |
| nb_0.675 | 0.030 | 0.005 | 0.010 | 0.051 | yes |
| nb_0.700 | 0.034 | 0.004 | 0.020 | 0.052 | yes |
| nb_0.725 | 0.037 | 0.004 | 0.024 | 0.056 | yes |
| nb_0.750 | 0.037 | 0.004 | 0.020 | 0.054 | yes |
| nb_0.775 | 0.043 | 0.005 | 0.025 | 0.064 | yes |
| nb_0.800 | 0.050 | 0.006 | 0.030 | 0.077 | yes |

Table S25: The decision curve of Figure S3 as a table: BPIC14, the registered handover target, one-hot logistic regression, the clean register, the single temporal holdout, the intake block plus the free field as baseline. Every row is one operating point on RAW scores, and is therefore a score-threshold sensitivity analysis in the sense of Section 8.1 rather than a decision curve. The bands are the whole-family simultaneous max-$t$ construction over this pair's declared decision-curve family, and 'sim resolved' says whether that band excludes zero. This family is NOT coverage-calibrated; Section 8.2 gives the counts under the empirical critical value beside these.

| measure | description | median | min | max | largest first order median | n pairs first order exceeds | n pairs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| equal-level | every level of every axis equally likely | 0.560 | 0.233 | 0.793 | 0.287 | 6 | 19 |
| reference | half the mass on the reference level of each axis | 0.496 | 0.157 | 0.709 | 0.299 | 6 | 19 |
| concentrated | eighty per cent on the reference level | 0.317 | 0.065 | 0.638 | 0.392 | 12 | 19 |
| envelope | 200 Dirichlet draws of the level weights, primary pair | 0.181 | 0.098 | 0.347 | – | – | – |

Table S26: The declared measures over specifications, and the total higher-order variance share under each. 'largest first order median' is the median over pairs of the largest single first-order index under the same measure, and 'n pairs first order exceeds' counts the pairs on which that index is LARGER than the higher-order total. THE MAGNITUDE MOVES WITH THE MEASURE, AND SO DOES THE QUALITATIVE CONCLUSION: across the three product measures the higher-order share moves by 24.3%, and under the measure concentrated on the reference level it is 31.7%, BELOW the largest first-order index of 39.2%, with a first-order index exceeding the higher-order remainder on 12 of 19 pairs — and on 6 of 19 even under the primary equal-level measure. 'The interactions carry more than any main effect' is therefore a claim about a measure and not only about a surface, and Section 6.2 states it as one. The envelope row is the Dirichlet envelope on the primary pair alone, so it carries no corpus-wide comparison and its last three cells are dashes rather than zeroes.

| metric | unit | majority | one-number | uniform-beneficial | weighted-mean | majority (n suboptimal) | one-number (n suboptimal) | uniform-beneficial (n suboptimal) | weighted-mean (n suboptimal) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ap | average precision | 0.000 | 0.002 | 0.027 | 0 | 1 | 3 | 17 | 0 |
| auc | AUC | 0.000 | 0.005 | 0.026 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 14 | 0 |
| brier_skill | Brier skill | 0.000 | 0.002 | 0.031 | 0 | 3 | 4 | 9 | 0 |
| logloss_skill | log-loss skill | 0.003 | 0.004 | 0.023 | 0 | 3 | 3 | 8 | 0 |
| nagelkerke | Nagelkerke R2 | 0.025 | 0.042 | 0.037 | 0 | 6 | 6 | 7 | 0 |

Table S27: Four decision rules, INSIDE one instrument at a time. Mean excess regret across log–target pairs in that instrument's own units, and the number of pairs on which each rule is strictly suboptimal. No column averages across instruments, because there is no unit in which such an average would be expressed.

| log | target | n train | n test | prev test | cal intercept | cal slope | brier | unseen |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 1040 | 447 | 0.275 | −0.368 | 0.916 | 0.170 | 0.407 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 5287 | 2267 | 0.154 | −1.783 | 0.571 | 0.216 | 0.105 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 5287 | 2267 | 0.616 | −0.925 | 0.943 | 0.167 | 0.105 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 32624 | 13982 | 0.427 | −0.259 | 0.938 | 0.202 | 0.053 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 32624 | 13982 | 0.945 | 0.378 | 0.994 | 0.037 | 0.053 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 839 | 360 | 0.442 | −1.204 | 0.997 | 0.228 | 0.753 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 839 | 360 | 0.839 | −0.061 | 1.255 | 0.066 | 0.753 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 986 | 423 | 0.456 | −0.746 | 0.928 | 0.214 | 0.095 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 986 | 423 | 0.905 | −0.649 | 1.437 | 0.069 | 0.095 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 737 | 316 | 0.225 | −1.927 | 0.029 | 0.351 | 0.649 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 737 | 316 | 0.867 | −1.349 | 0.302 | 0.119 | 0.649 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 809 | 347 | 0.285 | −0.793 | 0.290 | 0.244 | 0.867 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 22056 | 9453 | 0.494 | −0.060 | 0.758 | 0.244 | 0.060 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 176213 | 75521 | 0.162 | −3.163 | 0.278 | 0.352 | 0.299 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 3206 | 1374 | 0.451 | −0.149 | 0.475 | 0.245 | 0.229 |
| RoadFines | duration | 105259 | 45111 | 0.429 | −0.312 | 0.626 | 0.244 | 0.368 |
| Sepsis | duration | 735 | 315 | 0.444 | −0.307 | 0.716 | 0.192 | 0.079 |
| UCI498 | duration | 17442 | 7476 | 0.286 | −0.619 | 0.811 | 0.176 | 0.192 |
| UCI498 | handover | 17442 | 7476 | 0.420 | 0.017 | 1.230 | 0.071 | 0.192 |

Table S28: Calibration and unseen-category rates at the reference cell, one row per log–target pair in the same order as every other per-pair table. Every row is on the cohort and target the registered rules of Section 5 define, BPIC14's included; the case study's own cohort is smaller and its counts are in Section 7.1.

| log | target | raw slope | platt slope | isotonic slope | raw ece | platt ece | isotonic ece |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BPIC13_closed | handover | 0.332 | 1.005 | 0.886 | 0.149 | 0.120 | 0.096 |
| BPIC13_incidents | duration | 0.575 | 1.052 | 0.902 | 0.295 | 0.304 | 0.296 |
| BPIC13_incidents | handover | 0.743 | 1.334 | 1.049 | 0.140 | 0.149 | 0.142 |
| BPIC14 | duration | 0.945 | 1.117 | 1.050 | 0.056 | 0.056 | 0.056 |
| BPIC14 | handover | 0.952 | 1.049 | 0.995 | 0.017 | 0.015 | 0.015 |
| BPIC15_1 | duration | 0.731 | 1.812 | 1.118 | 0.208 | 0.172 | 0.152 |
| BPIC15_1 | handover | 0.778 | 1.654 | 1.466 | 0.075 | 0.066 | 0.050 |
| BPIC15_3 | duration | 0.886 | 1.225 | 1.109 | 0.190 | 0.152 | 0.152 |
| BPIC15_3 | handover | 0.450 | 1.247 | 0.904 | 0.071 | 0.057 | 0.039 |
| BPIC15_4 | duration | 0.025 | 0.028 | −0.013 | 0.364 | 0.313 | 0.340 |
| BPIC15_4 | handover | 0.282 | 0.701 | 0.456 | 0.086 | 0.071 | 0.080 |
| BPIC15_5 | duration | 0.263 | 0.853 | 0.414 | 0.252 | 0.209 | 0.211 |
| BPIC17 | duration | 0.868 | 1.165 | 1.031 | 0.023 | 0.019 | 0.017 |
| BPIC19 | duration | 0.293 | 0.355 | 0.372 | 0.339 | 0.338 | 0.338 |
| Helpdesk | duration | 0.490 | 0.731 | 0.622 | 0.088 | 0.066 | 0.065 |
| RoadFines | duration | 0.688 | 0.720 | 1.377 | 0.081 | 0.086 | 0.081 |
| Sepsis | duration | 0.456 | 0.830 | 0.554 | 0.147 | 0.086 | 0.089 |
| UCI498 | duration | 0.882 | 1.534 | 1.333 | 0.104 | 0.185 | 0.175 |
| UCI498 | handover | 1.077 | 1.453 | 1.203 | 0.041 | 0.063 | 0.047 |

Table S29: Calibration before and after a training-only recalibration, one row per log–target pair: the median calibration slope and expected calibration error over the arms of the baseline ladder, raw and under each calibrator. A slope far from one is a score whose thresholds are not cost ratios; only curves computed on calibrated probabilities carry a probability-threshold reading.

| evidence | value | establishes |
|---|---|---|
| interactions in the file | 147004.000 | the population the knowledge reference is written in |
| interactions that never became incidents | 94250.000 | the field is written by the service-desk process, not by the incident process |
| knowledge reference populated on those | 1.000 | the same, quantitatively |
| interactions CLOSED before the incident was opened | 5.000 | airtight pre-incident availability, on five cases, which is not enough to rest a headline on |
| interactions whose recorded handling time had elapsed before the incident was opened | 41413.000 | that the desk had worked the interaction, which is not a timestamped field-value history |
| knowledge reference populated on the joined cohort | 0.911 | coverage, not timing |
| base AUC from the knowledge reference alone | 0.648 | the field is highly predictive, which is a reason for suspicion and not for confidence |

Table S30: What the interaction file establishes, and what it does not. Case study cohort, reassignment target.

| mechanism | level | populated | V | spread over seeds | seeds |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| clean | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.103 | 0.000 | 1 |
| corrupt | 0.050 | 1.000 | 0.099 | 0.003 | 3 |
| corrupt | 0.150 | 1.000 | 0.086 | 0.001 | 3 |
| corrupt | 0.300 | 1.000 | 0.069 | 0.002 | 3 |
| duplicate | 0.150 | 1.000 | 0.103 | 0.001 | 3 |
| duplicate | 0.500 | 1.000 | 0.104 | 0.001 | 3 |
| duplicate | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.102 | 0.001 | 3 |
| mask_common | 0.500 | 0.521 | 0.071 | 0.000 | 1 |
| mask_random | 0.500 | 0.502 | 0.068 | 0.004 | 3 |
| mask_rare | 0.250 | 0.270 | 0.041 | 0.000 | 1 |
| mask_rare | 0.500 | 0.505 | 0.082 | 0.000 | 1 |
| mask_rare | 0.750 | 0.762 | 0.096 | 0.000 | 1 |
| stale | 1.000 | 0.984 | 0.103 | 0.000 | 1 |
| stale_lag | 0.100 | 0.982 | 0.107 | 0.000 | 1 |
| stale_lag | 0.250 | 0.972 | 0.106 | 0.000 | 1 |
| stale_lag | 0.500 | 0.940 | 0.107 | 0.000 | 1 |

Table S31: Register-quality mechanisms on the case study's cohort (45,455 incidents) and reassignment target, at the reference cell. 'level' is the share populated for the population mechanisms, the share corrupted for accuracy, the share of identities split for reconciliation and the lag for discovery. Stochastic mechanisms are averaged over 20 seeds and the spread across seeds is printed beside the mean, because mechanism variability and sampling variability are different quantities. The corpus-cohort version of this table is in Supplement S15.

| mechanism | levels | seeds | integral | coarse | shift | seed s.d. | V complete | V empty |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| content | 11 | 3 | 0.049 | 0.047 | 0.001 | 0.002 | 0.085 | −0.001 |
| mask_rare | 11 | 1 | 0.069 | 0.066 | 0.003 | 0.000 | 0.103 | −0.003 |
| propensity | 11 | 3 | 0.056 | 0.054 | 0.002 | 0.002 | 0.086 | −0.001 |
| time | 11 | 1 | 0.077 | 0.088 | 0.011 | 0.000 | 0.115 | −0.001 |

Table S32: Register-quality mechanisms as severity CURVES rather than points, on the case study's cohort and reassignment target. The integral is taken against a uniform measure on severity over 11 levels; 'grid shift' is how much coarsening that grid to five levels moves it, which is the check that the summary is a property of the curve and not of the grid.

| b lo | b hi | V lo | V hi | D | D lo | D hi | R | R fieller lo | R fieller hi | fieller kind |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| B_half | B_intake | 0.1828 | 0.1838 | −0.0010 | −0.0049 | 0.0033 | −0.0056 | −0.0270 | 0.0156 | bounded |
| B_half | B_intake_g | 0.1828 | 0.1034 | 0.0793 | 0.0619 | 0.0896 | 0.4341 | 0.3572 | 0.5127 | bounded |
| B_half | B_intake_g_km | 0.1828 | −0.0029 | 0.1857 | 0.1759 | 0.2025 | 1.0157 | 0.9904 | 1.0425 | bounded |
| B_intake | B_intake_g | 0.1838 | 0.1034 | 0.0804 | 0.0626 | 0.0914 | 0.4372 | 0.3611 | 0.5151 | bounded |
| B_intake | B_intake_g_km | 0.1838 | −0.0029 | 0.1867 | 0.1773 | 0.2040 | 1.0156 | 0.9905 | 1.0422 | bounded |
| B_intake_g | B_intake_g_km | 0.1034 | −0.0029 | 0.1063 | 0.0965 | 0.1308 | 1.0277 | 0.9831 | 1.0771 | bounded |

Table S33: Absolute absorption $D = V(f \mid B_0) - V(f \mid B_1)$ first, with its own interval, then the ratio $R$ with its Fieller set and the set's kind, on the case study's cohort and reassignment target, in ROC AUC. 0 of 30 reductions across all five instruments have a set that is not a bounded interval; for those a percentile interval is not a summary of anything.

| mechanism | level | populated | V |
|---|---|---|---|
| clean | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.167 |
| mask_rare | 0.750 | 0.760 | 0.140 |
| mask_rare | 0.500 | 0.515 | 0.104 |
| mask_rare | 0.250 | 0.268 | 0.037 |
| mask_random | 0.500 | 0.502 | 0.095 |
| mask_common | 0.500 | 0.512 | 0.106 |
| corrupt | 0.050 | 1.000 | 0.153 |
| corrupt | 0.150 | 1.000 | 0.132 |
| corrupt | 0.300 | 1.000 | 0.097 |
| duplicate | 0.150 | 1.000 | 0.167 |
| duplicate | 0.500 | 1.000 | 0.165 |
| duplicate | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.163 |
| stale | 1.000 | 0.984 | 0.167 |
| stale_lag | 0.100 | 0.982 | 0.169 |
| stale_lag | 0.250 | 0.971 | 0.169 |
| stale_lag | 0.500 | 0.941 | 0.164 |

Table S34: Register-quality mechanisms on the REGISTERED cohort (46,606 cases) and the handover target, at the reference cell, including a discovery lag and a sweep of the two accuracy mechanisms. The case study's own cohort and target are in Table S31.

| mechanism | operational failure mode | n levels | n seeds | integral | grid shift | seed s.d. | V complete | V empty |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| content | discovery: coverage depends on the item's type | 11 | 20 | 0.090 | 0.015 | 0.031 | 0.146 | 0.000 |
| corrupt | accuracy: a share of rows carry the wrong identity | 11 | 20 | 0.113 | 0.010 | 0.005 | 0.068 | 0.167 |
| duplicate | reconciliation: one item exists under two keys | 11 | 20 | 0.165 | 0.001 | 0.001 | 0.163 | 0.167 |
| mask_common | population: the core identities are absent | 11 | 1 | 0.104 | 0.018 | 0.000 | 0.167 | 0.014 |
| mask_random | population: absent independently of everything | 11 | 20 | 0.088 | 0.016 | 0.004 | 0.167 | 0.000 |
| mask_rare | population: the long tail of identities is absent | 11 | 1 | 0.092 | 0.016 | 0.000 | 0.167 | 0.014 |
| propensity | missing where the work is unusual: a training-estimated propensity drives the missingness | 11 | 20 | 0.069 | 0.010 | 0.004 | 0.119 | 0.000 |
| time | discovery: the register was populated late | 11 | 1 | 0.105 | 0.005 | 0.000 | 0.167 | 0.000 |

Table S35: Register-quality mechanisms as severity CURVES rather than points, on the primary log at the reference cell. Each row gives the operational failure mode the mechanism represents, the number of severities and seeds, the integral of the increment against a uniform measure on severity, how much coarsening the severity grid by a factor of four moves that integral, the spread across seeds, and the endpoints.

| metric | b lo | b hi | V lo | V hi | D | D lo | D hi | R | R fieller lo | R fieller hi | fieller kind |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ap | B_half | B_intake | 0.031 | 0.030 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.002 | 0.014 | −0.027 | 0.052 | bounded |
| ap | B_half | B_intake_g | 0.031 | 0.019 | 0.012 | 0.009 | 0.016 | 0.390 | 0.276 | 0.498 | bounded |
| ap | B_half | B_intake_g_km | 0.031 | 0.001 | 0.030 | 0.026 | 0.033 | 0.976 | 0.949 | 1.004 | bounded |
| ap | B_intake | B_intake_g | 0.030 | 0.019 | 0.012 | 0.008 | 0.016 | 0.381 | 0.266 | 0.492 | bounded |
| ap | B_intake | B_intake_g_km | 0.030 | 0.001 | 0.029 | 0.026 | 0.033 | 0.976 | 0.948 | 1.004 | bounded |
| ap | B_intake_g | B_intake_g_km | 0.019 | 0.001 | 0.018 | 0.014 | 0.021 | 0.961 | 0.917 | 1.007 | bounded |
| auc | B_half | B_intake | 0.260 | 0.257 | 0.003 | −0.002 | 0.015 | 0.010 | −0.021 | 0.039 | bounded |
| auc | B_half | B_intake_g | 0.260 | 0.167 | 0.092 | 0.064 | 0.127 | 0.356 | 0.239 | 0.469 | bounded |
| auc | B_half | B_intake_g_km | 0.260 | 0.008 | 0.252 | 0.229 | 0.272 | 0.970 | 0.946 | 0.995 | bounded |
| auc | B_intake | B_intake_g | 0.257 | 0.167 | 0.090 | 0.063 | 0.126 | 0.350 | 0.229 | 0.466 | bounded |
| auc | B_intake | B_intake_g_km | 0.257 | 0.008 | 0.249 | 0.228 | 0.271 | 0.970 | 0.945 | 0.995 | bounded |
| auc | B_intake_g | B_intake_g_km | 0.167 | 0.008 | 0.160 | 0.122 | 0.179 | 0.954 | 0.917 | 0.992 | bounded |
| brier_skill | B_half | B_intake | 0.269 | 0.269 | 0.000 | −0.003 | 0.003 | 0.001 | −0.009 | 0.012 | bounded |
| brier_skill | B_half | B_intake_g | 0.269 | 0.247 | 0.022 | −0.006 | 0.049 | 0.081 | −0.026 | 0.177 | bounded |
| brier_skill | B_half | B_intake_g_km | 0.269 | 0.004 | 0.265 | 0.229 | 0.290 | 0.985 | 0.943 | 1.028 | bounded |
| brier_skill | B_intake | B_intake_g | 0.269 | 0.247 | 0.021 | −0.004 | 0.049 | 0.080 | −0.029 | 0.177 | bounded |
| brier_skill | B_intake | B_intake_g_km | 0.269 | 0.004 | 0.265 | 0.227 | 0.292 | 0.985 | 0.943 | 1.028 | bounded |
| brier_skill | B_intake_g | B_intake_g_km | 0.247 | 0.004 | 0.243 | 0.208 | 0.274 | 0.983 | 0.938 | 1.031 | bounded |
| logloss_skill | B_half | B_intake | 0.321 | 0.320 | 0.001 | −0.002 | 0.002 | 0.003 | −0.004 | 0.010 | bounded |
| logloss_skill | B_half | B_intake_g | 0.321 | 0.241 | 0.080 | 0.060 | 0.102 | 0.249 | 0.188 | 0.308 | bounded |
| logloss_skill | B_half | B_intake_g_km | 0.321 | 0.015 | 0.306 | 0.279 | 0.328 | 0.954 | 0.924 | 0.985 | bounded |
| logloss_skill | B_intake | B_intake_g | 0.320 | 0.241 | 0.079 | 0.060 | 0.101 | 0.247 | 0.186 | 0.306 | bounded |
| logloss_skill | B_intake | B_intake_g_km | 0.320 | 0.015 | 0.305 | 0.279 | 0.329 | 0.954 | 0.924 | 0.985 | bounded |
| logloss_skill | B_intake_g | B_intake_g_km | 0.241 | 0.015 | 0.226 | 0.203 | 0.244 | 0.939 | 0.900 | 0.980 | bounded |
| nagelkerke | B_half | B_intake | 0.363 | 0.362 | 0.001 | −0.003 | 0.002 | 0.003 | −0.005 | 0.010 | bounded |
| nagelkerke | B_half | B_intake_g | 0.363 | 0.266 | 0.096 | 0.073 | 0.121 | 0.266 | 0.203 | 0.326 | bounded |
| nagelkerke | B_half | B_intake_g_km | 0.363 | 0.015 | 0.348 | 0.318 | 0.372 | 0.959 | 0.932 | 0.987 | bounded |
| nagelkerke | B_intake | B_intake_g | 0.362 | 0.266 | 0.096 | 0.074 | 0.121 | 0.264 | 0.201 | 0.324 | bounded |
| nagelkerke | B_intake | B_intake_g_km | 0.362 | 0.015 | 0.347 | 0.318 | 0.372 | 0.959 | 0.932 | 0.987 | bounded |
| nagelkerke | B_intake_g | B_intake_g_km | 0.266 | 0.015 | 0.252 | 0.226 | 0.271 | 0.944 | 0.908 | 0.982 | bounded |

Table S36: Absolute absorption $D$ first, the ratio $R$ second, with its Fieller set and the set's kind, on the REGISTERED cohort and the handover target, over all five instruments. The case study's own cohort and target are in Table S33.

| world | bias vs limit | width (basic) | fixed pct | fixed basic | fixed bc | nested pct | nested basic | nested bc | m-out-of-n |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| drift | 0.000 | 0.037 | 0.919 | 0.917 | 0.914 | 0.966 | 0.919 | 0.920 | – |
| imbalanced | −0.010 | 0.116 | 0.906 | 0.906 | 0.900 | 0.933 | 0.933 | 0.923 | – |
| linear | −0.002 | 0.060 | 0.925 | 0.931 | 0.915 | 0.939 | 0.931 | 0.921 | 0.768 |
| noisy | −0.002 | 0.036 | 0.926 | 0.924 | 0.916 | 0.936 | 0.948 | 0.939 | – |
| nonlinear | −0.002 | 0.044 | 0.923 | 0.923 | 0.924 | 0.940 | 0.929 | 0.929 | 0.758 |
| sparse | −0.012 | 0.034 | 0.631 | 0.643 | 0.620 | 0.372 | 0.899 | 0.631 | 0.728 |

Table S37: Coverage of the estimator's own limit $V_{\text{limit}}$ in each simulated world, under seven interval constructions, at the replicate count of Section 9, with the estimator's bias against that limit and the mean width of the interval this paper reports. Nominal is 0.95; the Monte Carlo standard error on a coverage is 0.7 percentage points, so differences below about a point are not differences. An empty cell is a construction not priced on that world.

| n train | K | basic coverage | pct coverage | basic mean width | pct mean width | replicates | coverage se (pp) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2000 | 20 | 0.887 | 0.887 | 0.085 | 0.085 | 150 | 2.588 |
| 2000 | 200 | 0.780 | 0.480 | 0.042 | 0.042 | 150 | 3.382 |
| 2000 | 1000 | 0.453 | 0.100 | 0.064 | 0.064 | 150 | 4.065 |
| 4000 | 20 | 0.900 | 0.907 | 0.057 | 0.057 | 150 | 2.449 |
| 4000 | 200 | 0.907 | 0.500 | 0.031 | 0.031 | 150 | 2.375 |
| 4000 | 1000 | 0.507 | 0.080 | 0.047 | 0.047 | 150 | 4.082 |
| 8000 | 20 | 0.893 | 0.900 | 0.039 | 0.039 | 150 | 2.520 |
| 8000 | 200 | 0.893 | 0.480 | 0.021 | 0.021 | 150 | 2.520 |
| 8000 | 1000 | 0.613 | 0.033 | 0.034 | 0.034 | 150 | 3.976 |
| 8000 | 3019 | 0.213 | 0.000 | 0.026 | 0.026 | 150 | 3.345 |

Table S38: Sample size and register cardinality varied jointly. Coverage of $V_{\text{limit}}$ and mean interval width for the nested percentile and the nested basic construction. The last row is the cardinality regime of the case study's own register. *How well these are determined.* Every cell is 150 replicates, not the 1,000 of the core experiment, and the coverages here are far from nominal — so the Monte Carlo standard error of a coverage in this table has a median of 3.0 percentage points and reaches 4.1, against the 0.7 that Section 9.1 quotes for the core. It is 3.7 times larger, it is computed at each cell's own observed rate rather than at the nominal one, and it is a column here rather than a sentence because the differences down this table are read row against row.

| world | block multiplier | nested basic | nested pct |
|---|---|---|---|
| linear | 0.500 | 0.896 | 0.944 |
| linear | 1.000 | 0.920 | 0.908 |
| linear | 2.000 | 0.916 | 0.932 |
| sparse | 0.500 | 0.856 | 0.392 |
| sparse | 1.000 | 0.836 | 0.332 |
| sparse | 2.000 | 0.872 | 0.408 |

Table S39: Three block lengths around $n^{1/3}$: the multiplier column is the factor applied to the rule of thumb, so 0.5 halves the block and 2 doubles it. Coverage of $V_{\text{limit}}$.

| family | draws are | K | draws | multiplier | mult., MC upper | empirical | emp., OS upper | Rademacher | per-cell |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| decision-curve | degenerate | 248 | 200 | 0.803 | 0.805 | 0.935 | 0.964 | 0.785 | 0.937 |
| decision-curve | degenerate | 1100 | 400 | 0.929 | 0.930 | 0.948 | 0.962 | 0.773 | 0.940 |
| decision-curve | gaussian | 248 | 200 | 0.932 | 0.933 | 0.918 | 0.959 | 0.921 | 0.941 |
| decision-curve | gaussian | 1100 | 400 | 0.932 | 0.936 | 0.920 | 0.954 | 0.925 | 0.945 |
| decision-curve | heavy | 248 | 200 | 0.912 | 0.914 | 0.936 | 0.961 | 0.900 | 0.940 |
| decision-curve | heavy | 1100 | 400 | 0.913 | 0.915 | 0.938 | 0.955 | 0.904 | 0.944 |
| decision-curve | nonzero | 248 | 200 | 0.903 | 0.906 | 0.932 | 0.964 | 0.889 | 0.940 |
| decision-curve | nonzero | 1100 | 400 | 0.921 | 0.921 | 0.943 | 0.957 | 0.915 | 0.946 |
| whole-surface | degenerate | 180 | 400 | 0.923 | 0.924 | 0.945 | 0.966 | 0.920 | 0.946 |
| whole-surface | gaussian | 180 | 400 | 0.943 | 0.945 | 0.936 | 0.959 | 0.936 | 0.946 |
| whole-surface | heavy | 180 | 400 | 0.915 | 0.919 | 0.947 | 0.967 | 0.913 | 0.945 |
| whole-surface | nonzero | 180 | 400 | 0.925 | 0.927 | 0.946 | 0.971 | 0.920 | 0.946 |

Table S40: Family-wise coverage of the max-$t$ band against a known answer, over synthetic families matched to this corpus in size, cross-cell correlation and per-cell excess kurtosis, and spanning draw counts around the one it runs. EVERY ROW IS A FAMILY THE CORPUS RUNS: whole-surface at $K = 180$ and 400 draws is every pair's surface family, decision-curve at $K = 1{,}100$ and 400 draws the modal curve family, and the 248-cell row at 200 draws the case study's own curve family; the draw-count ladder the text quotes is a sensitivity around the first and is not printed here. Nominal is 0.95; the five middle columns are the five candidate critical values and the last is the control. *The bootstrap here is ideal* — the draws come from the sampling distribution itself — so every coverage in this table is an upper bound on what the real procedure attains, and the control says why: *per-cell* is the basic interval the band is built from, on the same draws, and it is short of nominal before any multiplicity correction is applied. *Regimes.* gaussian is the case the multiplier bootstrap is derived for; heavy carries this corpus's measured tails; degenerate adds the cells whose net-benefit difference is zero by arithmetic, which the corpus's decision-curve families contain and its surface families do not; nonzero is heavy with a fixed heterogeneous non-zero truth, the regime under which a cell can be resolved correctly and a region label is actually being asked to hold. Every cell is 2,000 replicates, so no coverage here is determined worse than 1.0%.

| world | n train | K | K / n | replicates | coverage at c = 1 | se | c | c lo | c hi | c monotone | c log-linear |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| linear | 180000 | 200 | 0.001 | 500 | 0.882 | 0.014 | 1.352 | 1.174 | 1.482 | 1.177 | 1.000 |
| linear | 8000 | 20 | 0.003 | 500 | 0.916 | 0.012 | 1.154 | 1.073 | 1.307 | 1.177 | 1.000 |
| linear | 4000 | 20 | 0.005 | 500 | 0.898 | 0.014 | 1.219 | 1.101 | 1.313 | 1.177 | 1.056 |
| linear | 2000 | 20 | 0.010 | 500 | 0.924 | 0.012 | 1.108 | 1.024 | 1.228 | 1.177 | 1.134 |
| linear | 50000 | 625 | 0.013 | 498 | 0.902 | 0.013 | 1.296 | 1.135 | 1.689 | 1.177 | 1.160 |
| linear | 8000 | 100 | 0.013 | 500 | 0.936 | 0.011 | 1.096 | 0.960 | 1.203 | 1.177 | 1.160 |
| sparse | 8000 | 100 | 0.013 | 500 | 0.892 | 0.014 | 1.317 | 1.220 | 1.453 | 1.177 | 1.160 |
| linear | 2000 | 25 | 0.013 | 500 | 0.908 | 0.013 | 1.188 | 1.072 | 1.277 | 1.177 | 1.160 |
| linear | 750 | 10 | 0.013 | 500 | 0.920 | 0.012 | 1.117 | 1.029 | 1.207 | 1.177 | 1.168 |
| linear | 4000 | 100 | 0.025 | 500 | 0.896 | 0.014 | 1.179 | 1.087 | 1.296 | 1.177 | 1.245 |
| linear | 8000 | 200 | 0.025 | 499 | 0.932 | 0.011 | 1.093 | 0.985 | 1.264 | 1.177 | 1.245 |
| sparse | 4000 | 200 | 0.050 | 500 | 0.884 | 0.014 | 1.182 | 1.131 | 1.299 | 1.177 | 1.337 |
| linear | 2000 | 100 | 0.050 | 500 | 0.912 | 0.013 | 1.234 | 1.055 | 1.326 | 1.177 | 1.337 |
| linear | 4000 | 200 | 0.050 | 500 | 0.888 | 0.014 | 1.195 | 1.119 | 1.337 | 1.177 | 1.337 |
| linear | 8000 | 400 | 0.050 | 500 | 0.884 | 0.014 | 1.152 | 1.104 | 1.226 | 1.177 | 1.337 |
| linear | 750 | 38 | 0.051 | 500 | 0.926 | 0.012 | 1.103 | 0.989 | 1.259 | 1.177 | 1.338 |
| sparse | 2000 | 200 | 0.100 | 500 | 0.836 | 0.017 | 1.333 | 1.224 | 1.372 | 1.310 | 1.435 |
| linear | 500 | 50 | 0.100 | 500 | 0.874 | 0.015 | 1.250 | 1.141 | 1.460 | 1.310 | 1.435 |
| linear | 4000 | 400 | 0.100 | 499 | 0.796 | 0.018 | 1.287 | 1.221 | 1.399 | 1.310 | 1.435 |
| linear | 2000 | 200 | 0.100 | 500 | 0.844 | 0.016 | 1.316 | 1.253 | 1.417 | 1.310 | 1.435 |
| linear | 8000 | 1000 | 0.125 | 496 | 0.655 | 0.021 | 1.526 | 1.417 | 1.600 | 1.441 | 1.468 |
| linear | 2000 | 250 | 0.125 | 500 | 0.792 | 0.018 | 1.404 | 1.284 | 1.485 | 1.441 | 1.468 |
| linear | 750 | 94 | 0.125 | 500 | 0.872 | 0.015 | 1.310 | 1.154 | 1.396 | 1.441 | 1.468 |
| linear | 2000 | 400 | 0.200 | 500 | 0.758 | 0.019 | 1.562 | 1.398 | 1.670 | 1.562 | 1.540 |
| sparse | 4000 | 1000 | 0.250 | 498 | 0.460 | 0.022 | 1.716 | 1.672 | 1.849 | 1.727 | 1.575 |
| linear | 4000 | 1000 | 0.250 | 500 | 0.520 | 0.022 | 1.739 | 1.632 | 1.805 | 1.727 | 1.575 |
| linear | 8000 | 3019 | 0.377 | 488 | 0.305 | 0.021 | 1.881 | 1.804 | 1.988 | 1.791 | 1.643 |
| linear | 500 | 200 | 0.400 | 500 | 0.760 | 0.019 | 1.450 | 1.353 | 1.656 | 1.791 | 1.653 |
| linear | 2000 | 1000 | 0.500 | 500 | 0.462 | 0.022 | 1.869 | 1.788 | 2.024 | 1.869 | 1.691 |

Table S41: The coverage calibration. For each cell of the $(n, K)$ plane: the coverage the reported interval actually attains, and the factor $c$ by which it must be widened to attain the nominal level, with the Monte Carlo interval of that factor. $c$ is the 0.95 quantile of the studentised error and is computed, not searched for. THIS CALIBRATION IS DERIVED AND REPORTED, NOT APPLIED: it was fitted to restore POINTWISE coverage on this plane, and Section 9.2 measures the family-wise widening the article's families need as LARGER than it supplies, so no band in the article is widened by it. 'c monotone' is the monotone regression that would be used if it were; 'c log-linear' is the parametric fit whose slope Section 6.3 quotes, printed beside it because it sits below the measured factor at small ratios and would under-correct there.

## S16. What the corpus does and does not have in common

The corpus is 13 public logs spanning 6 domains, including the further ITSM logs the literature uses (Steeman, 2013; Amaral et al., 2018), and it is heterogeneous: the registers are a configuration item, a caller, a product, a vendor, a diagnosis and a legal article, and the targets mean different things in a bank's incident queue, a hospital's admissions and a municipality's permits. Table S13 names, for every pair, the domain, the field playing each role, the target's interpretation and the construct threat that pair carries — a diagnosis code is admitted by a cardinality-and-reuse rule and is not a configuration management database. This is therefore a *benchmark of specification sensitivity across heterogeneous prediction problems*, not a replication of one finding on several organisations, and two disciplines follow: no effect magnitude is averaged across domains as though it estimated one universal register value, and the 8 ITSM-like pairs, the closest family to the case study, are analysed as a group as well, with every headline corpus statistic reported on both populations in Supplement S14.17.

## S17. Against specification-curve analysis as practised

The closest existing practice is specification-curve analysis (Simonsohn et al., 2020): enumerate the reasonable specifications, plot the curve, and test it against a sharp null by permutation. Table S22 runs it unchanged on *every* admitted pair — 19 of them, 100 permutations of a declared 24-cell sub-surface, under budgets Supplement S15 declares — beside the region label computed on the same cells, which makes "how often do the two verdicts part company" a measurement rather than an illustration.

**They part company on 9 of the 19 pairs**, close to half: the permutation test rejects the sharp null — the surface is decisively unlike one with no signal — and the same cells contain increments of *both* signs, so a reader given only the test would conclude that the register matters and have no way to learn that whether it helps or hurts depends on choices nobody told them about. On 4 of the 19 pairs neither resolves and the cheaper instrument suffices. And a specification curve is a statement about the cells it enumerates: on 1 of the 19 pairs — BPIC19/duration — every cell of the sub-surface has one sign while the *full* surface is sign-changing, and nothing is wrong with either, because they are claims about different sets; without a declared denominator and a simultaneous band a curve cannot distinguish "the sign holds" from "the sign holds on the cells I drew".

Neither subsumes the other. The permutation test answers *is there anything here*, costs one refit per permutation per cell and needs no band; the region answers *may I quote a sign*, costs a nested bootstrap, and is what a reader deciding whether to act needs. This paper's contribution is the second, and the first should be reported beside it.

## S18. What the case study says to a configuration management programme

This subsection is the reading a service-management audience will want, stated in the estate's own vocabulary. It is a reading of *one* estate on *one* public log and it is offered as one; Section 10 says what a second would need.

*The three moments, in service-desk terms.* The prediction is: *will this case be reassigned to another group before it is resolved?* The register is the affected configuration item, the free field the assignment group — the routing queue, recorded without a configuration management database and the field the register has to beat — the intake block what the desk records when the case arrives, and the knowledge reference a pointer to a knowledge-base article whose availability at the moment of decision is exactly what Section 7.3 cannot settle. $\tau_0$ is *an interaction is logged*: every call is in scope, 145,478 of them. $\tau_1$ is the same moment restricted to the calls that will escalate. $\tau_2$ is *an incident record is created*: 45,455 cases, 942 of them with no interaction record. Read down Table 8 and the register's worth falls from +0.2310 AUC to +0.2013 to +0.1034 once the routing queue is in the baseline, and to −0.0029 — not resolvably different from zero — once the knowledge reference is admitted too. A programme that justifies the register on a first-touch number and deploys the model at incident creation is quoting the top of a ladder and standing on the bottom of it; Section 8.3 prices that at 1.71 true positives promised per thousand cases against 0.003 delivered.

*Which layer of the register pays.* A programme does not choose whether to have a configuration management database; it chooses how much of one to populate and maintain, which is a choice among *layers*. On the registered cohort and handover rule — 46,606 cases, one-hot logistic regression at the temporal holdout, against the intake block at base AUC 0.641 — the item's *type* (13 values) is worth +0.134 AUC over intake, its *subtype* (65) +0.163, and the item itself +0.257, adding +0.109 once the subtype is in the model; that ladder is on a different cohort and target from Table 8 and does not

reconcile with it arithmetically (Supplement S4). **The coarse layers are not free, and the finest layer is not redundant**: 52% of what the item is worth is reachable from a thirteen-value type field, and the item still adds once the subtype is known. On the duration target the ladder gives +0.045, +0.045 and +0.129, with +0.087 marginal and the type reaching 35%, so the split between the layers is a property of the target and not of the register; Supplement S4 carries two further logs on which every coarse layer is worth essentially nothing while the finest one is not. Nothing here prices what a layer costs to populate or to keep accurate.

*What would have to change for the answer to move.* Three things, in the order a programme could act on them. A *timestamped field history*: the knowledge reference decides this estate's answer and its admissibility is settled here by probability, and a register that records when each value was written turns Section 7.3's tipping point into a measurement. A *complete population at the forecast origin*: 942 incidents have no interaction record, so the $\tau_1$-to-$\tau_2$ step is an information step only on the cases that have both. And a *target the desk actually acts on*: the register's sign changes with the target on this log (Section 7.1), and a programme evaluating a register against a generic handover rule is answering a question nobody asked it.

## S19. The absorption ladder, and why the ratio is secondary

The quantity a report of this kind usually leads with is the *relative* reduction $R$: the share of the register's apparent value that a single free field absorbs. The absolute absorption $D = V(f \mid B_0) - V(f \mid B_1)$ is reported first, with its own interval, and $R$ second with a Fieller set and the set's kind. On this estate at the reference cell $D$ is +0.0804 [+0.0626, +0.0914] and $R$ is 0.437 with a bounded Fieller set; 0 of the 30 reductions this ladder produces have a non-bounded set, because the denominator is resolvably positive at every rung, which across the corpus is not so (Section 3.4). The full ladder is Table S33.

## S20. Threats to validity, in full

*What the band's coverage does and does not establish — the three qualifications.* The measurement switches the resampling off, so it bounds the critical value's contribution and not the bootstrap's: the pointwise interval un-

derneath is governed by $K/n$ and undercovers where this corpus lives (Section 9.1), and the $(n, K)$ calibration that would widen it is reported as a sensitivity and not applied, because it is fitted pointwise, applied simultaneously and measurably misspecified. The level is bought with width: 192 cells the multiplier would have resolved are unresolved here, and 8 pairs resolve nothing. And the decision-curve families carry cells that are zero by arithmetic, which a declared rule excludes from the family before the quantile is taken (Section 8.2). The decision-curve region of that section is the exception to the first sentence of this paragraph's verdict: its family's empirical quantile covers 93.6% on a matched family that reproduces the corpus's estimator ratio at 1.49 against 2.24, so that label rests on a critical value about a point short of its level.

*Internal — two mechanisms this evidence retires.* A multinomial resample holds about $1 - e^{-1}$ of a high-cardinality register's levels, which is the natural explanation of a displaced bootstrap distribution. Under weights every row has positive weight in every draw and the level share is 100% against 80.8% — the mechanism is gone by construction — and the displacement's median moves only from 0.0050 to 0.0041 (Section 4.1). What the change does remove is a defect the mechanism genuinely caused: cells a draw drops entirely, which get no band at all and were counted as *unresolved* beside cells that were banded and straddled zero — 270 under the multinomial scheme on this design, 0 under weights. And the draw count is not what governs the multiplier's coverage: on families matched to this design it is 90.9% at 150 draws, 91.5% at 400 and 91.2% at 1,000 — it plateaus — while the empirical quantile's coverage is what rises with $B$, from 77.8% at 33 draws to 94.7% at 400. A mechanism can be removed completely and leave its supposed consequence standing, which is a caution about every explanation of a resampling artefact offered without the counterfactual, including the two here.

*Internal — further assumptions, named, and one of them measured.* The split point is fixed within a draw, so split-position uncertainty is outside every interval here. A second sort is undeclared and is not repaired: the register-quality mechanisms cut a cumulative-count curve inside a group of tied identities, so *which* identities a degradation removes rests on an order nothing pins; the affected quantity is the quality axis and not the increment at the reference cell, and repairing it moves every number on that axis, which is why it is recorded here and why Supplement S21's tie-break item ranges

over every sort a procedure cuts on. The moving-block construction needs stationarity and mixing that an event log is not guaranteed to have, and the same assumption makes Definition 2's population limit well defined under a temporal split. Stationarity is measured and does not hold everywhere: cutting each pair's test half into 5 consecutive blocks and reading the spread of the increment against a null that re-partitions the same rows at random, 6 of 19 pairs sit in the upper tail of that null at $\alpha = 0.05$, 11 carry both signs between blocks of one test half, and only 1 shows a monotone trend, so this is heterogeneity and not decay (Supplement S13). On those pairs the interval and the band understate what a reader would see on a different stretch of the same log, by an amount this design cannot sign; time is not a declared axis of $\mathcal{S}$. Mixing is not tested. The band's family-wise coverage is asymptotic, the block length is a convention, $\lceil n^{1/3} \rceil$, which moves coverage by up to 3.6% within a world, and the $(n, K)$ calibration of Supplement S9 corrects the studentised statistic's *scale* and not the shape of the maximum's distribution and is measurably misspecified ($\log n$ enters at $t = 8.3$). A reader who rejects any of these should rely on the objects that need no band: the point estimates, the decomposition, the disagreement rates and the regret comparison.

## S21. A reporting standard, and software

*S21.1. The minimum reportable form*

The apparatus of Sections 3 and 4 implies a reporting standard short enough to state in full. A feature-value claim is reportable when it carries: **the design space**, as an enumerable declaration of which learners, encodings, targets, splits, forecast origins, quality mechanisms, baselines, metrics and operating points are admissible, why anything defensible was left out, and *the measure placed on those levels*; **the denominator**, as a count a reader can reproduce from the axis levels — declared cells, computed cells, and the cells any inference actually rests on, which need not be the same set; **the absolute increments** at every rung of the baseline ladder, in the metric's own units, with intervals from a resampling scheme that refits the model; **the sensitivity decomposition**, with the total higher-order share reported as $1 - \sum_i S_i$ and not as any per-axis difference; **the resolution region and** $\rho$, under a band whose family is the set the label ranges over; and **the ratio** $R$ **last if at all**, with a Fieller set and the set's kind, never where the denominator is not resolvably positive.

**Five further items, each of which this study got wrong before it got right.** *The tie-break rule* on *every* sort a procedure cuts on, and not only on the sort that produces the split: an undeclared one there moved this study's own case-study increment by 12.4% of its magnitude and left it ranging over 30.6% of that magnitude under random tie orders (Section 7.1). The item is stated at that width because the narrow version of it missed a second instance in this same study: the register-quality mechanisms cut a cumulative-count curve inside a group of tied identities, so *which* identities a degradation removes also rests on an order nothing pins. That one is recorded rather than repaired — repairing it moves every number on the quality axis — and Section 10 carries it. *Which halves a quality counterfactual is applied to*, and which half its parameters are estimated from (Section 7.3). *A minimal practically important difference*, declared before any disagreement rate is computed and in the units of one named instrument (Section 6.4). *Which axes are resampling rather than analyst latitude*, so that a decomposition is not read as specification sensitivity when it is sampling variability (Section 4.5). And *the draw count and the* effective *draw count* behind every band, together with whatever is known about the coverage those draws buy — because a band reported without them invites a reader to assume its nominal level, which Section 9.2 shows is not attained here. Nothing in the list is expensive once the surface exists, and the surface is a factorial over declarations the analyst has already made implicitly.

*Applying it to a field of your own, in six steps.* **One**, name the roles: the field $f$ whose worth is in question, the cheap field $g$ it must beat, and the intake block $B_0$ available at the forecast origin. **Two**, declare the space: list every level of every axis you would have accepted *before* seeing a result, and the measure over them. **Three**, compute the surface — one call, one cell per specification — and audit the denominator by multiplying the level counts and comparing with the row count. **Four**, decompose it with the resampling axes held as an error stratum, and report the analyst-choice shares as primary. **Five**, band it over the family your claim ranges over, not over one cell, and state the draw count and what coverage those draws attain. **Six**, report the region and $\rho$ with the triple of counts they rest on, and refuse a direction below your declared minimum resolved share. The package below performs steps three to six from a tidy frame.

*S21.2. `fieldvalue`*

The standard ships as `fieldvalue` (Anonymous, 2026), which computes the surface from a data frame, a feature name and a dictionary of baselines. Its notable property is a refusal: `Surface` raises rather than returning a scalar, `Surface.report()` emits the form above, and `Surface.at(...)` returns one cell only if the caller names every axis. Version 0.2.0 implements Sections 4.5–4.7 as four functions of a surface — `decompose`, `regions`, `robustness` and, for the robustness check of Section 4.7, `regret` — each taking a tidy frame rather than this package's own object, so they apply to a surface computed by some other pipeline. It carries 108 tests and is an *independent implementation*: the analysis scripts and the package compute the same quantities from the same definitions in different code, neither written against the other, and on this corpus they agree on 266 of 266 quantities to $1.1 \times 10^{-16}$.

*S21.3. Beyond process logs, and beyond this paper's claims*

The standard is not about event logs and not about configuration databases. Supplement S7 runs it on UCI Adult, where the expensive field is `occupation` and the cheap ones come with the sampling frame: over 480 cells the reduction runs 0.200 to 0.947; the baseline and the metric carry the same share of the variance to three figures, 25.9% and 25.9% — a coincidence rather than a copy error, as the fourth figure shows: 25.94% against 25.90% — against 7.2% for the register population; and a one-number report misstates the sign for a mean 24.9% of the other cells. `examples/worked_example.py` produces all of it in 121 statements against the package's public interface.

*How the surface is reported today.* Whether the axes this paper varies are varied in published work deserves a systematic review, and we did not conduct one: a prevalence pilot with one adjudicator — the author, assisted by the model named in the generative-AI declaration — was run on a convenience frame, is *not* reported here because that adjudicator and a screen of measured sensitivity 0.474 can generate a hypothesis about practice and cannot test one, and is in the archive with its frame, sample, codes and evidence dossiers. The paper's argument does not need it.

## S22. The correction register

This project keeps a correction register. Earlier versions of this work carried it in the main text; a referee for this journal observed that scientific

transparency should be visible in the design and the supplement rather than repeatedly asserted, and that is right, so it is here.

`REFEREE-LOG.md` in the archive carries every objection this project has received, each with its disposition and with the corrections it produced named. What follows is the register grouped by *class*, because the classes are more useful than the incidents: they say what kind of mistake this apparatus is prone to. Identifiers run in the order the corrections were made, across all twenty rounds; three of the low numbers never entered the register and the classes below are therefore not a contiguous range, which is a fact about the numbering and not a missing entry.

*Class A — a control that could not fail.* Four corrections (C1, C2, C8, C16) are nulls or searches drawn at the wrong level, swept over the wrong range, or given fresh noise inside a comparison that assumed determinism. A null that cannot fail is worse than no null, because it is reported as evidence. The most recent, C16, is in S2: the axis non-redundancy search drew fresh noise inside each cell evaluation, so two evaluations of the same cell disagreed and the search found almost nothing.

*Class B — a quantity whose sign was set by a tie-break.* Two corrections (C4, C7) concern an operational factor computed at a fixed review capacity, where 93.1% of what the naive baseline nominated came from a single tied block and reordering rows inside that block moved the arm from $-26$ to $+608$. A quantity whose sign is set by a tie-break is not a measurement. Section 8 is built on net benefit, which admits or excludes a whole tied block at a threshold and never breaks one.

*Class C — every literal correct, the relation between them false.* Five corrections (C9, C10, C12, C13, C14) are sentences in which each printed number was right and the claim asserted about them was not: an extremum that was the worst of the points the table happened to name; a count reported as a contiguous run; a range "across the operating range" that was a range across five named points; a universal "if and only if" whose necessity direction is only existential (Section 3.5); and — the one that mattered most — a headline spread that was inflated by an intercept-only baseline no analyst would build, while a later section of the same manuscript said so and the abstract did not. This class is the reason Section 4.6 excludes the intercept-only rung by definition and the reason every number in this document is a generated macro rather than a typed literal.

*Class D — evidence one download away.* One correction (C11): an earlier version reported that it could not establish whether the knowledge-article reference was available at incident creation, named the file that would settle where the field comes from, and did not obtain it. Obtaining it changed the headline. Section 7 now reports two forecast origins rather than choosing one, because obtaining the file settled where the field is written and not when.

*Class E — a claim about the world that our own coder could not support.* One correction (C15), and it is the largest. An earlier version reported that *not one* of twenty audited papers reports the increment across a range of operating points. The rebuilt pilot of Section S21.3 adjudicates the papers the mechanical screen *rejected* as well as the ones it accepted, measures the screen's sensitivity at 0.474, and finds eligible papers that do report the increment across a range of operating points — one of them at four values of $k$ in a top-$k$ evaluation. The earlier "not one" was a property of a coder that finds fewer than half of the eligible papers, not a property of the literature. The corrected estimate is 5% with an interval that includes it.

*Class F — internal inconsistency.* Four corrections (C17, C18, C19, C22) are places where an earlier manuscript disagreed with itself: an instrument count that treated two thresholds of one instrument as two instruments; a reference reduction quoted as 43.7% in the text and 35.0% in a table without the change of specification being made clear; and a section that said a withdrawn instrument was retained in a table that did not contain it. The generated-macro discipline of S8 makes this class structurally impossible rather than merely unlikely — and does not make it impossible when the same wrong quantity is computed twice from the same wrong expression, which is C22. Correcting the pilot's frame size in the facts and not in the PRISMA flow left Section S21.3 reading 600 and Table S42 reading two orders of magnitude more, four pages apart, *after* the error had been found and written up. The frame is computed once now, before both consumers, and the verifier checks every row of the flow that the prose also quotes.

*Class G — an estimand that was not the one being estimated.* One correction (C20), found in round nineteen and the reason S6 exists. The simulation of Section 9 computed both estimands by enumerating the data generator's cells, which in the noisy world carry the register's *true* value while the estimator only ever observes a value replaced by a uniform draw with probability 20%. Coverage was therefore measured against a population the estimator does

not sample from, and came out at 7.0% with an apparent bias of −0.0353. Both were artefacts. The correction is exact marginalisation of the noise; the estimator's mean was +0.0781 before and after.

This class is worth separating from Class F because nothing in the generated-macro discipline could have caught it: every number was internally consistent, correctly computed, and correctly printed. What was wrong was the *definition* of the quantity two of them referred to. It was found by constructing two experiments that could each have confirmed the comfortable reading — that the method simply fails in that world — and having both refuse to. That is the only mechanism in this project that has ever caught an error of this class, and it is not automatable.

*Class H — a statistic aggregated over the wrong index set.* One correction (C21). The practice pilot's frame size summed a stratum-size column over the *rows* of the sample rather than over its distinct strata, and a stratum's size is carried on every row of that stratum. The quantity computed was $\sum_h N_h n_h$ and the quantity intended was $\sum_h N_h$, so a frame of 600 records was reported as one two orders of magnitude larger. Every input was correct; the arithmetic was correct; the group-by was wrong.

The correction changed what the pilot *is* and not only how large it sounds. With the true frame in view it is immediate that the design weight is 1.00 in every stratum, that the enumeration stopped short of its declared budget of 2,400, and that the pilot is therefore a census of what one index returned rather than a probability sample of a literature — which Section S21.3 now says, with the additional limit that the frame's coverage of the field is unmeasured.

The guard is a re-derivation rather than a recount: the verifier computes the frame from the sample by grouping, and refuses a manuscript in which a frame is smaller than the sample it contains, or differs from it while every design weight is one. A checker that recomputed the same aggregation would have agreed with the error.

*Class I — an inferential object whose denominator was not the one the claim quantified over.* Two corrections (C26, C28), and they are the same mistake in two places. A region label such as *uniformly beneficial* ranges over every admissible cell of a surface, and an earlier version supported it with max-$t$ bands whose family was the five scalar instruments *at one cell*; the family was two orders of magnitude smaller than the claim. Widening it to the

whole surface raises the critical value from 2.37 to 5.03 at the median pair and changes the region label on 12 of 19 pairs — and more at the cell level, where a region label's coarseness no longer hides it and the wider family unresolves cells throughout. Section 4.3 now declares four interval objects by name so a table cannot print one and be read as the other. The same class covers the pilot's Wilson intervals (C28): a binomial interval was put around a ratio of two weighted totals through a fractional "effective sample size", and none of the five resulting intervals contains its design-based counterpart.

The general form is worth stating because it is not a coding error and no checker in this repository would have caught it: **an interval is only as good as the correspondence between the family it controls and the sentence it is used to license**, and that correspondence is a judgement about English, not a property of the arithmetic.

*Class J — a quantity assembled from units that do not add.* Two corrections (C25, C27). The first: an earlier version reported the largest per-axis difference $\max_i(S_{T_i} - S_i)$ and described it as the share of variance carried by interactions. Those differences overlap across axes — a two-way component appears in the total effect of both of its axes — so their maximum is neither their sum nor their union, and the total higher-order share is $1 - \sum_i S_i$, which on this corpus is 56.0% against the 43.7% that was printed. The second: expected regret was averaged over an admissible set spanning five scalar instruments and reported as a single percentage "in the metric's own units". There is no such unit once AUC and Brier skill are inside one average. Section 6.6 now reports regret inside one instrument at a time, and Section 8.3 reports a common-utility version on calibrated net benefit, which is a scale on which averaging is defined.

*Class K — a theorem stated wider than its proof, and wider than the truth.* Two corrections (C23, C24). The necessity direction of the rank-invariance proposition quantified over every non-rank-based instrument and was supported by one stored configuration for five named instruments under one map. Repairing the proof also refuted the claim: what invariance of the *reduction* requires is that the recalibration act *affinely* on the instrument, not that it leave it fixed, and Section 3.5 exhibits a non-rank-based instrument whose reduction is invariant. The word *exactly* was wrong, not merely unproved. C24 withdraws the axis non-redundancy search entirely: its answer moved with an arbitrary tolerance, no claim depended on it, and removing it was cheaper than repairing it.

*Class L — a number the design cannot produce, and a word the design does not license.* Two corrections (C29, C30). An earlier version printed raw and Holm-adjusted bootstrap $p$-values of 0.000 from 200 draws; no finite bootstrap can produce zero, and Section 4.4 now uses the plus-one estimator with the smallest attainable value stated beside it. And the five contrasts were called *confirmatory* when they had been fixed after eighteen rounds of analysis on the same data; they are *final-round planned contrasts*, which is what the design supports.

*Class M — an interpretation attached to a scale that does not carry it.* One correction (C31). Decision-curve thresholds were read as probability thresholds, and therefore as cost ratios, on scores whose calibration slope was reported in the same manuscript as far from one. Section 8.1 refits every model contributing to a decision-curve conclusion under a training-only calibration and labels raw-score curves as score-threshold sensitivity analyses, which is what they are.

*What found these, and what to take from it.* Of the corrections above, those found in the project's own work divide by *method* rather than by class. The estimand error (C20) was found by constructing two experiments that could each have confirmed the comfortable reading and having both refuse. The aggregation error (C21) and the inconsistency it left behind (C22) were found by reading the compiled pages. So were five defects that produced no wrong number at all but printed badly: the word *Appendix* doubled on every appendix reference, a macro eating the space before an em dash, a macro carrying words set as italic variables, a sentence's tail printed twice, and a minus sign set as a hyphen in the sentence about signs.

Every checker in this repository ran clean on the build that carried all of them. That is the finding worth generalising: an apparatus that guarantees every number is derived from a result file guarantees nothing about whether the sentence around it says what the author meant, and the only instrument that has ever caught that is somebody reading the output.

## S23. The literature pilot in full

Section S21.3 states what the pilot is and what it is not. This appendix gives the flow, the design and the numbers.

| step | n |
|---|---|
| records enumerated in the frame | 600 |
| records sampled | 600 |
| full text retrieved | 369 |
| full text not retrieved | 231 |
| screened in by the mechanical rule | 54 |
| screened out: no quantitative metric | 192 |
| screened out: no incremental comparison | 123 |
| adjudicated, screened-in stratum (census) | 54 |
| adjudicated, screened-out stratum (sample) | 120 |
| confirmed eligible, screened-in stratum | 26 |
| confirmed eligible, screened-out stratum (unweighted) | 11 |
| estimated eligible among all retrieved full texts | 54.9 |

Table S42: The pilot's flow, in PRISMA-style steps. Every row is a count of records except the last, which is the two-stratum estimate of how many of the retrieved full texts are eligible and is therefore fractional.

*Flow*

Table S42 is the flow, laid out in the style Page et al. (2021) prescribe for a systematic review — which this is not, and the appendix says so throughout; the layout is used because it makes what was excluded, and why, countable. Records were enumerated from a public index across 77 strata — venues, two citation seeds and a topic frame — and the enumeration is cached per stratum in the archive so it can be re-run without re-querying.

The allocation was declared before the enumeration finished: proportional to stratum size with a floor of 25 per stratum, up to a budget of 2,400 records, with every estimate carrying the design weight $N_h/n_h$. The enumeration returned 600 deduplicated records — short of that budget, because the provider's daily request quota was exhausted first — so the allocation bound at $n_h = N_h$ in every stratum and the design weight is 1.00 throughout. **The machinery of weighting is therefore inert here.** It is retained because it is what makes the design re-runnable at scale, and because a reader is entitled to see that the weights are one rather than to assume it; but the pilot's reach is that of a census of 600 enumerated records, not that of a probability sample of a literature, and Section S21.3 says so.

| quantity | estimate | lo | hi | note |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| screen sensitivity | 0.474 | 0.347 | 0.602 | weighted; the screened-out stratum is a 38.1% sample |
| screen specificity | 0.911 | 0.874 | 0.938 | weighted |
| screen precision (PPV) | 0.481 | 0.354 | 0.611 | census over the screened-in stratum |
| eligibility prevalence among retrieved full texts | 0.149 | – | – | two-stratum estimate |

Table S43: The mechanical screen's measured accuracy against the adjudicated standard.

| rule | sensitivity | specificity | precision | n flagged |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| amended (primary) | 0.474 | 0.911 | 0.481 | 54 |
| registered | 0.569 | 0.769 | 0.301 | 73 |

Table S44: Two mechanical screens against the same adjudicated standard. They fail differently and neither is good enough to support a claim about a field's practice, which is why the pilot does not make one.

*The two-stratum adjudication, and why it is the point*

The design's one non-obvious feature is that the papers the mechanical screen *rejected* were sampled and adjudicated too. Without that, a screen's misses are invisible and its proportions can only be described as bounds — which an earlier version of this work did, incorrectly, because a screen with false positives does not yield a bound in either direction.

With it, Table S43 reports what the screen actually does: sensitivity 0.474 [0.347, 0.602], specificity 0.911, precision 0.481. Agreement between the mechanical codes and the adjudicated ones has median $\kappa = 0.20$, which is poor. The prevalence estimates in Table S48 are nonetheless unbiased for the adjudicated standard, because the two strata are combined with their sampling weights rather than the screened-in stratum being used alone. That is why no sensitivity-and-specificity correction of the Rogan–Gladen (1978) kind is applied: such a correction repairs a prevalence estimated *from the screen*, and the estimate here is made from the adjudications, with the screen entering only as the stratifier.

*Two mechanical screens, one standard*

Two screening rules ran on every paper: the one registered in `AUDIT-PROTOCOL.md` section 4, and the amended one of its amendment 1, written against the same prose. Table S44 reports both against the adjudicated standard. They fail differently — the registered rule flags more papers and is right about fewer of them — and neither is good enough to support a claim about a field's practice. That is the pilot's central finding about itself.

| quantity | n |
|---|---|
| eligible papers | 54.875 |
| of which the incremental feature is a lookup into an external register or reference source | 3.000 |
| of those, reporting the increment across a range of register populations | 0.000 |

Table S45: Applicability-specific denominators.

| characteristic | retrieved | not retrieved |
|---|---|---|
| n | 369 | 231 |
| median year | 2023 | 2024 |
| share from the four round-eighteen venues | 0.650 | 0.654 |

Table S46: Retrieved against unretrieved records, and the bounds on the eligibility rate under the extreme assumptions about the unretrieved.

| assumption | p_eligible |
|---|---|
| none of the unretrieved papers is eligible | 0.091 |
| the unretrieved papers are eligible at the retrieved rate | 0.149 |
| all of the unretrieved papers are eligible | 0.476 |

*Applicability-specific denominators*

Not every code applies to every eligible paper. The register-population code is meaningful only where the incremental feature is a lookup into an external register or reference source whose per-case coverage can be incomplete, and Table S45 reports that denominator separately. Of 54.9 estimated eligible papers, 3 have such a feature. A proportion of zero over a denominator of 3 is a much weaker statement than a proportion of zero over 54.9, and the earlier version reported the latter.

*What is missing, and what it could do*

Full text was unavailable for 231 of the sampled records. Table S46 compares the retrieved and the unretrieved on every characteristic the metadata carries, and gives the eligibility rate under the extreme assumptions that none and that all of the unretrieved are eligible: 9% to 48%. The retrieved and unretrieved sets do not differ materially on year or venue mix, which is reassuring and is not evidence of exchangeability.

| half width | n required | achieved |
|---|---|---|
| 0.050 | 385 | 29.6 |
| 0.070 | 196 | 29.6 |
| 0.100 | 97 | 29.6 |
| 0.150 | 43 | 29.6 |
| 0.200 | 25 | 29.6 |

Table S47: What the pilot's design can and cannot resolve: the adjudicated sample each half-width would need, against the effective sample the pilot achieved.

*What this design can and cannot resolve*

An effective sample of 29.6 resolves a proportion near one half to about ±18 percentage points. A design that resolved it to ±7 would need 196 adjudicated eligible papers. Table S47 gives the requirement at five half-widths. This is the single most important limitation of the pilot and it is why no claim in the paper depends on it.

*Adjudication materials*

Every adjudication was made from an evidence dossier extracted from the paper's full text: the sentences the screen fired on, the sentences carrying a performance metric beside a number, and the neighbourhood of every mention of each coded concept. The dossiers are committed to `data/audit2/dossiers/` and the judgements to `data/audit2/adjudication_in.csv` and `adjudication_out.csv`, with a free-text reason for every one. There is one adjudicator, machine-assisted; that is transparency, not independence, and Section S21.3 says so.

*The prevalence estimates, and their denominators*

Over an estimated 54.9 eligible papers with an effective sample size of 29.6: 85% state the composition of their baseline; 18% argue for what the baseline excludes; 5% argue for the metric; 27% state or integrate over an operating point; 34% report the increment at more than one baseline, 15% under more than one metric, 5% across a range of operating points and 0% across a range of register populations.

Denominators are applicability-specific. Only 3 of the eligible papers have an incremental feature that is a lookup into an external register at all, so the population axis has a denominator of 3 and not of 54.9. Using the eligible

| code | estimate | boot lo | boot hi | design lo | design hi | Wilson lo | Wilson hi |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| B_stated | 0.850 | 0.705 | 0.973 | 0.755 | 0.945 | 0.682 | 0.937 |
| B_justified | 0.175 | 0.067 | 0.315 | 0.102 | 0.249 | 0.078 | 0.347 |
| M_justified | 0.055 | 0.000 | 0.129 | 0.042 | 0.067 | 0.013 | 0.198 |
| Theta_stated | 0.271 | 0.121 | 0.442 | 0.162 | 0.380 | 0.144 | 0.450 |
| Range_reported | 0.440 | 0.264 | 0.619 | 0.317 | 0.562 | 0.278 | 0.615 |

Table S48: The pilot's proportions over the estimated eligible population, with the stratified bootstrap interval this paper reports, the design-based linearised interval beside it, and the Wilson interval an earlier version printed. None of the five Wilson intervals is contained in its design-based counterpart.

count for every axis understates every rate whose axis does not apply to every paper, and is not done here.

*Variance.* Each proportion here is a *ratio* of two weighted totals: the numerator counts eligible papers carrying a code, the denominator estimates the eligible population, and both are random. The screened-in stratum is a census, so it carries a design weight of 1.000 and contributes no sampling variance; the screened-out stratum was adjudicated at a sampling fraction whose reciprocal is 2.625.

A **Wilson** interval computed from a fractional "effective sample size" — which is what this pilot previously reported — is a binomial interval for a binomial count, and neither the numerator nor the denominator here is one. Table S48 reports instead a **stratified nonparametric bootstrap** — resampling adjudicated papers within stratum and recomputing the ratio, 20,000 times — as the primary interval, because with 120 adjudicated papers in the second stratum a linearisation is not to be trusted, and the **design-based** linearised interval beside it. The design-based interval has a median width of 19% percentage points and the bootstrap 27%, against the Wilson interval's 27%; and *none* of the five Wilson intervals is contained in its design-based counterpart, the endpoints differing by up to 13% percentage points. That is correction C28 in S22.

*Four limits, stated rather than buried*

The frame is what one provider's index returned before its daily quota stopped the enumeration, so it is a convenience frame and its coverage of the field is unmeasured; nothing here corrects for that, and nothing can without a second index.

An effective sample of 29.6 resolves a proportion to about ±18 percentage points; a design that resolved it to ±7 points would need 196 adjudicated papers. That is the sample-size calculation, and this pilot does not meet it.

Full text was unavailable for 231 of the sampled records, and under the extreme assumptions that none or all of them are eligible the eligibility rate moves between 9% and 48%.

There is one adjudicator, machine-assisted, not two independent human raters. Every adjudication was made from an evidence dossier committed to the repository, so the judgements can be re-examined against exactly what they were made from; that is transparency, not independence, and no inter-rater reliability statistic reported here is a substitute for a second human.

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